“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 22

The Discourse on the Truth of Bhakti as the Abhidheya

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this twenty-second chapter Śrīman Mahāprabhu has described the truth of *abhidheya*. First He explained the truth of the *jīva*; then the supremacy of *bhakti* and the impotence of the paths of mere knowledge (*jñāna*), *yoga* and the rest, and that *bhakti* is the duty of all *jīvas*. He also showed that the *jñānīs*' conceit of being liberated is vain. One who gives up the desires for worldly enjoyment (*bhukti*), liberation (*mukti*) and mystic perfections (*siddhi*) attains everything desired — *prayojana* and all else — by the path of pure *bhakti*. And if, through ignorance, some of those desires still remain interwoven in someone at the time of his *bhajana*, Kṛṣṇa nonetheless removes them and grants him pure *bhakti*. Without the mercy of the great souls (*mahat*) *bhakti* does not arise; therefore the company of *sādhus* (*sādhu-saṅga*) is an absolute duty. Faith (*śraddhā*) alone gives one the right to exclusive (*ananya*) *bhakti*. Next the Lord described the kinds of *śraddhā* and of exclusive devotees, and the nature of Vaiṣṇavas. Bad company (*asat-saṅga*) is the company of women and of non-devotees. One must give up both, abandon attachment to *varṇāśrama*, and surrender to Kṛṣṇa. The six marks of surrender (*śaraṇāgati*) are also explained. *Sādhana-bhakti* is of two kinds, *vaidhī* and *rāgānugā*. In *vaidhī-bhakti* the sixty-four limbs (*aṅgas*) are principal, and of them the last five are exceedingly powerful. Practicing one limb of *bhakti* or many brings the fruit. Knowledge, renunciation, *yoga* and the like are never limbs of *bhakti*. No separate effort is needed for nonviolence, *yama*, *niyama* and the rest: they

accompany *bhakti* of themselves. *Rāgānugā-bhakti* follows only *rāgātmikā-bhakti*. The foremost *rāgātmikā-bhakti* is that of the residents of Vraja. After describing the characteristics of *rāgātmikā-bhakti*, the Lord then told how *rāgānugā-bhakti* is practiced.

*Obeisance to the Lord, the *avatāra* who purifies the age of Kali, the giver of *prema* —*

বন্দে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যদেবং তং করুণার্ণবম্ ।
কলাবপ্যতিগূঢ়েয়ং ভক্তির্যেন প্রকাশিতা ॥ ১ ॥

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
devaṁ taṁ karuṇārṇavam
the Lord Him the ocean of mercy
kalāv apy ati-gūḍheyaṁ
in Kali even this most hidden
bhaktir yena prakāśitā
bhakti by whom was revealed

1 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva, the ocean of mercy, by whom this most hidden bhakti was revealed even in the age of Kali.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva, the ocean of mercy, by whom even in the age of Kali the most hidden *bhakti* was revealed.

Anubhāṣya.
kalau (in the age devoid of *dharma*, the time of disputes based on logic) **yuge api yena** (by Mahāprabhu) **ati-gūḍhā** (unknown even to the knowers of true *dharma* in the Satya, Tretā and Dvāpara ages, when *dharma* abounded) **iyaṁ bhaktiḥ** (unmotivated service to Kṛṣṇa) **prakāśitā** (was proclaimed to all), **taṁ karuṇārṇavam** (the ocean of compassion for the *jīvas*) **śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-devam ahaṁ vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory to the host of Gaura's devotees

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

*In all the Vedic scriptures Kṛṣṇa alone is established as the *sambandha* —*

এই ত' কহিলুঁ সম্বন্ধ-তত্ত্বের বিচার ।
বেদশাস্ত্রে উপদেশে, কৃষ্ণ — এক সার ॥ ৩ ॥

ei ta' kahiluṁ sambandha-tattvera vicāra
thus indeed I have told of sambandha-tattva the analysis
veda-śāstre upadeśe, kṛṣṇa — eka sāra
of the Vedas and śāstras in the teaching Kṛṣṇa the one essence

3 "Thus I have explained to you the truth of *sambandha*. All the Vedas and śāstras teach that Kṛṣṇa is the one essence.[2]

*The instructions to Śrī Sanātana — (2) the description of *abhidheya* (devotion to Kṛṣṇa); *abhidheya* itself bestows both *sambandha* and *prayojana* —*

এবে কহি, শুন, অভিধেয়-লক্ষণ ।
যাহা হৈতে পাই — কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণপ্রেমধন ॥ ৪ ॥

ebe kahi, śuna, abhidheya-lakṣaṇa
now I speak listen of abhidheya the characteristics
yāhā haite pāi — kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-prema-dhana
which through one attains Kṛṣṇa the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa

4 Now listen as I describe *abhidheya*, the means by which one attains Kṛṣṇa and the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

*Devotion to Kṛṣṇa alone is the *abhidheya* —*

কৃষ্ণভক্তি — অভিধেয়, সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কয়।
অতএব মুনিগণ করিয়াছে নিশ্চয় ॥ ৫ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhakti — abhidheya, sarva-śāstre kaya
devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the abhidheya all the scriptures declare
ataeva muni-gaṇa kariyāche niścaya
therefore the sages have made the conclusion

5 All the scriptures declare that devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the *abhidheya*, and so the sages have concluded.

**Śruti*, *smṛti*, the Purāṇas and the Pañcarātra enjoin devotion to Kṛṣṇa alone as the *abhidheya* — (the words of a sage) —*

শ্রুতির্মাতা পৃষ্টা দিশতি ভবদারাধনবিধিং
যথা মাতুর্ব্বাণী স্মৃতিরপি তথা বক্তি ভগিনী।
পুরাণাদ্যা যে বা সহজনিবহাস্তে তদনুগা
অতঃ সত্যং জ্ঞাতং মুরহর ভবানেব শরণম্ ॥ ৬ ॥

śrutir mātā pṛṣṭā diśati bhavad-ārādhana-vidhiṁ
śruti the mother when asked points out of Your worship the method
yathā mātur vāṇī smṛtir api tathā vakti bhaginī
as of the mother the words smṛti too so speaks the sister
purāṇādyā ye vā sahaja-nivahās te tad-anugā
the Purāṇas and the rest which and the brothers they following her
ataḥ satyaṁ jñātaṁ murahara bhavān eva śaraṇam
therefore truly it is known O slayer of Mura You alone the shelter

6 “When Mother Śruti is asked, she points out the way to worship You. Smṛti, her sister, speaks just as the mother does, and the Purāṇas and the rest, like brothers, follow her. Therefore, O slayer of Mura, I have truly understood that You alone are my shelter.” (Words of a sage)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mother *śruti*, when asked, teaches how You are to be worshiped. *Smṛti*, like a sister, teaches the same. The Purāṇas and other scriptures, like brothers, follow

mother *śruti* and say the very same. Therefore, O Murahara, I have truly understood that You alone are the only refuge.

Anubhāṣya.

mātā (the mother — like a mother, wishing their welfare and protecting the *jīvas*) **śrutiḥ pṛṣṭā** (when asked) **bhavad-ārādhana-vidhim** (service to Kṛṣṇa) **diśati** (commands); **yathā mātuḥ** (of *śruti*) **vāṇī** (the word), **tathā bhaginī** (cherished by mother *śruti*) **smṛtiḥ api vakti** (reveals — speaks of devotion to Kṛṣṇa); **purāṇādyāḥ** (the Purāṇas, *Āgamas* and others) **ye vā sahaja-nivahāḥ** (the brothers), **te** (they too) **tad-anugāḥ** (following the mother and the sister, teach devotion to Kṛṣṇa); **ataḥ he murahara** (O Murāri), **bhavān eva** (my) **śaraṇam iti** (by me) **satyaṁ jñātam**.

*Kṛṣṇa and His *svarūpa-śakti*, though one, are joined to each other in embrace for the sake of pastimes (*vilāsa*) —*

অদ্বয়জ্ঞান-তত্ত্ব কৃষ্ণ — স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ।
‘স্বরূপ-শক্তি’রূপে তাঁর হয় অবস্থান ॥ ৭ ॥

advaya-jñāna-tattva kṛṣṇa — svayaṁ bhagavān
the Truth of nondual knowledge Kṛṣṇa Himself Bhagavān
‘svarūpa-śakti’-rūpe tāṁra haya avasthāna
of svarūpa-śakti in the form His is abiding

7 Kṛṣṇa, the nondual Truth (*advaya-jñāna-tattva*), is Bhagavān Himself. He abides in the form of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*).

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa is the truth of nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna-tattva*). The potency and the possessor of potency are the truth of nondifference (*abheda-tattva*). Let no one mistakenly take the word “potency” to mean the *māyā-śakti*, which covers the *jīva*'s true nature. The potency that is engaged solely in the service of Kṛṣṇa Himself, the *svarūpa-śakti*, is distinct from the *māyā-śakti*. The *svarūpa-śakti* and Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of the *svarūpa-śakti*, abide inseparably.

*Pastimes (*līlā-vilāsa*) in the countless Vaikuṇṭhas in the form of His own*

*portions, Viṣṇu, and in the universes in the form of the *jīvas* —*

স্বাংশ-বিভিন্নাংশ-রূপে হঞা বিস্তার ।
অনন্ত বৈকুণ্ঠ-ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে করেন বিহার ॥ ৮ ॥

svāṁśa-vibhinnāṁśa-rūpe hañā vistāra
as His own parts and separated parts in the form having become expanded
ananta vaikuṇṭha-brahmāṇḍe karena vihāra
in endless Vaikuṇṭhas and universes He performs pastimes

8 Expanding Himself as His own parts (*svāṁśa*) and separated parts (*vibhinnāṁśa*), He enjoys His pastimes in endless Vaikuṇṭhas and universes.

*The *svāṁśa-vilāsa* — the *catur-vyūha* and the *avatāras* — is Kṛṣṇa's own form, or the truth of the possessor of potency (*śaktimat-tattva*); the *jīva* is a separated part, or the truth of potency (*śakti-tattva*) —*

স্বাংশ-বিস্তার — চতুর্ব্যূহ, অবতারগণ ।
বিভিন্নাংশ জীব — তাঁর শক্তিতে গণন ॥ ৯ ॥

svāṁśa-vistāra — catur-vyūha, avatāra-gaṇa
the expansion of His own parts the catur-vyūha the host of avatāras
vibhinnāṁśa jīva — tāṁra śaktite gaṇana
the separated part the jīva His among the energies is counted

9 His own parts are the *catur-vyūha* and the host of avatāras. The jīva is His separated part and is counted among His energies.

*The two kinds of *jīvas* —*

সেই বিভিন্নাংশ জীব — দুই ত' প্রকার ।
এক — 'নিত্যমুক্ত', এক — 'নিত্য-সংসার' ॥ ১০ ॥

sei vibhinnāṁśa jīva — dui ta' prakāra
those separated parts the jīvas two indeed kinds
eka — 'nitya-mukta', eka — 'nitya-saṁsāra'
one eternally liberated one eternally in worldly existence

10 Those jīvas, His separated parts, are of two kinds: some are eternally liberated (*nitya-mukta*), and some are eternally in worldly existence (*nitya-saṁsāra*).

(1) The nature of the eternally liberated —

'নিত্যমুক্ত' — নিত্য কৃষ্ণচরণে উন্মুখ ।
'কৃষ্ণ-পারিষদ' নাম, ভুঞ্জে সেবা-সুখ ॥ ১১ ॥

'nitya-mukta' — nitya kṛṣṇa-caraṇe unmukha
the eternally liberated ever toward Kṛṣṇa's feet turned
'kṛṣṇa-pāriṣada' nāma, bhuñje sevā-sukha
Kṛṣṇa's associates named they enjoy the joy of service

11 The eternally liberated are ever turned toward Kṛṣṇa's feet. They are called Kṛṣṇa's associates (*pārṣadas*), and they enjoy the happiness of serving Him.

*(2) The nature of the eternally conditioned *jīvas* —*

'নিত্যবদ্ধ' — কৃষ্ণ হৈতে নিত্য-বহির্ম্মুখ ।
'নিত্যসংসার', ভুঞ্জে নরকাদি-দুঃখ ॥ ১২ ॥

'nitya-baddha' — kṛṣṇa haite nitya-bahirmukha
the eternally bound from Kṛṣṇa eternally turned away
'nitya-saṁsāra', bhuñje narakādi-duḥkha
eternally in worldly existence they suffer the miseries of hell and the like

12 The eternally bound (*nitya-baddha*) jīva is forever turned away from Kṛṣṇa. Eternally caught in worldly existence, he suffers the miseries of hell and the like.

The result of turning away from Kṛṣṇa, or the punishment —

সেই দোষে মায়া-পিশাচী দণ্ড করে তারে ।
আধ্যাত্মিকাদি তাপত্রয় তারে জারি' মারে ॥ ১৩ ॥

sei doṣe māyā-piśācī daṇḍa kare tāre
for that fault the witch Māyā punishment inflicts on him
ādhyātmikādi tāpa-traya tāre jāri' māre
beginning with those of body and mind the threefold miseries him wearing down torment

13 For this fault the witch Māyā punishes him: the threefold miseries, beginning with those of body and mind (*ādhyātmika*), wear him down and torment him.

কাম-ক্রোধের দাস হঞা তার লাথি খায় ।
ভ্রমিতে ভ্রমিতে যদি সাধু-বৈদ্য পায় ॥ ১৪ ॥

kāma-krodhera dāsa hañā tāra lāthi khāya
of lust and anger the servant having become her kicks he suffers
bhramite bhramite yadi sādhu-vaidya pāya
wandering wandering if a sādhu-physician he finds

14 Having become the servant of lust and anger, he suffers her kicks. But if, wandering on and on, he meets a sādhu, a physician of the soul,

The means of deliverance —

তাঁর উপদেশ-মন্ত্রে পিশাচী পলায় ।
কৃষ্ণভক্তি পায়, তবে কৃষ্ণ-নিকট যায় ॥ ১৫ ॥

tāṁra upadeśa-mantre piśācī palāya
his by the mantra of instruction the witch flees
kṛṣṇa-bhakti pāya, tabe kṛṣṇa-nikaṭa yāya
devotion to Kṛṣṇa he obtains then near Kṛṣṇa he goes

15 by the mantra of that sādhu's instruction the witch flees. The soul obtains devotion to Kṛṣṇa and then draws near to Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"In the form of His own portions (*svāṁśa*)" — that is, in the form of the *catur-vyūha* and its *avatāras*. In the state of *svāṁśa*, Kṛṣṇa's own nature (*svarūpa*) is seen everywhere. The *jīva* is His separated part (*vibhinnāṁśa*);

the *jīva* too is counted among Kṛṣṇa's potencies. *Jīvas* are of two kinds: eternally liberated (*nitya-mukta*) and eternally in the cycle of worldly existence (*nitya-saṁsāra*, conditioned). The eternally liberated *jīvas* have never tasted any connection with *māyā*. They dwell in Kṛṣṇa's spiritual abode, turned toward His feet; they are known as Kṛṣṇa's associates (*kṛṣṇa-pāriṣadas*), and their enjoyment is the joy of serving Kṛṣṇa. The eternally conditioned *jīvas*, eternally turned away from Kṛṣṇa, experience happiness and distress in worldly existence — in heaven, in hell and elsewhere. For this fault of turning away from Kṛṣṇa, the witch Māyā binds them in the gross and subtle coverings (*sthūla* and *liṅga*) and punishes them; that is, the threefold miseries — *ādhyātmika* and the others — torment them terribly. Overpowered by the six waves — lust, anger and the rest — they go on taking the kicks of the witch Māyā. This is the *jīva*'s disease. If, while wandering up and down through worldly existence, the *jīva* ever finds a *sādhu*-physician, then at the *mantra* of his instruction the witch Māyā flees, and the *jīva* attains devotion to Kṛṣṇa and goes to Kṛṣṇa.

*The prayer of one who has surrendered — (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Paścima-vibhāga, "Prīti-bhakti-laharī," sixth verse) —*

কামাদীনাং কতি ন কতিধা পালিতা দুর্নিদেশা-
স্তেষাং জাতা ময়ি ন করুণা ন ত্রপা নোপশান্তিঃ ৷
উৎসৃজ্যৈতানথ যদুপতে সাম্প্রতং লব্ধবুদ্ধি-
স্ত্বামায়াতঃ শরণমভয়ং মাং নিযুঙ্ক্ষাত্মদাস্যে ॥ ১৬ ॥

kāmādīnāṁ kati na katidhā pālitā durnideśās
of lust and the rest how many not in how many ways were obeyed the evil commands

teṣāṁ jātā mayi na karuṇā na trapā nopaśāntiḥ
of them arose toward me no pity no shame nor peace

utsṛjyaitān atha yadu-pate sāmpratam labdha-buddhis
having abandoned them now O Lord of the Yadus at present having gained good sense

tvām āyātaḥ śaraṇam abhayaṁ māṁ niyuṅkṣvātma-dāsye
to You I have come for shelter fearless me engage in Your service

16 "How many evil commands of lust and the rest have I not obeyed, and in how many ways! Yet they never took pity on me, nor did I feel shame or

find peace. Now, O Lord of the Yadus, I have cast them off; good sense has dawned in me, and I have come to You, the fearless shelter. Engage me in Your service." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Paścima-vibhāga, Prīti-bhakti-laharī, 6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, how many kinds of wicked orders of lust and the others I have obeyed! Yet neither did they take pity on me, nor did I feel shame or find peace. O Yadupati, now I have given them up, gained sound intelligence and taken refuge at Your feet, which grant fearlessness. Engage me now in Your service.

Anubhāṣya.

kāmādīnām (of lust, anger, greed, delusion, intoxication, envy and the rest) **durnideśāḥ** (wicked orders) **katidhā** (of how many kinds) **mayā kati na pālitāḥ** (have I not obeyed? — indeed I have); **teṣāṁ** (on the part of those enemies, lust and the others) **mayi karuṇā** (compassion), **na trapā** (nor shame on my part), **na upaśāntiḥ** (nor even a wish on my part to give them up) **na ca jātā** (has arisen). **atha** (after that) **he yadupate**, **sāmpratam** (now) **tān** (lust and the others) **utsṛjya** (casting off the rule of the enemies) **labdha-buddhiḥ** (having gained understanding) **abhayam** (who grants complete fearlessness) **śaraṇaṁ tvām āyātaḥ** (I have come); **mām ātma-dāsye** (in service to You) **niyuṅkṣva** (engage).

**Bhakti* is the *abhidheya* that depends on nothing, while *karma*, *jñāna*, *yoga* and the rest depend on *bhakti* —*

কৃষ্ণভক্তি হয় অভিধেয়-প্রধান ।
ভক্তিমুখ-নিরীক্ষক কর্ম্ম-যোগ-জ্ঞান ॥ ১৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhakti haya abhidheya-pradhāna
devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the chief abhidheya
bhakti-mukha-nirīkṣaka karma-yoga-jñāna
on the face of bhakti looking karma yoga jñāna

17 Devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the chief *abhidheya*. Karma, yoga and jñāna all look to the face of bhakti for their results.

*Without the shelter of *bhakti*, *karma*, *jñāna*, *yoga* and the rest are*

fruitless —

এই সব সাধনের অতি তুচ্ছ বল ।
কৃষ্ণভক্তি বিনা তাহা দিতে নারে ফল ॥ ১৮ ॥

ei saba sādhanera ati tuccha bala
of these all practices very feeble the strength
kṛṣṇa-bhakti vinā tāhā dite nāre phala
devotion to Kṛṣṇa without they to give cannot fruit

18 The strength of all these practices is very feeble: without devotion to Kṛṣṇa they cannot give any fruit.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In many places the scriptures call *karma* the *abhidheya*, in many places *yoga*, and in many places knowledge (*jñāna*). Yet everywhere they call *bhakti* the foremost of all, the "eternal *abhidheya*." The purport is this. Devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the one principal, that is, "direct," means (*abhidheya*) for attaining the highest goal of life, *prema*. The status of *karma*, *yoga* and *jñāna* as a means is only "secondary." For whatever fruits they bestow, they bestow only by looking to the face of *bhakti*: without the shelter of *bhakti*, *karma*, *yoga* and *jñāna* cannot give any fruit. Only when they obtain the shelter of *bhakti* can *karma* and *haṭha-yoga* give the fruit of worldly enjoyment (*bhukti*), and *jñāna* and *rāja-yoga* the fruits of liberation (*mukti*) and mystic perfection (*siddhi*).

*Even dry knowledge and selfless *karma* are futile without *bhakti* —*
*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.5.12) —*

নৈষ্কর্ম্ম্যমপ্যচ্যুতভাব-বর্জ্জিতং
ন শোভতে জ্ঞানমলং নিরঞ্জনম্ ।
কুতঃ পুনঃ শশ্বদভদ্রমীশ্বরে
ন চার্পিতং কর্ম্ম যদপ্যকারণম্ ॥ ১৯ ॥

naiṣkarmyam apy acyuta-bhāva-varjitaṁ
freedom from action even love for Acyuta devoid of
na śobhate jñānam alaṁ nirañjanam
not shines knowledge at all stainless
kutaḥ punaḥ śaśvad abhadram īśvare
how then again ever inauspicious to the Lord
na cārpitaṁ karma yad apy akāraṇam
not offered action which even free of motive

19 "Even stainless knowledge, free from all action (*naiṣkarmya*), does not shine if it is devoid of love for Acyuta. How then can action shine, ever inauspicious as it is, if it is not offered to the Lord, even when it is free of selfish motive?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.5.12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
If even pure knowledge — *naiṣkarmya* — does not shine when it lacks devotion to Acyuta, then how can *karma*, which is always inauspicious by nature, shine when it is not offered to Īśvara, even if it is free from selfish desire?

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Vyāsadeva had performed many austerities and composed all the scriptures, yet he was deprived of satisfaction of the self (*ātma-prasāda*). Dissatisfied at heart, he sat on the bank of the river Sarasvatī, turning over many arguments in his mind and lamenting. Then his *gurudeva*, who knew his heart, Śrī Nārada Gosvāmī, came there. When Vyāsadeva asked him why there was no satisfaction in his heart, Śrī Nārada glorified pure devotion to Hari as greater than all paths — *karma*, *jñāna* and the rest:

acyuta-bhāva-varjitam (if it lacks feeling for Acyuta, Kṛṣṇa, that is, lacks favorable cultivation [*anukūla-anuśīlana*]) **nirañjanam** (free from *upādhis* — pure, that is, spotless) **naiṣkarmyam** (free even from enjoying fruits) **jñānam alam**[28] (exceedingly) **na śobhate** (does not lead to full liberation); **punaḥ tathā śaśvat** (always — both during *sādhana* and at the time of attainment — and therefore) **abhadram** (painful) **yat ca akāraṇam karma** (*karma* aimed at worldly activity [*pravṛtti*], selfish; and even if aimed at withdrawal [*nivṛtti*], selfless, it is still *karma*) **īśvare** (to Viṣṇu) **na arpitam** (not offered), **kutaḥ** (how could it shine? — not at all, is the sense).

*Without offering to Kṛṣṇa, the whole *karma-kāṇḍa* produces worldly existence — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.4.17) —*

তপস্বিনো দানপরা যশস্বিনো
মনস্বিনো মন্ত্রবিদঃ সুমঙ্গলাঃ ।
ক্ষেমং ন বিন্দন্তি বিনা যদর্পণং
তস্মৈ সুভদ্রশ্রবসে নমো নমঃ ॥ ২০ ॥

tapasvino dāna-parā yaśasvino
ascetics devoted to charity the renowned
manasvino mantra-vidaḥ su-maṅgalāḥ
the thoughtful knowers of mantras of auspicious conduct
kṣemaṁ na vindanti vinā yad-arpaṇaṁ
welfare not attain without offering to Him
tasmai subhadra-śravase namo namaḥ
to Him of auspicious fame obeisance obeisance

20 "Ascetics, the generous, the renowned, the thoughtful, the knowers of mantras and those of auspicious conduct — none of them attains true welfare without offering everything to Him. Again and again I bow to Him, whose fame is auspicious." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.4.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ascetics, generous givers, the renowned, the wise, the knowers of Vedic *mantras* — though all their deeds are auspicious, without offering them to Him they can in no way attain auspiciousness. Again and again I bow to Bhagavān Subhadraśravā, whose fame is auspicious.

Anubhāṣya.

When Parīkṣit asked about the creation of the world and the other pastimes of Śrī Hari, the master of *māyā*, Śrī Śukadeva describes the glory of Śrī Hari and of His service:

tapasvinaḥ (the *jñānīs* devoted to austerity) **dāna-parāḥ** (the generous) **yaśasvinaḥ** (the renowned) **manasvinaḥ** (the *yogīs*) **mantra-vidaḥ** (the knowers of the *Nigamas* and *Āgamas*) **sumaṅgalāḥ** (those of righteous conduct) **yad-arpaṇam** (offering to Him, Śrī Hari, the fruits each obtains from the austerity and so on mentioned above) **vinā** (without) **kṣemam** (welfare) **na**

vindanti (do not obtain), **tasmai subhadra-śravase** (to Bhagavān Śrī Hari, the embodiment of auspicious fame) **namo namaḥ**.

*Knowledge without *bhakti* does not give liberation; liberation is the maidservant of *bhakti* —*

কেবল জ্ঞান ‘মুক্তি’ দিতে নারে ভক্তি বিনে ।
কৃষ্ণোন্মুখে সেই মুক্তি হয় বিনা-জ্ঞানে ॥ ২১ ॥

kevala jñāna ‘mukti’ dite nāre bhakti vine
mere knowledge liberation to give cannot bhakti without
kṛṣṇonmukhe sei mukti haya vinā-jñāne
to one turned toward Kṛṣṇa that liberation comes without knowledge

21 Knowledge alone cannot give liberation without bhakti; but to one turned toward Kṛṣṇa that liberation comes even without knowledge.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

From the scriptural statement “Liberation is easily attained by knowledge” one may conclude that knowledge gives liberation. But there is a subtle point here: knowledge gives liberation only under the shelter of *bhakti*. On the other hand, when *bhakti* turned toward Kṛṣṇa awakens, that liberation comes of itself, even if one makes no effort for knowledge.

Anubhāṣya.

Mere knowledge — that is, the experience of the potency of consciousness (*saṁvit*) devoid of *bhakti* — cannot free the *jīva* from material bondage. However much the *jīva* may reject all that is not the Truth (*atat-nirasana*), through ignorance of Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* the worship of oneself as God (*ahaṅgraha-upāsanā*) grows strong in him, and he falls down. But if the *jīva*, even without cultivating knowledge, is eager to serve Kṛṣṇa, he obtains the fruit of knowledge — liberation from material bondage — and realizes Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa*. “O Bhagavān, if by fortune we have firm devotion to You, Your divine youthful form will appear to us. Liberation herself, with folded palms, serves us, and *dharma*, *artha* and *kāma* wait for their turn.” (*Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*)[29]

*Eternal good lies only on the path of *bhakti*; apart from it, dry knowledge*

*yields nothing but futile labor — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.14.4) —*

শ্রেয়ঃসৃতিং ভক্তিমুদস্য তে বিভো
ক্লিশ্যন্তি যে কেবলবোধলব্ধয়ে ৷
তেষামসৌ ক্লেশল এব শিষ্যতে
নান্যদ্ যথা স্থূলতুষাবঘাতিনাম্ ॥ ২২ ॥

śreyaḥ-sṛtiṁ bhaktim udasya te vibho
the path to the highest good bhakti having rejected Your O almighty Lord
kliśyanti ye kevala-bodha-labdhaye
toil those who for attaining mere knowledge
teṣām asau kleśala eva śiṣyate
for them this toil only remains
nānyad yathā sthūla-tuṣāvaghātinām
nothing else as for those who pound empty husks

22 "O almighty Lord, bhakti to You is the path to the highest good. Those who reject it and toil only to gain knowledge are left with nothing but their toil, like those who pound empty husks." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.4)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Vibhu, devotion to You is the path to the highest good. Some reject it and accept all kinds of hardship for mere knowledge — that is, to realize firmly, "I am Brahman." As those who pound empty husks get no grain, so for them only hardship remains.

Anubhāṣya.

When, as a result of the stealing of the calves, Śrī Kṛṣṇa crushed Brahmā's pride, Brahmā surrendered to Śrī Kṛṣṇa completely and offers Him a prayer:

vibho (O Bhagavān), **ye** (people who follow the reasoning of the ascending process [*āroha-vāda*]) **śreyaḥ-sṛtim** (the path, the road to blessings, that is, to prosperity [*abhyudaya*] and liberation [*apavarga*]) **te** (Your) **bhaktim** (pure *bhajana*) **udasya** (rejecting) **kevala-bodha-labdhaye** (to obtain mere knowledge without *bhakti*) **kliśyanti** (accept the hardships of renunciation, austerity and so on), **teṣām** (for those dry *jñānīs*, the *brahmavādīs* who admit no distinctions) — **yathā sthūla-tuṣāvaghātinām** (as for those who pound husks — empty shells with no grain inside, which only look like full grains — the labor proves futile, so)

— **asau** (born of the study of scripture, of the six kinds of *sādhana* and so on) **kleśalaḥ** (hardship, futile labor) **eva śiṣyate** (remains), **na anyat** (they have no other fruit — that is, even knowledge is out of their reach).

*Only one who surrenders to Bhagavān is freed from *māyā* — (*Bhagavad-gītā* 7.14) —*

দৈবী হ্যেষা গুণময়ী মম মায়া দুরত্যয়া ।
মামেব যে প্রপদ্যন্তে মায়ামেতাং তরন্তি তে ॥ ২৩ ॥

daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī
divine indeed this made of the guṇas
mama māyā duratyayā
My māyā hard to overcome
mām eva ye prapadyante
to Me alone those who surrender
māyām etāṁ taranti te
māyā this cross over they

23 "This divine māyā of Mine, made of the guṇas, is hard to overcome. But those who surrender to Me alone cross beyond this māyā." (Bhagavad-gītā, 7.14)[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
This *māyā* is My potency, and therefore by its very nature the weak *jīva* cannot overcome it. Only those who surrender (*prapatti*) to Me in My form as Bhagavān can cross this ocean of *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.121.

*The cause of the *jīva*'s bondage in worldly existence —*

'কৃষ্ণ-নিত্যদাস' — জীব তাহা ভুলি' গেল ।
এই দোষে মায়া তার গলায় বান্ধিল ॥ ২৪ ॥

'kṛṣṇa-nitya-dāsa' — jīva tāhā bhuli' gela
Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant the jīva that having forgotten went
ei doṣe māyā tāra galāya bāndhila
for that fault Māyā his around the neck bound

24 The jīva is Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant, but he has forgotten it. For that fault Māyā has bound him by the neck.

Anubhāṣya.
The *jīva* forgot the truth: "The *jīva* is Kṛṣṇa's eternal servant." Therefore *māyā* tempted and bewildered him in every way and bound the chain of the three *guṇas* around his neck. Since then it has been hard for the conditioned *jīva* to escape the bonds of *māyā*'s chain — the desire to enjoy.

*The only means of deliverance and of attaining *prayojana* —*

তাতে কৃষ্ণ ভজে, করে গুরুর সেবন ।
মায়াজাল ছুটে, পায় কৃষ্ণের চরণ ॥ ২৫ ॥

tāte kṛṣṇa bhaje, kare gurura sevana
therefore Kṛṣṇa he worships he renders the guru's service
māyā-jāla chuṭe, pāya kṛṣṇera caraṇa
the net of Māyā falls away he attains Kṛṣṇa's feet

25 If he then worships Kṛṣṇa and serves his guru, the net of Māyā falls away and he attains Kṛṣṇa's feet.

Anubhāṣya.
Only by the strength of serving the *guru* and worshiping Kṛṣṇa is the conditioned *jīva* freed from the net of *māyā* and attains Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet.

*Following *varṇāśrama-dharma* without *bhakti* leads to hell —*

চারি বর্ণাশ্রমী যদি কৃষ্ণ নাহি ভজে ।
স্বকর্ম্ম করিলেও সে রৌরবে পড়ি' মজে ॥ ২৬ ॥

cāri varṇāśramī yadi kṛṣṇa nāhi bhaje
of the four followers of varṇa and āśrama if Kṛṣṇa do not worship
svakarma karileo se raurave paḍi' maje
their own duties even performing they in the hell Raurava having fallen sink

26 If the followers of the four *varṇas* and *āśramas* do not worship Kṛṣṇa, then even while performing their own duties they fall into the hell Raurava and sink there.

Anubhāṣya.

Brāhmaṇas, *kṣatriyas*, *vaiśyas* and *śūdras* may properly follow the *dharma* of their *varṇa*, and *brahmacārīs*, *gṛhasthas*, *vānaprasthas* and *sannyāsīs* may follow the *dharma* of their *āśrama* in every respect. But if they do not worship Kṛṣṇa, then, though they rise high under the sway of mundane self-conceit, in the end, when their pious merit (*puṇya*) is exhausted, they surely fall into the hell Raurava. Without the cultivation of transcendental *bhakti*, there is no good at all for a worldly-minded follower of *varṇāśrama*.

*The origin of *daiva-varṇāśrama-dharma* — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.2–3) —*

মুখবাহূরুপাদেভ্যঃ পুরুষস্যাশ্রমৈঃ সহ ।
চত্বারো জজ্ঞিরে বর্ণা গুণৈর্ব্বিপ্রাদয়ঃ পৃথক্ ॥ ২৭ ॥

mukha-bāhūru-pādebhyaḥ
from the mouth, arms, thighs and feet
puruṣasyāśramaiḥ saha
of the Puruṣa with the āśramas together
catvāro jajñire varṇā
four were born the varṇas
guṇair viprādayaḥ pṛthak
by their qualities brāhmaṇas and the rest distinct

27 "From the mouth, arms, thighs and feet of the Puruṣa the four *varṇas*, beginning with the brāhmaṇas, were born together with the *āśramas*, each distinct by its qualities." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

From Brahmā's mouth were born the "*brāhmaṇas*," from his arms the "*kṣatriyas*," from his thighs the "*vaiśyas*," and from his feet the "*śūdras*." These four *varṇas* were born together with the separate *āśramas* and with the qualities proper to each *varṇa*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Nārada, glorifying *bhāgavata-dharma* before Vasudeva, recounts the dialogue between Nimi, the king of Videha, and the nine Yogendras. Mahārāja Nimi asked, "What is the destination of the slaves of the senses (*godāsas*) who are averse to serving Hari?" In answer to this question, one of the nine Yogendras, the sage Camasa, describes in the following two verses the creation of *daiva-varṇāśrama*, favorable to *bhakti*, and the wretched condition of those who deviate from it:

puruṣasya (of Bhagavān, the universal [*vairāja*] Brahmā) **mukha-bāhūru-pādebhyaḥ guṇaiḥ** (according to the *guṇas* — *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*) **āśramaiḥ** (with the four *āśramas* — *brahmacarya*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa*) **saha pṛthak viprādayaḥ** (the *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas*, *vaiśyas* and *śūdras*) **catvāraḥ varṇāḥ jajñire**.

*One who follows non-*daiva varṇāśrama*, hostile to *bhakti*, goes to hell —*

য এষাং পুরুষং সাক্ষাদাত্মপ্রভবমীশ্বরম্ ।
ন ভজন্ত্যবজানন্তি স্থানাদ্ভ্রষ্টাঃ পতন্ত্যধঃ ॥ ২৮ ॥

ya eṣāṁ puruṣaṁ sākṣād
who of them the Puruṣa directly
ātma-prabhavam īśvaram
their own source the Lord
na bhajanty avajānanti
not worship disregard
sthānād bhraṣṭāḥ patanty adhaḥ
from their position fallen they fall down

28 "Those among them who do not worship the Puruṣa, their own source and Lord, but disregard Him, fall from their position and sink into the depths." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among the people of these four *varṇas* and *āśramas*, those who do not directly serve their Lord, Bhagavān Viṣṇu, but out of pride in their own *varṇa* and *āśrama* disregard His service, fall from their position and go down.

Anubhāṣya.

eṣām (among them — the *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas*, *vaiśyas* and *śūdras*, the *brahmacārīs*, *gṛhasthas*, *vānaprasthas* and *sannyāsīs*) **ye** (those people who) **sākṣāt ātma-prabhavam** (Him from whom comes their birth, or appearance) **īśvaram** (not knowing Him, being ungrateful) **na bhajanti**, **avajānanti** (or, though knowing, under the weight of pride in the dignity of *varṇāśrama* think there is no need to serve Kṛṣṇa and are hostile to Him), (they, devoid of service to Hari, *guru* and the Vaiṣṇavas,) **sthānāt** (from their own *varṇa* and *āśrama*) **bhraṣṭāḥ** (having fallen) **adhaḥ patanti** (go to hell; for mundane *varṇāśrama-dharma* is impermanent, shaken by time, yields only temporary fruits, and is designated by the word *asat*).

*Even the *jñānī* who lacks *bhakti* and thinks himself liberated follows the impure *dharma* of the mind; only the pure devotee follows the pure *dharma* of the soul —*

জ্ঞানী জীবন্মুক্তদশা পাইনু করি' মানে ।
বস্তুতঃ বুদ্ধি 'শুদ্ধ' নহে কৃষ্ণভক্তি বিনে ॥ ২৯ ॥

jñānī jīvan-mukta-daśā pāinu kari' māne
the jñānī of liberation in this life the state "I have attained" thus thinks
vastutaḥ buddhi 'śuddha' nahe kṛṣṇa-bhakti vine
in truth the intelligence pure is not devotion to Kṛṣṇa without

29 The jñānī thinks, 'I have attained the state of liberation in this life (*jīvan-mukti*).' But in truth the intelligence does not become pure without devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Followers of *māyāvāda* and other doctrines call themselves "*jñānīs*." But in truth, without devotion to Kṛṣṇa, the intelligence does not become pure.

Anubhāṣya.

A *jñānī* may think, "Even while living I have been freed from the bonds of worldly existence." Yet without devotion to Kṛṣṇa, in the worship of oneself as

God (*ahaṅgraha-upāsanā*), the intelligence cannot become pure. For the seeker of liberation, knowing his conditioned state, seeks release from it; and knowing the liberated state, he considers himself bound by all visible things outside it. Therefore he cannot get free from the grip of such impermanent conceptions.

*The dry *jñānī* devoid of devotion to Kṛṣṇa falls down — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.32) —*

যেঽন্যেঽরবিন্দাক্ষ বিমুক্তমানিন-
স্ত্বয়্যস্তভাবাদবিশুদ্ধবুদ্ধয়ঃ ।
আরুহ্য কৃচ্ছ্রেণ পরং পদং ততঃ
পতন্ত্যধোঽনাদৃতযুষ্মদঙ্ঘ্রয়ঃ ॥ ৩০ ॥

ye ‘nye ‘ravindākṣa vimukta-māninas
those who others O lotus-eyed Lord who think themselves liberated
tvayy asta-bhāvād aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ
toward You for want of love of impure intelligence
āruhya kṛcchreṇa paraṁ padaṁ tataḥ
having risen with hardship to the supreme position from there
patanty adho ‘nādṛta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ
fall down having neglected Your feet

30 “O lotus-eyed Lord, others think themselves liberated, but their intelligence is impure, for they have no love for You. Though they rise with great hardship to the supreme position, they fall down from there, having neglected Your feet.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.2.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Aravindākṣa, those who boast, “I have become liberated,” are impure in intelligence because they lack devotion to You. With great hardship they ascend to the supreme abode beyond *māyā* — to Brahman — but, disregarding devotion to Bhagavān, they fall down.

Anubhāṣya.

When Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa appeared in the womb of Devakī, imprisoned in Kaṁsa's jail, Brahmā and the other gods praised Bhagavān in the hymn known as the “Garbha-stotra”:

he aravindākṣa (O You whose eyes are like lotus petals), **anye** (non-devotees) **ye vimukta-māninaḥ** (who think, "We are liberated *jñānīs*") **tvayi** (toward You, Bhagavān) **asta-bhāvāt** (because their feeling [*bhāva*] has been cast off and is therefore absent — because they lack *bhakti* and do not serve You) **aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ** (those whose intelligence is not pure; that is, prizing the witch of liberation, they bear in their minds the fault, the impurity and stain of deceit born of knowledge) **kṛcchreṇa** (by much practice of knowledge and renunciation) **paraṁ padam** (in the words of Svāmī, "near to *mokṣa*," that is, the place immediately next to the seat of *mokṣa*) **āruhya** (having ascended) **anādṛta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ** (not honoring Your feet: having disregarded eternal service to Your lotus feet, by that offense they are cut off from the rope of Kṛṣṇa's mercy) **tataḥ** (from there — from the edge of the seat called the highest knowledge) **adhaḥ patanti** (sink into the darkness of ignorance, the gloom of worldly existence).

*Where Kṛṣṇa is seen, *māyā* is not seen; where *māyā* is seen, Kṛṣṇa is not seen —*

কৃষ্ণ — সূর্য্যসম; মায়া হয় অন্ধকার ।
যাঁহা কৃষ্ণ, তাঁহা নাহি মায়ার অধিকার ॥ ৩১ ॥

kṛṣṇa — sūrya-sama; māyā haya andhakāra
Kṛṣṇa like the sun Māyā is darkness
yāṁhā kṛṣṇa, tāṁhā nāhi māyāra adhikāra
where Kṛṣṇa there is no of Māyā dominion

31 Kṛṣṇa is like the sun, and Māyā is darkness. Where Kṛṣṇa is, Māyā has no power.

Anubhāṣya.

In the "Catuḥ-ślokī" of the *Bhāgavatam* it is written: "Whatever appears apart from the Reality and does not appear in the Self, know that to be My *māyā*, like a reflection (*ābhāsa*) and like darkness."[30] As there is no darkness where there is light, so the *jīva*, once turned toward Kṛṣṇa, is freed from the grip of *māyic* desires. *Māyā* swallows the *jñānīs*, the *karmīs* and those with other desires (*anyābhilāṣīs*) — all except Kṛṣṇa's devotees.

*The maidservant *māyā* is ashamed to stand before her Lord, yet she imprisons the one who turns from the Lord by giving him a distorted intelligence (*vivarta-buddhi*) — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.5.13) —*

বিলজ্জমানয়া যস্য স্থাতুমীক্ষাপথেঽমুয়া ।
বিমোহিতা বিকত্থন্তে মমাহমিতি দুর্ধিয়ঃ ॥ ৩২ ॥

vilajjamānayā yasya
ashamed whose
sthātum īkṣā-pathe ‘muyā
to stand in the path of the sight by her
vimohitā vikatthante
bewildered boast
mamāham iti durdhiyaḥ
“mine” and “I” thus the foolish

32 “Māyā is ashamed to stand in the path of His sight; yet the foolish, bewildered by her, boast of ‘I’ and ‘mine’.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.5.13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Māyā is ashamed to stand in the path of Kṛṣṇa's sight. Bewildered by that *māyā*, people of bad intelligence spread many nets of words such as “I” and “mine.”

Anubhāṣya.
Devarṣi Nārada, seeing Brahmā, the grandsire of the worlds, engaged in austerity, asked him whether apart from him there was an independent controller, the Lord of all lords. Brahmā then describes the pastimes of Śrī Hari, the Paramātmā, and how He creates the world and so on through *māyā*:

yasya (of Bhagavān) **īkṣā-pathe** (in the path of His sight) **sthātum vilajjamānayā** (by her who is ashamed, thinking, “This Lord knows my deceit”) **amuyā** (by that *māyā*) **vimohitāḥ** (bewildered) **durdhiyaḥ** (only *jīvas* of bad intelligence, whose knowledge is covered by *avidyā*) **mama aham iti** (thus) **vikatthante** (praise themselves) — “to Him obeisance”: thus it connects with the preceding.

In another reading a verse is quoted here (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.47): “That which is eternally tranquil, fearless, pure consciousness, pure, equal, beyond cause and effect (*sat* and *asat*) — the supreme truth of the Self; where the word with its many case relations, directed toward action, does not operate, and from which

māyā flees, ashamed to stand before it — that indeed is the abode (*pada*) of the Supreme Person, Bhagavān, which they know as Brahman, unending happiness without sorrow." What the sages know as "the great Brahman without attributes (*nirvikalpa*)" is the first perceived feature of the Supreme Person, Bhagavān. That Brahman is full of unending happiness, free from sorrow, eternally tranquil, devoid of distinctions, fearless, consisting of knowledge alone, pure, untouched by objects and senses; it is the supreme truth of the Self. The word of the *karma-kāṇḍa*, which reveals the four kinds of results of action — production and the rest — cannot make Him known,[31] and *māyā* is ashamed to come before Him and flees.

*Only the devotee who has completely offered himself, or who has gained knowledge of *sambandha*, is released from worldly existence —*

'কৃষ্ণ, তোমার হঙ' যদি বলে একবার ।
মায়াবন্ধ হৈতে কৃষ্ণ তারে করে পার ॥ ৩৩ ॥

'kṛṣṇa, tomāra haṅa' yadi bale eka-bāra
"Kṛṣṇa Yours I am" if he says once
māyā-bandha haite kṛṣṇa tāre kare pāra
from the bondage of Māyā Kṛṣṇa him makes carried across

33 If someone says even once, 'Kṛṣṇa, I am Yours', Kṛṣṇa carries him across, beyond the bondage of Māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Some, every day, only with their lips and out of habit, say again and again, "Kṛṣṇa, I am Yours." Their words do not come from the heart (are not sincere). But whoever even once, from the heart — with body, mind and words — says, "O Kṛṣṇa, I am Your servant," Kṛṣṇa carries across the bondage of *māyā*.

*The reassuring words of all-merciful Kṛṣṇa — (*Rāmāyaṇa*, Śrī Rāmacandra's words when Vibhīṣaṇa came to Him) —*

সকৃদেব প্রপন্নো যস্তবাস্মীতি চ যাচতে ।
অভয়ং সর্ব্বদা তস্মৈ দদাম্যেতদ্ব্রতং মম ॥ ৩৪ ॥

sakṛd eva prapanno yas
once only surrendered who
tavāsmīti ca yācate
"I am Yours" thus and begs
abhayaṁ sarvadā tasmai
fearlessness always to him
dadāmy etad vrataṁ mama
I give this vow My

34 "To one who surrenders to Me even once and prays, 'I am Yours', I always grant fearlessness. This is My vow." (Rāmāyaṇa, Yuddha-kāṇḍa, 18.33)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
My vow is this: if anyone truly surrenders and, saying even once, "I am Yours," begs Me for fearlessness, I always grant it to him.

Anubhāṣya.
yaḥ (the person who) **prapannaḥ** (having surrendered) **tava asmi** (I am bound to You by the tie of eternal service) **iti sakṛt eva** (only once) **ca yācate** (humbly begs), **ahaṁ** (I, Bhagavān, the son of Daśaratha) **tasmai sarvadā abhayaṁ dadāmi** — **etat** (this is) **mama vratam** (My vow).

*A man full of desires and without peace attains peace as the fruit of constant *bhajana* —*

মুক্তি-ভুক্তি-সিদ্ধিকামী 'সুবুদ্ধি' যদি হয় ।
গাঢ়-ভক্তিযোগে তবে কৃষ্ণেরে ভজয় ॥ ৩৫ ॥

mukti-bhukti-siddhi-kāmī 'subuddhi' yadi haya
desiring liberation, enjoyment and perfections truly intelligent if he becomes
gāḍha-bhakti-yoge tabe kṛṣṇere bhajaya
by deep bhakti-yoga then Kṛṣṇa he worships

35 If one who desires liberation, worldly enjoyment or mystic perfections becomes truly intelligent, he then worships Kṛṣṇa with deep *bhakti-yoga*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Through bad desires and bad company, desires for liberation (*mukti*), worldly enjoyment (*bhukti*) and mystic perfection (*siddhi*) arise in the *jīva*. But if good intelligence awakens in him through the company of saints, he gives up the thirst for *mukti*, *bhukti* and *siddhi* and worships Kṛṣṇa by the path of deep, pure *bhakti*.

*Every intelligent person should worship Kṛṣṇa — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.3.10) —*

অকামঃ সর্ব্বকামো বা মোক্ষকাম উদারধীঃ ।
তীব্রেণ ভক্তিযোগেন যজেত পুরুষং পরম্ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

akāmaḥ sarva-kāmo vā
without desire full of all desires or
mokṣa-kāma udāra-dhīḥ
desiring liberation of broad intelligence
tīvreṇa bhakti-yogena
with intense bhakti-yoga
yajeta puruṣaṁ param
should worship the Person Supreme

36 "Whether he is without desire, full of every desire, or desirous of liberation, a person of broad intelligence should worship the Supreme Person with intense *bhakti-yoga*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.3.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whether a man was formerly without desires, full of all desires, or desirous of liberation (*mokṣa*) — as soon as his intelligence becomes broad, he will worship the Supreme Person, Kṛṣṇa, by the path of intense (*tīvra*), pure *bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit asked, "What is the duty of a man about to die?" In answer to this question, Śrī Śukadeva says that the *jīva*'s only eternal *dharma* is unmotivated, pure devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and that even for the weak-hearted who are full of desires, the worship of Śrī Hari is enjoined:

sarva-kāmaḥ (one with all desires, stated and unstated) **mokṣa-kāmaḥ** (one who seeks liberation) **akāmaḥ** (the exclusive pure devotee) **vā**, **udāra-dhīḥ** (a person of broad intelligence) **tīvreṇa** (firm — by its very nature unobstructed) **bhakti-**

yogena param (the master of *māyā*) **puruṣam** (the Supreme Person, Puruṣottama) **yajeta** (should serve).

The evidence of Kṛṣṇa's causeless mercy —

অন্যকামী যদি করে কৃষ্ণের ভজন ।
না মাগিলেহ কৃষ্ণ তারে দেন স্ব-চরণ ॥ ৩৭ ॥

anya-kāmī yadi kare kṛṣṇera bhajana
one with other desires if performs Kṛṣṇa's worship
nā māgileha kṛṣṇa tāre dena sva-caraṇa
not even having asked Kṛṣṇa to him gives His own feet

37 If one who has other desires worships Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa gives him His own feet even though he has not asked for them.

কৃষ্ণ কহে, — 'আমা ভজে, মাগে বিষয় সুখ ।
অমৃত ছাড়ি' বিষ মাগে, — এই বড় মূর্খ ॥ ৩৮ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahe, — 'āmā bhaje, māge viṣaya sukha
Kṛṣṇa says Me he worships he asks for sense pleasure
amṛta chāḍi' viṣa māge, — ei baḍa mūrkha
nectar giving up poison he asks for this one a great fool

38 Kṛṣṇa says, 'He worships Me, yet asks for sense pleasure. Giving up nectar, he asks for poison — he is a great fool.

আমি — বিজ্ঞ, এই মূর্খে 'বিষয়' কেনে দিব ?
স্ব-চরণামৃত দিয়া 'বিষয়' ভুলাইব' ॥ ৩৯ ॥

āmi — vijña, ei mūrkhe 'viṣaya' kene diba?
I am wise to this fool sense objects why should I give
sva-caraṇāmṛta diyā 'viṣaya' bhulāiba'
the nectar of My own feet giving sense objects I shall make him forget

39 But I am wise: why should I give sense objects to this fool? I will give him the nectar of My own feet and make him forget sense objects.'

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those who desire *mukti*, *bhukti* and *siddhi* do not seek pure *bhakti*. But if by some good fortune they take up pure service to Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa mercifully grants them *prema*, the fruit of *sādhana-bhakti*, even though at the time they do not aim at it. Kṛṣṇa says: “In the heart of this man, who has just begun *bhajana*, there was a craving for worldly happiness, and a little of it still remains as part of his nature. He has given up the nectar of *prema* and wished for the poison of worldly objects; so he is a great fool. True, through ignorance he could not ask for what is truly good. But I am wise and experienced and know what is good and bad for him. Therefore I will give him the nectar of My feet and make him forget his thirst for the poison of worldly objects.”

*By Kṛṣṇa's mercy even a worshiper with desires comes to desire pure *bhakti*, or becomes free from desires — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.19.26) —*

সত্যং দিশত্যর্থিতমর্থিতো নৃণাং
নৈবার্থদো যৎ পুনরর্থিতা যতঃ ।
স্বয়ং বিধত্তে ভজতামনিচ্ছতা-
মিচ্ছাপিধানং নিজপাদপল্লবম্ ॥ ৪০ ॥

satyaṁ diśaty arthitam arthito nṛṇāṁ
truly He grants what is asked when asked to men
naivārtha-do yat punar arthitā yataḥ
not indeed giver of that which again asking from which
svayaṁ vidhatte bhajatām anicchatām
Himself He grants to those who worship though not desiring
icchā-pidhānaṁ nija-pāda-pallavam
covering all desires His own feet like tender shoots

40 “It is true that when men ask, the Lord grants what they ask for; but He does not give what would make them ask again. To those who worship Him, though they do not desire it, He Himself gives His own feet, tender as new shoots, which put an end to all other desires.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.19.26)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

It is true that Kṛṣṇa, when asked, fulfills people's requests. But He does not give the thing from which requests arise again and again. Some, having other desires, worship His feet, tender as new shoots, without even wishing to obtain them. To them He Himself gives those very feet, which quell all other desires.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Śukadeva recounts to Mahārāja Parīkṣit how the gods sing of the superiority of human birth over all other births and of its necessity, and of the glory of Śrī Hari, who descends among human beings, and of unmotivated, pure devotion to Hari:

(**saḥ hariḥ** — that Hari, by people with desires) **arthitaḥ** (when asked) **nṛṇām** (to people with desires) **arthitam** (what is asked for, the desired object) **diśati** (gives) — this is **satyam** (true). (Yet that Lord, as a rule, for them) **arthadaḥ** (the giver of the supreme goal) **na** (does not become); **yat** (because) **yataḥ** (after which — after the giving — for people with desires) **punaḥ api arthitā** (the request to fulfill desires) **bhavati**. (**tu** — but) **anicchatām** (to those without desires) **bhajatām** (to His servants) **icchā-pidhānam** (that which covers desires and inclinations, that is, fulfills all desires) **svayam eva vidhatte** (He bestows).

*Though some worshipers with desires have bad desires other than pure *bhakti*, by the power of the constant joy of service that evil is destroyed; even so, desire is not the cause of desirelessness —*

কাম লাগি' কৃষ্ণে ভজে, পায় কৃষ্ণ-রসে ।
কাম ছাড়ি' 'দাস' হৈতে হয় অভিলাষে ॥ ৪১ ॥

kāma lāgi' kṛṣṇe bhaje, pāya kṛṣṇa-rase
desire for the sake of Kṛṣṇa he worships he attains the taste of Kṛṣṇa
kāma chāḍi' 'dāsa' haite haya abhilāṣe
desire giving up a servant to become there arises the longing

41 One who worships Kṛṣṇa for the sake of some desire comes to taste Kṛṣṇa's sweetness (*kṛṣṇa-rasa*). Then, giving up that desire, he longs to become His servant.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If someone, for the sake of an ordinary desire, seeks out the worship of Kṛṣṇa and in the company of *sādhus* takes up pure service to Kṛṣṇa, the desire for which he came goes away, and he obtains the taste of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-rasa*). Service to Kṛṣṇa

is so pure that one who takes it up gives up his former desire and longs to become Kṛṣṇa's servant.

*The prayer of Dhruva, full of desires, upon seeing Śrī Hari — (*Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya*, ch. 7, the story of Dhruva, verse 28) —*

স্থানাভিলাষী তপসি স্থিতোঽহং
ত্বাং প্রাপ্তবান্ দেবমুনীন্দ্রগুহ্যম্ ।
কাচং বিচিন্বন্নপি দিব্যরত্নং
স্বামিন্ কৃতার্থোঽস্মি বরং ন যাচে ॥ ৪২ ॥

sthānābhilāṣī tapasi sthito 'haṁ
desiring a position in austerity engaged I
tvāṁ prāptavān deva-munīndra-guhyam
You have attained hidden from the gods and the best of sages
kācaṁ vicinvann api divya-ratnaṁ
glass searching for though a divine jewel
svāmin kṛtārtho 'smi varaṁ na yāce
O Master fulfilled I am a boon not I ask

42 "Desiring a high position, I engaged in austerities, and I have attained You, who are hidden even from the gods and the greatest sages. I was searching for a piece of glass and found a divine jewel. O Master, my purpose is fulfilled; I ask for no boon." (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 7.28)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa wished to give Dhruva a boon, Dhruva said: "Svāmī, I engaged in austerities for You, desiring a high position. But now I have attained You, who are hidden even from the gods and the foremost sages, and my life has found its fulfillment: searching for ordinary glass, I have found a divine jewel! I ask no other boon."

Anubhāṣya.

sthānābhilāṣī (one inclined to desire a position, a high place) **ahaṁ tapasi sthitaḥ**; **he prabho**, **kācaṁ vicinvan** (searching for glass) **divya-ratnam** (like a divine jewel) **deva-munīndra-guhyam** (hidden even from the gods and the

foremost sages, hard to attain) **tvāṁ prāptavān**; **he svāmin ahaṁ kṛtārthaḥ asmi**, **ataḥ anyaṁ varaṁ na yāce** (I do not ask).

*A description of the *jīva* who has *sukṛti* —*

সংসার ভ্রমিতে কোন ভাগ্যে কেহ তরে ।
নদীর প্রবাহে যেন কাষ্ঠ লাগে তীরে ॥ ৪৩ ॥

saṁsāra bhramite kona bhāgye keha tare
in worldly existence while wandering by some fortune someone is delivered
nadīra pravāhe yena kāṣṭha lāge tīre
of a river in the current as a log touches the bank

43 While wandering in worldly existence, someone by some good fortune is delivered, as a log carried by a river's current comes to rest on the bank.

Anubhāṣya.
Countless *jīvas* turned away from Kṛṣṇa wander helplessly through worldly existence, born in higher and lower species. If *sukṛti* arises in one of them, that person reaches the shore by the power of serving the feet of the great souls (*mahat*). Many logs float down a river. Buffeted by the current, one log or another comes to rest on the bank, while the others go on being carried by the stream.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.38.5) —*

মৈবং মমাধমস্যাপি স্যাদেবাচ্যুতদর্শনম্ ।
হ্রিয়মাণঃ কালনদ্যা ক্বচিত্তরতি কশ্চন ॥ ৪৪ ॥

maivaṁ mamādhamasyāpi
not so of me lowly even
syād evācyuta-darśanam
there will be surely the sight of Acyuta
hriyamāṇaḥ kāla-nadyā
being carried away by the river of time
kvacit tarati kaścana
at times crosses over someone

44 “But no — even I, lowly as I am, will surely see Acyuta. For even among those swept along by the river of time, someone at times reaches the shore.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.38.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“I am so low that I will never see Bhagavān” — this fear of mine is false. For even among those carried off by the current of the river of time, some now and then cross the river.

Anubhāṣya.

Devarṣi Nārada, having told (Kaṁsa) of the coming slaying of Kaṁsa and the other deeds (of Kṛṣṇa), departed. Then the great soul Akrūra set out for Gokula to bring Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, and on the way he reflected on his good fortune in being about to see Kṛṣṇa:

(“To see Him, who is praised in the finest verses, will be hard for me” — so I think; or else:) **maivam** (no, not so); **adhamasya** (even of one who is low) **mama acyuta-darśanam syāt eva** (will surely be); (for) **kāla-nadyā hriyamāṇaḥ kaścana kvacit tarati**. (The sense is this: as of the straws and other things carried along by a river some now and then reach the shore, so among the *jīvas* carried along by time under the sway of *karma*, someone may now and then be saved.)

*The conditioned *jīva* attains perfection as the fruit of *sukṛti* turned toward *bhakti* —*

কোন ভাগ্যে কারো সংসার ক্ষয়োন্মুখ হয় ।
সাধুসঙ্গে তরে, কৃষ্ণে রতি উপজয় ॥ ৪৫ ॥

kona bhāgye kāro saṁsāra kṣayonmukha haya
by some fortune someone’s worldly existence near its end becomes
sādhu-saṅge tare, kṛṣṇe rati upajaya
in the company of sādhus he is delivered for Kṛṣṇa attraction arises

45 When by some good fortune someone’s worldly existence nears its end, he is delivered through the company of sādhus, and attraction (*rati*) for Kṛṣṇa awakens in him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

What does the word “fortune” mean here — a mere chance event, or something more? The scriptures of *bhakti* call *sukṛti* “fortune.” *Sukṛti* is of three kinds: *sukṛti* turned toward *bhakti*, *sukṛti* turned toward enjoyment, and *sukṛti* turned toward liberation. Acts that are established as producing pure *bhakti* in this world produce *sukṛti* turned toward *bhakti*. Acts whose fruit is worldly enjoyment give *sukṛti* turned toward enjoyment. Acts whose fruit is liberation (*mokṣa*) produce *sukṛti* turned toward liberation. The *sukṛti* that ends worldly existence and awakens devotion to Kṛṣṇa — the *dharma* of one's true nature (*svarūpa*) — grows strong and becomes ready to bear fruit. Then the devotee is delivered from worldly existence in the company of *sādhus*, and *rati* for Kṛṣṇa arises in him.

*As the fruit of *sukṛti* comes the company of *sādhus*; as its fruit, the beginning of *bhajana*; and then, as the *anarthas* cease, the perfection of *sādhana*, or the attainment of the goal, *prema* for Kṛṣṇa — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.51.53) —*

ভবাপবর্গো ভ্রমতো যদা ভবে-
জ্জনস্য তর্হ্যচ্যুত সৎসমাগমঃ ।
সৎসঙ্গমো যর্হি তদৈব সদ্গতৌ
পরাবরেশে ত্বয়ি জায়তে রতিঃ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

bhavāpavargo bhramato yadā bhavej
the end of worldly existence of one wandering when comes
janasya tarhy acyuta sat-samāgamaḥ
of a person then O Acyuta meeting with the saints
sat-saṅgamo yarhi tadaiva sad-gatau
association with the saints when at that very time for the goal of the saints
parāvareśe tvayi jāyate ratiḥ
for the Lord of the high and the low for You is born attraction

46 “O Acyuta, when a wandering soul’s worldly existence comes to its end, he meets the saints. And when he associates with the saints, attraction (*rati*) is born in him for You, the goal of the saints and the Lord of the high and the low.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.51.53)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Acyuta, when, wandering through the world, the *jīva* reaches the end of that wandering (*apavarga*) and meets saints, then *rati* arises in him for You — the true goal (*sad-gati*) and the Lord of the higher and the lower.

Anubhāṣya.

The demon Kālayavana kicked the sleeping Mucukunda. Mucukunda awoke and glanced at him, and by the power of a boon Mucukunda had earlier received from the gods, the demon was burned to ashes. Then Śrī Kṛṣṇa wished to give Mucukunda a boon, and Mucukunda offers a prayer to Śrī Kṛṣṇa:

he acyuta, **bhramataḥ** (of a person wandering in worldly existence) **yadā** (by Bhagavān's mercy) **bhavāpavargaḥ** (the *apavarga* — the end, the destruction — of *bhava*, worldly existence) **bhavet** (that is, when the time has come), (then) **sat-samāgamaḥ** (the company of *sādhus*) **bhavet**; **yarhi** (when) **sat-saṅgamaḥ hi bhavet**, (then) **eva sad-gatau** (for the eternal supreme abode attained by the best of people) **parāvareśe** (for Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **tvayi ratiḥ** (devotion) **jāyate** (and then the *jīva* is released from worldly existence — this is the sense).

*Only by Kṛṣṇa's grace does one obtain the *guru*'s grace —*

কৃষ্ণ যদি কৃপা করে কোন ভাগ্যবানে ।
গুরু-অন্তর্য্যামি-রূপে শিখায় আপনে ॥ ৪৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa yadi kṛpā kare kona bhāgyavāne
Kṛṣṇa if mercy shows to some fortunate soul
guru-antaryāmi-rūpe śikhāya āpane
in the forms of guru and the Indweller teaches Himself

47 If Kṛṣṇa shows mercy to some fortunate soul, He Himself teaches him in the forms of the guru and the Indweller (*antaryāmī*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Even if no great soul comes to the person mentioned above, who has *sukṛti* turned toward *bhakti*, Kṛṣṇa nonetheless teaches him pure *bhakti* in the form of the *guru* within the heart (*antaryāmī-guru*).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.29.6) —*

নৈবোপয়ন্ত্যপচিতিং কবয়স্তবেশ
ব্রহ্মায়ুষাপি কৃতমৃদ্ধমুদঃ স্মরন্তঃ ।
যোঽন্তর্বহিস্তনুভৃতামশুভং বিধুন্ব-
ন্নাচার্য্যচৈত্ত্যবপুষা স্বগতিং ব্যনক্তি ॥ ৪৮ ॥

naivopayanty apacitiṁ kavayas taveśa
not attain repayment the wise Your, O Lord
brahmāyuṣāpi kṛtam ṛddha-mudaḥ smarantaḥ
with Brahmā's lifespan even Your deeds with growing joy remembering
yo 'ntar bahis tanu-bhṛtām aśubhaṁ vidhunvann
who within without of the embodied the inauspicious dispelling
ācārya-caitya-vapuṣā sva-gatiṁ vyanakti
as ācārya and Supersoul in forms Your own path reveal

48 "O Lord! Even if the wise lived as long as Brahmā and remembered with ever-growing joy all that You have done for them, they could not repay their debt to You. For, dispelling all that is inauspicious in embodied souls, You come to them from without as the ācārya and from within as the Supersoul, and reveal to them the way to Yourself." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.29.6)[5]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.48.

*After *dīkṣā*, as the fruit of knowledge of *sambandha* and of *abhidheya* — the cessation of *anarthas*, taste (*ruci*), attachment (*āsakti*) and the attainment of the goal, *prayojana* —*

সাধুসঙ্গে কৃষ্ণভক্ত্যে শ্রদ্ধা যদি হয় ।
ভক্তিফল 'প্রেম' হয়, সংসার যায় ক্ষয় ॥ ৪৯ ॥

sādhu-saṅge kṛṣṇa-bhaktye śraddhā yadi haya
in the company of sādhus in devotion to Kṛṣṇa faith if arises
bhakti-phala 'prema' haya, saṁsāra yāya kṣaya
the fruit of bhakti prema comes worldly existence goes to its end

49 If, in the company of sādhus, faith in devotion to Kṛṣṇa arises, then prema, the fruit of bhakti, appears, and worldly existence comes to an end.

*The faithful practitioner of *bhakti-yoga* is neither excessively attached nor excessively detached — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.20.8) —*

যদৃচ্ছয়া মৎকথাদৌ জাতশ্রদ্ধস্তু যঃ পুমান্ ।
ন নির্বিণ্ণো নাতিসক্তো ভক্তিযোগোঽস্য সিদ্ধিদঃ ॥ ৫০ ॥

yadṛcchayā mat-kathādau
by good fortune in narrations about Me and the rest
jāta-śraddhas tu yaḥ pumān
in whom faith is born but who the person
na nirviṇṇo nāti-sakto
not disgusted not overly attached
bhakti-yogo 'sya siddhi-daḥ
bhakti-yoga for him gives perfection

50 "For one who by good fortune has come to have faith in narrations about Me and the like, and who is neither disgusted with the world nor overly attached to it, *bhakti-yoga* grants perfection." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.20.8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To the person who by good fortune has gained faith in narrations about Me, who is neither too weary (of the world) nor too attached to it — to him alone *bhakti-yoga* grants perfection, *prema-bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.
Telling Śrī Uddhava about the three kinds of *yoga*, Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa determines who is qualified for *bhakti-yoga*:

yadṛcchayā (by some good fortune) **yaḥ pumān mat-kathādau** (in hearing, chanting and so on — in narrations about Bhagavān) **tu jāta-śraddhaḥ** (and at the same time) **nirviṇṇaḥ** (extremely detached, resorting to false [*phalgu*] renunciation) **na**, **ati-saktaḥ** (excessively absorbed in worldly existence) **ca na**, **asya** (of just such a faithful person) **bhakti-yogaḥ siddhidaḥ** (bestows what is desired).

*Only by the mercy of the *guru* and the Vaiṣṇava, or the *sādhu*, do the *anarthas* cease and pure *bhakti* is attained —*

মহৎ-কৃপা বিনা কোন কর্ম্মে ‘ভক্তি’ নয় ।
কৃষ্ণভক্তি দূরে রহু, সংসার নহে ক্ষয় ॥ ৫১ ॥

mahat-kṛpā vinā kona karme ‘bhakti’ naya
of the great souls the mercy without by any activity bhakti is not
kṛṣṇa-bhakti dūre rahu, saṁsāra nahe kṣaya
devotion to Kṛṣṇa aside let it be worldly existence does not end

51 Without the mercy of great souls no activity yields bhakti. Without it, worldly existence does not even come to an end, let alone devotion to Kṛṣṇa arise.

Anubhāṣya.

No mundane *sukṛti* of the *karma-kāṇḍa* leads to transcendental devotion to Kṛṣṇa. Without the mercy of Kṛṣṇa's devotee, transcendental devotion to Kṛṣṇa has no chance to arise. Let alone devotion to Kṛṣṇa — even worldly existence, the mundane frame of mind, is not destroyed. In no *jīva* other than Kṛṣṇa's devotee can there be greatness (*mahattva*). Kṛṣṇa's devotee alone is transcendental. Though some, with mundane vision, think him “mundane,” in truth only Kṛṣṇa's devotee, who has renounced everything mundane, is incomparably exalted. Whoever recognizes him as the *jīva*'s only desirable well-wisher and begs for his mercy no longer has mundane enjoyment and obtains the right to transcendental service to Kṛṣṇa.

*Without following the *mahat*, or the pure devotee, attaining Kṛṣṇa is extremely difficult — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.12.12) —*

রহূগণৈতৎ তপসা ন যাতি
ন চেজ্যয়া নির্ব্বপণাদগৃহাদ্বা ।
ন চ্ছন্দসা নৈব জলাগ্নিসূর্য্যৈ-
র্ব্বিনা মহৎপাদরজোঽভিষেকম্ ॥ ৫২ ॥

rahūgaṇaitat tapasā na yāti
O Rahūgaṇa this by austerity not is attained
na cejyayā nirvapaṇād gṛhād vā
not and by worship by renunciation by household life or
na cchandasā naiva jalāgni-sūryair
not by the Vedas nor by water, fire and sun
vinā mahat-pāda-rajo-'bhiṣekam
without bathing in the dust of the feet of great souls

52 "O Rahūgaṇa, this is not attained by austerity, by worship, by renunciation or by household duties, nor by the Vedas, nor by worship of water, fire and the sun, without bathing in the dust of the feet of great souls." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.12.12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Rahūgaṇa, without being bathed in the dust of the feet of the great souls (*mahājanas*), devotion to Bhagavān can never be attained — not by austerity, not by Vedic worship and the like, not by observing *sannyāsa*, not by following the *dharma* of a householder, not by reciting the Vedas, nor by (worshiping) water, fire and the sun.

Anubhāṣya.

Rahūgaṇa, king of Sindhu and Sauvīra, heard the science of the Truth from the lips of the *avadhūta* Bharata, who bore the outward marks of a *brāhmaṇa* by birth only (a *dvija-bandhu*). He bowed to Bharata and asked him to explain clearly the hard-to-understand *adhyātma-yoga*. Then Bharata — a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a *paramahaṁsa* in the guise of a *brāhmaṇa* — first told Rahūgaṇa of *avidyā* and of Bhagavān Vāsudeva, the embodiment of pure knowledge, who destroys it, and then describes the means of attaining Bhagavān:

he rahūgaṇa, **mahat-pāda-rajo-'bhiṣekam** (bathing in the dust of the feet of pure devotees of Kṛṣṇa) **vinā** (without) **etat** (this transcendental truth of Bhagavān, Vāsudeva) **tapasā** (by the *dharma* of *vānaprastha*) **na**, **ijyayā** (by Vedic *karma*, that is, by worship of the gods) **ca na**, **nirvapaṇāt** (by giving up the company of women, that is, by *sannyāsa*) **na**, **gṛhāt** (nor by performing the sacrifices of the *gṛhamedhīs*, which are rooted in the company of women) **na**, **chandasā** (by study of the Vedas) **na**, **jalāgni-sūryaiḥ** (by worshiping them) **na yāti** (one does not attain) **eva**.

*Only by the mercy of the *mahat*, or the pure Vaiṣṇava, are the *anarthas* destroyed, and as its fruit the feet of Viṣṇu are attained — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.5.32) —*

নৈষাং মতিস্তাবদুরুক্রমাঙ্ঘ্রিং
স্পৃশত্যনর্থাপগমো যদর্থঃ ।
মহীয়সাং পাদরজোঽভিষেকং
নিষ্কিঞ্চনানাং ন বৃণীত যাবৎ ॥ ৫৩ ॥

naiṣāṁ matis tāvad urukramāṅghriṁ
not their mind so long Urukrama's feet
spṛśaty anarthāpagamo yad-arthaḥ
touches the removal of anarthas whose purpose
mahīyasāṁ pāda-rajo-'bhiṣekaṁ
of the great bathing in the dust of the feet
niṣkiñcanānāṁ na vṛṇīta yāvat
of those who own nothing not accepts as long as

53 "So long as people do not accept a bath in the dust of the feet of the great, who own nothing (*niṣkiñcana*), their minds cannot touch the feet of Urukrama, whose purpose is to remove all *anarthas*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.5.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

As long as people's minds are not bathed in the dust of the feet of Bhagavān's devotees who possess nothing (*niṣkiñcana*), they cannot touch Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, which destroy the *anarthas*.

Anubhāṣya.

Devarṣi Nārada tells Dharmarāja Yudhiṣṭhira the story of Prahlāda. The *mahā-bhāgavata* Prahlāda, answering the question of Hiraṇyakaśipu, king of the Daityas, described the ninefold devotion to Viṣṇu as the only and highest learning and education. Hiraṇyakaśipu then sharply rebuked the *guru*'s sons, Ṣaṇḍa and Amarka. Ṣaṇḍa and Amarka cleared themselves by pointing to Prahlāda's own natural disposition as the cause of his devotion to Viṣṇu. Hiraṇyakaśipu told Prahlāda to explain the cause of such a Vaiṣṇava disposition. Prahlāda said nothing

about it, but speaks of what keeps the *gṛha-vratas*, hostile to devotion to Viṣṇu, in bondage, and of the means of their release:

niṣkiñcanānām (of those who have cast off all conceit connected with worldly objects) **mahīyasām** (of the greatest, the Vaiṣṇavas) **pāda-rajo-'bhiṣekam** (bathing, smearing with the dust of the feet) **yāvat na vṛṇīta** (they do not accept), **tāvat** (so long, for these *gṛha-vratas* — though He is known to them from the words of *śruti* —) **matiḥ** (the inclination) **urukramāṅghrim** (the feet of Urukrama) **na spṛśati** (does not touch — does not reach; that is, it is struck down by disbelief [*asambhāvanā*] and the like); **anarthāpagamaḥ** (the *apagama*, destruction, of the *anartha*, that is, of evil attachment [*asad-avagraha*] — worldly existence, which obstructs the touch of His feet) **yad-arthaḥ** (the fruit of that disposition which touches His feet; the sense: without the grace of the *mahat* they have neither firm realization of the truth nor liberation).

*Only as the fruit of association with an awakened soul (*cetana*), even for half a moment, does the *jīva*'s spiritual function — service to Kṛṣṇa — awaken and the goal is attained —*

'সাধুসঙ্গ', 'সাধুসঙ্গ' — সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কয়।
লবমাত্র সাধুসঙ্গে সর্ব্বসিদ্ধি হয় ॥ ৫৪ ॥

'sādhu-saṅga', 'sādhu-saṅga' — sarva-śāstre kaya
sādhu-saṅga sādhu-saṅga all the scriptures declare
lava-mātra sādhu-saṅge sarva-siddhi haya
a mere moment of sādhu-saṅga all perfection comes

54 'The company of sādhus, the company of sādhus!' — so declare all the scriptures. Even a moment of *sādhu-saṅga* brings every perfection.

Anubhāṣya.
A *lava* is the time of a blink (*nimeṣa*); eleven and a quarter (11¼) *lavas* make one second.

*The glory of the company of *sādhus* — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.18.13) —*

তুলয়াম লবেনাপি ন স্বর্গং নাপুনর্ভবম্।
ভগবৎসঙ্গিসঙ্গস্য মর্ত্ত্যানাং কিমুতাশিষঃ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

tulayāma lavenāpi
we compare with a moment even
na svargaṁ nāpunar-bhavam
not heaven not liberation
bhagavat-saṅgi-saṅgasya
of association with those who associate with the Lord
martyānāṁ kim utāśiṣaḥ
of mortals what then the blessings

55 "We would not compare even heaven or liberation with a single moment in the company of those who are ever with the Lord — what then of the blessings mortals seek?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.18.13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The boundless good that comes to the *jīva* through the company of those who associate with Bhagavān cannot be compared in the slightest with heaven or liberation (*mokṣa*), to say nothing of gaining a kingdom and the like.

Anubhāṣya.
The sages headed by Śaunaka, mentioning their own futile labor in the trifling *karma-kāṇḍa* — sacrifices and the like — describe the glory of association with Sūta, the *mahā-bhāgavata* who recites narrations about Hari:

(**he sūta**,) **bhagavat-saṅgi-saṅgasya** (of association with Hari's servant, who associates with Bhagavān) **lavena** (even with the tiniest moment) **svargam** (the place of exemplary happiness and enjoyment) **na tulayāma** (we do not consider equal), **apunarbhavam** (nor liberation, *mokṣa*) **na** (do we equate); **martyānām** (of mundane gods, *brāhmaṇas*, kings and the like) **āśiṣaḥ** (the most trifling blessings — wealth, power and so on) **kim uta** (what to speak of them — them we certainly do not equate).

*The teaching of the *Gītā* —*

কৃষ্ণ কৃপালু অর্জ্জুনেরে লক্ষ্য করিয়া ।
জগতেরে রাখিয়াছেন উপদেশ দিয়া ॥ ৫৬ ॥

kṛṣṇa kṛpālu arjunere lakṣya kariyā
Kṛṣṇa merciful Arjuna the aim making
jagatere rākhiyāchena upadeśa diyā
the world has protected instruction giving

56 Addressing Arjuna, merciful Kṛṣṇa protected the whole world with this instruction:

সর্ব্বগুহ্যতমং ভূয়ঃ শৃণু মে পরমং বচঃ ।
ইষ্টোঽসি মে দৃঢ়মিতি ততো বক্ষ্যামি তে হিতম্ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

sarva-guhyatamaṁ bhūyaḥ
the most secret of all again
śṛṇu me paramaṁ vacaḥ
hear My supreme word
iṣṭo 'si me dṛḍham iti
dear you are to Me very thus
tato vakṣyāmi te hitam
therefore I shall speak to you your good

57 "Hear again My supreme word, the most secret of all. You are very dear to Me, and therefore I shall tell you what is for your good." (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.64)

*Every action should be done for the sake of attaining Kṛṣṇa — (*Bhagavad-gītā* 18.64–65) —*

মন্মনা ভব মদ্ভক্তো মদ্যাজী মাং নমস্কুরু ।
মামেবৈষ্যসি সত্যং তে প্রতিজানে প্রিয়োঽসি মে ॥ ৫৮ ॥

man-manā bhava mad-bhakto
with mind fixed on Me be My devotee
mad-yājī māṁ namaskuru
worshipping Me to Me bow down
mām evaiṣyasi satyaṁ te
to Me surely you will come truly to you
pratijāne priyo 'si me
I promise dear you are to Me

58 "Fix your mind on Me, be My devotee, worship Me and bow down to Me. You will surely come to Me — truly I promise you this, for you are dear to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.65)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
(O Arjuna,) you are most intimately My own; therefore, for your welfare, I give you the most confidential, the best of all instructions: think of Me, become My devotee, worship Me and surrender to Me — then you will surely attain Me. You are very dear to Me; that is why I have spoken to you these words of My vow.

Anubhāṣya.
he arjuna, **me** (My) **sarva-guhyatamam** (most confidential) **paramaṁ vacaḥ** (word) **bhūyaḥ** (again) **śṛṇu**; (for) **me** (to Me) **dṛḍham** (very) **iṣṭaḥ** (dear) **asi**, **tataḥ** (for that reason) **te** (to you) **hitam** (what is good) **vakṣyāmi** (I shall tell): (you) **man-manāḥ** (with your mind on Me) **mad-bhaktaḥ** (devoted to serving Me) **mad-yājī** (devoted to worshiping Me) **bhava**, **mām** (giving up the other, mundane gods — Me alone, the transcendental, in the form of Kṛṣṇa) **namaskuru**; (living thus, by My grace, through pure *bhakti*) **mām eva eṣyasi** (you will attain — have no doubt about it); **tvaṁ hi me priyaḥ asi**, (therefore) **satyam** (so that it will surely come true) **te** (to you) **ahaṁ pratijāne** (I make a promise).

*Earlier *karma*, *yoga*, *jñāna* and the rest were spoken of as the *abhidheya*, but the final command is devotion to Kṛṣṇa: it alone is the *abhidheya* and the injunction —*

পূর্ব্ব আজ্ঞা, — বেদ-ধর্ম্ম, কর্ম্ম, যোগ, জ্ঞান ।
সব সাধি' অবশেষ-আজ্ঞা — বলবান্ ॥ ৫৯ ॥

pūrva ājñā, — veda-dharma, karma, yoga, jñāna
the earlier commands Vedic dharma karma yoga jñāna
saba sādhi' avaśeṣa-ājñā — balavān
all having established the final command is strongest

59 His earlier commands concerned Vedic *dharma*, karma, yoga and jñāna. Having established all of these, He gave His final command, and it is the strongest.

*The endeavor to worship Kṛṣṇa, giving up all *dharmas* —*

এই আজ্ঞাবলে ভক্তের 'শ্রদ্ধা' যদি হয় ।
সর্ব্বকর্ম্ম ত্যাগ করি' সে কৃষ্ণেরে ভজয় ॥ ৬০ ॥

ei ājñā-bale bhaktera 'śraddhā' yadi haya
of this by the force of the command in the devotee faith if arises
sarva-karma tyāga kari' se kṛṣṇere bhajaya
all activities giving up having made he Kṛṣṇa worships

60 If by the force of this command faith arises in the devotee, he gives up all other activities and worships Kṛṣṇa.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.20.9) —*

তাবৎ কর্ম্মাণি কুর্ব্বীত ন নির্ব্বিদ্যেত যাবতা ।
মৎকথাশ্রবণাদৌ বা শ্রদ্ধা যাবন্ন জায়তে ॥ ৬১ ॥

tāvat karmāṇi kurvīta
so long duties one should perform
na nirvidyeta yāvatā
not one becomes weary as long as
mat-kathā-śravaṇādau vā
in hearing My narrations and the rest or
śraddhā yāvan na jāyate
faith as long as not is born

61 "One should go on performing one's prescribed duties only so long as one has not grown weary of them, or so long as faith has not been born in

hearing about Me and the like." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.20.9)[6]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 9.266.

*The definition of *śraddhā* —*

'শ্রদ্ধা'-শব্দে — বিশ্বাস কহে সুদৃঢ় নিশ্চয়।
কৃষ্ণে ভক্তি কৈলে সর্ব্বকর্ম্ম কৃত হয় ॥ ৬২ ॥

'śraddhā'-śabde — viśvāsa kahe sudṛḍha niścaya
by the word "śraddhā" trust is meant very firm conviction
kṛṣṇe bhakti kaile sarva-karma kṛta haya
to Kṛṣṇa devotion when one renders all duties done become

62 The word *śraddhā* means trust: a very firm conviction that by rendering devotion to Kṛṣṇa one has fulfilled all one's duties.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Firm, unwavering faith that "by serving Kṛṣṇa with *bhakti* one performs all *karma*" is called *śraddhā*, which grants the right to *bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.
Firm, unwavering faith is called *śraddhā*. One who serves Kṛṣṇa need not perform any of the duties of the mundane realm — paying off the debts to the forefathers, to living beings, to the gods and the like. *Karma* is merely the ritual activity of the conditioned *jīva* aimed at enjoyment. When devotion to Bhagavān awakens, one need not strive for the fruits of *karma*. The best thing to be gained from the fruits of *karma* — "renunciation" (*vairāgya*) — always accompanies the devotee of itself.

*By worshiping Kṛṣṇa all worship is accomplished — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*

4.31.14) —

যথা তরোর্ম্মূলনিষেচনেন
তৃপ্যন্তি তৎস্কন্ধভুজোপশাখাঃ ৷
প্রাণোপহারাচ্চ যথেন্দ্রিয়াণাং
তথৈব সর্ব্বার্হণমচ্যুতেজ্যা ॥ ৬৩ ॥

yathā taror mūla-niṣecanena
as of a tree by watering the root
tṛpyanti tat-skandha-bhujopaśākhāḥ
are satisfied its trunk, branches and twigs
prāṇopahārāc ca yathendriyāṇāṁ
by feeding the life-breath and as of the senses
tathaiva sarvārhaṇam acyutejyā
just so the worship of all is the worship of Acyuta

63 "As by watering the root of a tree its trunk, branches and twigs are all nourished, and as by feeding the life-breath (*prāṇa*) all the senses are satisfied, so the worship of Acyuta is the worship of all." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 4.31.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When the root of a tree is watered, its trunk, branches, twigs and all the rest are satisfied. When the *prāṇa* is satisfied, all the senses are satisfied. In the same way, by worshiping Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the worship of all the gods is accomplished.

Anubhāṣya.
The Pracetās, sons of Prajāpati Dakṣa,[32] saw their *gurudeva*, Devarṣi Śrī Nārada, and asked him to speak to them again about the truth of the Self, that is, about Śrī Hari. Then Śrī Nārada describes the glory of Śrī Hari, the Soul of all beings:

yathā taroḥ (of a tree) **mūla-niṣecanena** (by watering, pouring water at its base) **tat-skandha-bhujopaśākhāḥ** (all the parts of the tree, from the trunk to the leaves and flowers) **tṛpyanti** (are satisfied — not by watering each of them separately without watering the root), (as) **prāṇopahārāt** (by offering to the *prāṇa*, by eating) **indriyāṇāṁ ca tṛptiḥ** (and not by smearing food separately on each sense), **tathā acyutejyā** (the worship of Bhagavān Viṣṇu) **eva sarvārhaṇam** (the worship of all the gods; the sense: there is no need to worship them separately).

*Determining the right to *bhakti* (the three kinds of devotees' right) and its varieties —*

শ্রদ্ধাবান্ জন হয় ভক্তি-অধিকারী ।
'উত্তম', 'মধ্যম', 'কনিষ্ঠ' — শ্রদ্ধা-অনুসারী ॥ ৬৪ ॥

śraddhāvān jana haya bhakti-adhikārī
having faith a person is qualified for bhakti
'uttama', 'madhyama', 'kaniṣṭha' — śraddhā-anusārī
highest middle lowest according to faith

64 A person who has faith is qualified for bhakti. According to his faith he is of the highest, the middle or the lowest level (*uttama*, *madhyama*, *kaniṣṭha*).

Anubhāṣya.
"One who has *śraddhā*" (*śraddhāvān*) is a person with firm, unwavering faith in Kṛṣṇa — the true Reality, the eternal Truth, the highest goal (*paramārtha*). He alone has the right to *bhakti*. Whether a devotee's right (*adhikāra*) is highest, middle or lowest depends on how firm and unwavering his faith is.

*(1) The definition of the *uttama-adhikārī* —*

শাস্ত্রযুক্ত্যে সুনিপুণ, দৃঢ়শ্রদ্ধা যাঁর ।
'উত্তম অধিকারী' সেই তারয় সংসার ॥ ৬৫ ॥

śāstra-yuktye sunipuṇa, dṛḍha-śraddhā yāṁra
in scripture and reasoning very expert firm faith whose
'uttama adhikārī' sei tāraya saṁsāra
of the highest qualification he delivers the world

65 One who is expert in scripture and reasoning and whose faith is firm is an *uttama adhikārī*, of the highest qualification; he delivers the world.

Anubhāṣya.
(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva-vibhāga, second *laharī*, description of *vaidhī-bhakti*, verse 11.) Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmipāda wrote: "One who is expert in the scriptures and in reasoning, firmly convinced in every way, and has mature faith is considered the highest (*uttama*) in the right to *bhakti*." Only a person

of such mature faith — "skilled in the scriptures of *bhakti* and adept with firm arguments in refuting other paths" — is an *uttama-adhikārī* among devotees.

শাস্ত্র-যুক্তি নাহি জানে দৃঢ়, শ্রদ্ধাবান্ ।
'মধ্যম-অধিকারী' সেই মহা-ভাগ্যবান্ ॥ ৬৬ ॥

śāstra-yukti nāhi jāne dṛḍha, śraddhāvān
the reasoning of scripture not knows firmly having faith
'madhyama-adhikārī' sei mahā-bhāgyavān
of middle qualification he greatly fortunate

66 One who does not firmly know the reasoning of scripture but has faith is a *madhyama adhikārī*, of the middle qualification; he is most fortunate.

*(3) The definition of the *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī* —*

যাহার কোমল শ্রদ্ধা, সে — 'কনিষ্ঠ' জন ।
ক্রমে ক্রমে তেঁহো ভক্ত হইবে 'উত্তম' ॥ ৬৭ ॥

yāhāra komala śraddhā, se — 'kaniṣṭha' jana
whose tender faith he a kaniṣṭha person
krame krame teṁho bhakta haibe 'uttama'
step by step step by step he a devotee will become of the highest

67 One whose faith is still tender is a *kaniṣṭha*, a beginner. Step by step he too will become a devotee of the highest level.

On the gradations of devotees —

রতি-প্রেম-তারতম্যে ভক্ত — তর-তম ।
একাদশ স্কন্ধে তার করিয়াছে লক্ষণ ॥ ৬৮ ॥

rati-prema-tāratamye bhakta — tara-tama
by the degree of rati and prema devotees higher and highest
ekādaśa skandhe tāra kariyāche lakṣaṇa
in the eleventh canto their has been given description

68 According to the degree of their *rati* and prema, devotees stand at different levels. The Eleventh Canto has described their characteristics.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

As stated above, one in whose heart *śraddhā* has arisen has the right to *bhakti*. Those who have *śraddhā* are of three kinds: “highest” (*uttama*), “middle” (*madhyama*) and “lowest” (*kaniṣṭha*). One who is expert in scripture and reasoning and firm in faith is an *uttama-adhikārī*. One who does not know the firm arguments of scripture yet has faith is a *madhyama-adhikārī*. One whose faith has not become firm is a *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī*. This threefold division is not merely a division of devotees; it divides the persons qualified for pure *bhakti*. One whose faith is weak (*kaniṣṭha-śraddha*) believes only this much: “Devotion to Kṛṣṇa is good.” But he does not know what pure devotion to Kṛṣṇa is, or what the method established by the marginal characteristics (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*) of *bhakti* is. Therefore in the hearts of those whose faith is tender (*komala*) an admixture of *jñāna* and *karma* is found. As soon as that admixture disappears, the practitioner becomes a *madhyama-adhikārī*. And when the faith of the *madhyama-adhikārī* is made firm by scripture and reasoning, he will become an *uttama-adhikārī*. Thus far the right to *bhakti* has been determined. Now (the Lord) divides the devotees themselves: by degree of *rati* and *prema* — “devotee,” “greater devotee” and “greatest devotee.” Such is the threefold division.

Anubhāṣya.

In the same place, in verse 12, Śrī Rūpapāda wrote: “One who is not so expert in the scriptures and so on but has faith is middle (*madhyama*). And one whose faith is tender is called lowest (*kaniṣṭha*).” The middle devotee has faith but is not so skilled in the purport of the scriptures and so on, and one whose faith is tender (*komala*) is a *kaniṣṭha*. The *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī*, through association with non-devotees, may fall away from his tender faith in Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet. The *madhyama-adhikārī*, though by the purport of the scriptures he cannot at once be free from the bad results of association with non-devotees, gains firmness by the power of the scriptures and of the company of Hari's servants. Association with non-devotees can in no way harm the faith of the *uttama-adhikārī*. As faith grows, the devotee's right (*adhikāra*) rises.

Anubhāṣya.

Rati varies in degree according to the measure of faith of the *vaidhī* devotee in whom taste (*ruci*) has not yet arisen; (the faith of a devotee in whom taste has

arisen is itself called *rati*). According to the degree of *rati*, the *rasa* of *prema-bhakti* also varies. In the Eleventh Canto, in the dialogue between Śrī Bhagavān and Uddhava, the right (*adhikāra*) of the devotee is described.

*The characteristics of the *uttama-bhakta*, or *mahā-bhāgavata* — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.45–47) —*

সর্ব্বভূতেষু যঃ পশ্যেদ্ভগবদ্ভাবমাত্মনঃ ।
ভূতানি ভগবত্যাত্মন্যেষ ভাগবতোত্তমঃ ॥ ৬৯ ॥

sarva-bhūteṣu yaḥ paśyed
in all beings who sees
bhagavad-bhāvam ātmanaḥ
of the Lord the presence of the Self
bhūtāni bhagavaty ātmany
the beings in the Lord in the Self
eṣa bhāgavatottamaḥ
he the best of devotees

69 "One who sees the Lord, the Soul of all, present in all beings, and sees all beings in the Lord, is the best of devotees (*bhāgavatottama*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.45)[7]

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 8.275.[33]

*The characteristics of the *madhyama-bhakta* —*

ঈশ্বরে তদধীনেষু বালিশেষু দ্বিষৎসু চ ।
প্রেম-মৈত্রী-কৃপোপেক্ষা যঃ করোতি স মধ্যমঃ ॥ ৭০ ॥

īśvare tad-adhīneṣu
to the Lord to those dependent on Him
bāliśeṣu dviṣatsu ca
to the ignorant to the hostile and
prema-maitrī-kṛpopekṣā
love, friendship, mercy and indifference
yaḥ karoti sa madhyamaḥ
who shows he is of the middle level

70 "One who shows love for the Lord, friendship for those who depend on Him, mercy to the ignorant and indifference to the hostile is a devotee of the middle level (*madhyama*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.46)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The devotee who has *prema* for Īśvara, friendship for the devotees, mercy for the ignorant and indifference toward the hostile is a *madhyama-bhakta*.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Nārada, glorifying *bhāgavata-dharma* before Vasudeva, recounts the dialogue between Nimi, the king of Videha, and the nine Yogendras. Nimi asked about the characteristics and conduct of the three kinds of devotees, or *bhāgavatas*, and in answer one of the nine Yogendras, the sage Havi, said:

yaḥ īśvare (toward Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **premāṇaṁ karoti** (has *prema*), **tad-adhīneṣu** (toward Bhagavān's devotees — *uttama-*, *madhyama-* and *kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*) **maitrīm** (friendship — fitting intimacy: service, obeisances, respect and so on) **karoti**, **bāliśeṣu** (toward those ignorant of *bhakti*) **kṛpāṁ karoti**, **dviṣatsu** (toward people hostile to Bhagavān and the *bhāgavatas*) **upekṣāṁ karoti** (shows indifference — that is, avoids their company in every way), **saḥ** (such a *bhāgavata*) **madhyamaḥ** (is called *madhyama*, because he sees such distinctions).

*The characteristics of the *kaniṣṭha-bhakta* —*

অর্চ্চায়ামেব হরয়ে পূজাং যঃ শ্রদ্ধয়েহতে ৷
ন তদ্ভক্তেষু চান্যেষু স ভক্তঃ প্রাকৃতঃ স্মৃতঃ ॥ ৭১ ॥

arcāyām eva haraye
in the Deity only to Hari
pūjāṁ yaḥ śraddhayehate
worship who with faith performs
na tad-bhakteṣu cānyeṣu
not to His devotees and to others
sa bhaktaḥ prākṛtaḥ smṛtaḥ
he a devotee on the worldly level is considered

71 “One who with faith worships Hari only in the Deity, but does not honour His devotees or others, is known as a *prākṛta* devotee, one still on the worldly level.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.47)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Someone worships Hari in the form of the *arcā-mūrti* with faith handed down to him by tradition — by worldly and family custom. But since he has not understood the truth of pure *bhakti* through the study of scripture, he does not honor Hari's devotees. He is a *prākṛta-bhakta*, that is, one who has only begun the path of *bhakti*. He may be called “almost a devotee” (*bhakta-prāya*) or “a semblance of a Vaiṣṇava” (*vaiṣṇava-ābhāsa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The purport is this. When the devotee is able to have “*prema*” for Īśvara, “friendship” for the devotees, “mercy” for the ignorant and “indifference” toward those hostile to Bhagavān and hostile to Bhagavān's devotees,[26] he is counted as a pure devotee among the *madhyama-bhaktas*. Then, as he goes on with *bhajana*, he comes to see in all beings Bhagavān related to himself, and in Bhagavān, the true nature of his soul, the presence of all beings. Then he no longer makes distinctions in his attitude toward Īśvara, those dependent on Him, the ignorant and the hostile. In that state he is called a *bhāgavatottama*.

Anubhāṣya.
yaḥ haraye (to Bhagavān — having offered himself to the *guru*) **arcāyām** (in the Śrī Vigraha) **śraddhayā** (having received *dīkṣā* — with mixed *bhakti*, with a semblance of *bhakti* [*bhakty-ābhāsa*], according to the rules of the Pañcarātra) **pūjām īhate** (performs), **tad-bhakteṣu** (to Hari's servants) **pūjāṁ na** (does not perform — because he does not know the gradations of devotees) **anyeṣu ca** (and toward others — that is, he also avoids the company of those averse to

Hari), **saḥ bhaktaḥ prākṛtaḥ** (a *kaniṣṭha*, resembling a Vaiṣṇava — that is, not pure) **smṛtaḥ** (is called).

The pure devotee is adorned with all of Kṛṣṇa's qualities —

সর্ব্ব মহা-গুণগণ বৈষ্ণব-শরীরে ।
কৃষ্ণভক্তে কৃষ্ণের গুণ, সকলি সঞ্চারে ॥ ৭২ ॥

sarva mahā-guṇa-gaṇa vaiṣṇava-śarīre
all the great qualities in the person of a Vaiṣṇava
kṛṣṇa-bhakte kṛṣṇera guṇa, sakali sañcāre
into Kṛṣṇa's devotee Kṛṣṇa's qualities all pass

72 All great qualities dwell in a Vaiṣṇava; all of Kṛṣṇa's qualities pass into His devotee.

Anubhāṣya.
The devotee's only object of worship is Śrī Bhagavān Viṣṇu, and Bhagavān's qualities are the property of the devotee alone. All of Bhagavān's qualities pass into the pure devotee.

*The pure Vaiṣṇava has all great qualities, and the non-Vaiṣṇava has no qualities at all — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.18.12) —*

যস্যাস্তি ভক্তির্ভগবত্যকিঞ্চনা
সর্ব্বৈর্গুণৈস্তত্র সমাসতে সুরাঃ ।
হরাবভক্তস্য কুতো মহদ্গুণা
মনোরথেনাসতি ধাবতো বহিঃ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

yasyāsti bhaktir bhagavaty akiñcanā
in whom there is devotion to the Lord free of desire
sarvair guṇais tatra samāsate surāḥ
with all qualities there dwell the gods
harāv abhaktasya kuto mahad-guṇā
to Hari of one not devoted whence great qualities
mano-rathenāsati dhāvato bahiḥ
by the chariot of the mind toward the unreal running outward

73 “In one whose devotion to the Lord is free of desire all the gods dwell, and with them every virtue. But how can great qualities be found in one who is not devoted to Hari? Driven by his desires, his mind is forever running outward after what is passing.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.18.12)[8]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Śuka tells Parīkṣit how the ruler of a *varṣa* named Bhadraśravā and his followers sing the glories of Bhagavān Śrī Nṛsiṁha and His pure devotees.[34] See Ādi 8.58.

A description of the twenty-six qualities, or characteristics, of a Vaiṣṇava —

সেই সব গুণ হয় বৈষ্ণব-লক্ষণ ।
সব কহা না যায়, করি দিগ্‌দরশন ॥ ৭৪ ॥

sei saba guṇa haya vaiṣṇava-lakṣaṇa
those all qualities are the marks of a Vaiṣṇava
saba kahā nā yāya, kari dig-daraśana
all to tell not possible I give an indication

74 All these qualities are the marks of a Vaiṣṇava. They cannot all be told, so I shall only point to some of them.

*Of these, the *svarūpa* (essential) characteristic is having Kṛṣṇa as one's only refuge; all the rest are *taṭastha* (marginal) characteristics —*

কৃপালু, অকৃতদ্রোহ, সত্যসার, সম ।
নির্দ্দোষ, বদান্য, মৃদু, শুচি, অকিঞ্চন ॥ ৭৫ ॥

kṛpālu, akṛta-droha, satya-sāra, sama
merciful harming no one devoted to truth equal to all
nirdoṣa, vadānya, mṛdu, śuci, akiñcana
faultless magnanimous gentle pure owning nothing

75 A Vaiṣṇava is merciful, harms no one, is devoted to truth, equal to all, faultless, magnanimous, gentle, pure and without possessions (*akiñcana*);

সর্ব্বোপকারক, শান্ত, কৃষ্ণৈকশরণ ।
অকাম, নিরীহ, স্থির, বিজিত-ষড়্গুণ ॥ ৭৬ ॥

sarvopakāraka, śānta, kṛṣṇaika-śaraṇa
benefactor of all peaceful having Kṛṣṇa as the only shelter
akāma, nirīha, sthira, vijita-ṣaḍ-guṇa
without desire free from worldly striving steady having conquered the six

76 he is a benefactor of all, peaceful, with Kṛṣṇa as his only shelter, free from desire, free from worldly striving, steady, the conqueror of the six (*ṣaḍ-guṇa*);

মিতভুক্ অপ্রমত্ত, মানদ, অমানী ।
গম্ভীর, করুণ, মৈত্র, কবি, দক্ষ, মৌনী ॥ ৭৭ ॥

mita-bhuk apramatta, mānada, amānī
moderate in eating sober giving honor to others seeking no honor
gambhīra, karuṇa, maitra, kavi, dakṣa, maunī
grave compassionate friendly a poet expert silent

77 he is moderate in eating, sober, giving honour to others while seeking none for himself, grave, compassionate, friendly, a poet, expert and sparing in speech.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The qualities from “merciful” to “silent” are the special characteristics of a Vaiṣṇava.

*The evidence — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.25.21) —*

তিতিক্ষবঃ কারুণিকাঃ সুহৃদঃ সর্ব্বদেহিনাম্ ।
অজাতশত্রবঃ শান্তাঃ সাধবঃ সাধুভূষণাঃ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

titikṣavaḥ kāruṇikāḥ
tolerant compassionate
suhṛdaḥ sarva-dehinām
well-wishers of all embodied beings
ajāta-śatravaḥ śāntāḥ
with no enemies peaceful
sādhavaḥ sādhu-bhūṣaṇāḥ
following the scriptures adorned with saintliness

78 “The sādhus are tolerant and compassionate, well-wishers of all embodied beings. They have no enemies and are peaceful; they follow the scriptures, and saintly conduct is their ornament.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sādhus are tolerant, compassionate, well-wishers of all *jīvas*, without enemies, peaceful, and goodness is their ornament.

Anubhāṣya.
When the sages headed by Śaunaka asked about the pastimes of Bhagavān Kapiladeva, the *mahā-bhāgavata* Sūta describes to them the truth of the Self and the dialogue between Bhagavān Kapila and Devahūti, which the venerable Maitreya, Vyāsa's friend, once related to Vidura. Kapiladeva calls attachment to the unreal (*asad-vastu*) the cause of the *jīva*'s bondage and attachment to the real (*sad-vastu*) the door to liberation, and he speaks first of the “marginal” (*taṭastha*) and then of the “essential” (*svarūpa*) characteristics of the *sādhus*, who are the *sad-vastu*:

(He states the characteristics of *sādhus*:) **titikṣavaḥ** (tolerant) **kāruṇikāḥ** (with hearts softened by compassion) **sarva-dehinām** (of all *jīvas*) **suhṛdaḥ** (close friends) **ajāta-śatravaḥ** (without enmity toward anyone) **śāntāḥ** (free from desires) **sādhu-bhūṣaṇāḥ** (those whose ornament is *sādhu*, that is, good character) **sādhavaḥ** (who follow the scriptures).

*Only by serving the *mahat*, or the Vaiṣṇavas, is one freed from *māyā*, while serving those who associate with women leads to the bondage of worldly*

*existence, or to hell — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.5.2) —*

মহৎসেবাং দ্বারমাহুর্ব্বিমুক্তে-
স্তমোদ্বারং যোষিতাং সঙ্গিসঙ্গম্ ৷
মহান্তস্তে সমচিত্তাঃ প্রশান্তাঃ
বিমন্যবঃ সুহৃদঃ সাধবো যে ॥ ৭৯ ॥

mahat-sevāṁ dvāram āhur vimuktes
service to the great the door they call of liberation
tamo-dvāraṁ yoṣitāṁ saṅgi-saṅgam
the door to darkness of those attached to women the company
mahāntas te sama-cittāḥ praśāntāḥ
the great they equal-minded peaceful
vimanyavaḥ suhṛdaḥ sādhavo ye
free from anger well-wishers saintly who

79 "Service to the great is called the door to liberation, and the company of those attached to women the door to darkness. The great are those who are equal-minded, peaceful, free from anger, well-wishers of all and saintly." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.5.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The wise have called service to the great souls (*mahat*) the door to liberation, and the company of those attached to women the door to darkness. *Sādhus* are people of great resolve, equal-minded, deeply peaceful, free from anger and well-wishers of all.

Anubhāṣya.
Once Bhagavān Ṛṣabhadeva, the father of the royal sage Bharata, having come to Brahmāvarta, spoke of *mokṣa-dharma* and the *dharma* of the *paramahaṁsas* to his sons, who were listening to instructions in the presence of the sages:

(The knowers of the Truth) **mahat-sevām** (service to the Vaiṣṇavas) **vimukteḥ** (of release from the bonds of worldly existence) **dvāram** (the cause) **āhuḥ** (call); **yoṣitāṁ saṅgi-saṅgam** (association with those who associate with women — with enjoyers of worldly objects) **tamo-dvāram** (the door — the cause — of worldly existence or of hell, they call); (among these) **ye sama-cittāḥ** (the wise, who see all equally) **praśāntāḥ** (pure-hearted) **vimanyavaḥ** (free from anger) **suhṛdaḥ** (close

friends) **sādhavaḥ** (who do not see faults in others), **te mahāntaḥ** (should be known as great).

*A description of the glory of the company of *sādhus*; only as the fruit of the company of *sādhus* is service to Kṛṣṇa attained —*

কৃষ্ণভক্তি-জন্মমূল হয় 'সাধুসঙ্গ' ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেম জন্মে, তিঁহো পুনঃ মুখ্য অঙ্গ ॥ ৮০ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhakti-janma-mūla haya 'sādhu-saṅga'
of the birth of devotion to Kṛṣṇa the root is sādhu-saṅga
kṛṣṇa-prema janme, tiṁho punaḥ mukhya aṅga
love for Kṛṣṇa is born it again the principal limb

80 The root from which devotion to Kṛṣṇa is born is *sādhu-saṅga*. And even when love for Kṛṣṇa is born, *sādhu-saṅga* remains its principal limb.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The company of *sādhus* is the original root from which devotion to Kṛṣṇa is born. Yet even when *prema* for Kṛṣṇa is born, that very company of *sādhus* is counted among the principal limbs of *prema*.

*As the fruit of *sukṛti* comes the company of *sādhus*; as its fruit, devotion to Kṛṣṇa — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.51.53) —*

ভবাপবর্গো ভ্রমতো যদা ভবে-
জ্জনস্য তর্হ্যচ্যুত সৎসমাগমঃ ।
সৎসঙ্গমো যর্হি তদৈব সদ্গতৌ
পরাবরেশে ত্বয়ি জায়তে রতিঃ ॥ ৮১ ॥

bhavāpavargo bhramato yadā bhavej
the end of worldly existence of one wandering when comes
janasya tarhy acyuta sat-samāgamaḥ
of a person then O Acyuta meeting with the saints
sat-saṅgamo yarhi tadaiva sad-gatau
association with the saints when at that very time for the goal of the saints
parāvareśe tvayi jāyate ratiḥ
for the Lord of the high and the low for You is born attraction

81 "O Acyuta, when a wandering soul's worldly existence comes to its end, he meets the saints. And when he associates with the saints, attraction (*rati*) is born in him for You, the goal of the saints and the Lord of the high and the low." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.51.53)[9]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 22.46.

*The company of saints is the highest wealth — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.30) —*

অত আত্যন্তিকং ক্ষেমং পৃচ্ছামো ভবতোঽনঘাঃ ।
সংসারেঽস্মিন্ ক্ষণার্দ্ধোঽপি সৎসঙ্গঃ সেবধির্নৃণাম্ ॥ ৮২ ॥

ata ātyantikaṁ kṣemaṁ
therefore the ultimate good
pṛcchāmo bhavato 'naghāḥ
we ask you O sinless ones
saṁsāre 'smin kṣaṇārdho 'pi
in worldly existence this half a moment even
sat-saṅgaḥ sevadhir nṛṇām
association with saints a treasure for men

82 "Therefore, O sinless ones, we ask you about the ultimate good. In this world even half a moment of association with saints is a treasure for humankind." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.30)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O sinless ones, I ask you about the *jīva*'s highest good. In this world even half a moment of the company of *sādhus* is a priceless treasure for the *jīvas*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Nārada, glorifying *bhāgavata-dharma* before Vasudeva, recounts the dialogue between Nimi, the king of Videha, and the nine Yogendras. Mahārāja Nimi was performing a sacrifice when the nine Yogendras, *mahā-bhāgavatas*, came there of their own accord. Nimi worshiped them according to the rules and says:

(**he**) **anaghāḥ** (sinless, faultless sages), **ataḥ** (since it is hard to see Bhagavān and the *bhāgavatas*) **bhavataḥ** (you) **ātyantikam** (about the unsurpassed) **kṣemam** (good) **pṛcchāmaḥ** (we ask); (for) **asmin saṁsāre** (in this world) **kṣaṇārdhaḥ** (lasting the briefest time) **api sat-saṅgaḥ nṛṇām** (for people) **sevadhiḥ** (a treasure that grants all fruits; the sense: as one rejoices on finding a treasure, so [here there is] the highest bliss).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.25.25) —*

সতাং প্রসঙ্গান্মম বীর্য্যসম্বিদো
ভবন্তি হৃৎকর্ণরসায়নাঃ কথাঃ ।
তজ্জোষণাদাশ্বপবর্গবর্ত্মনি
শ্রদ্ধা রতির্ভক্তিরনুক্রমিষ্যতি ॥ ৮৩ ॥

satāṁ prasaṅgān mama vīrya-samvido
of the saints in the company My prowess revealing
bhavanti hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ kathāḥ
become to heart and ear delightful talks
taj-joṣaṇād āśv apavarga-vartmani
by relishing them quickly on the path of liberation
śraddhā ratir bhaktir anukramiṣyati
faith, attraction, love will follow in turn

83 (Lord Kapila to His mother Devahūti:) “In the company of the saints there are talks revealing My power, delightful to the heart and to the ear. By relishing them one quickly comes to faith in Me, the path of liberation, and after it to attraction (*rati*) and love (*prema-bhakti*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.25)[10]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.60.

The conduct of a Vaiṣṇava and the identification of the non-Vaiṣṇava —

অসৎসঙ্গত্যাগ, — এই বৈষ্ণব-আচার ।
'স্ত্রীসঙ্গী' — এক অসাধু, 'কৃষ্ণাভক্ত' আর ॥ ৮৪ ॥

asat-saṅga-tyāga, — ei vaiṣṇava-ācāra
of bad association the rejection this Vaiṣṇava conduct
'strī-saṅgī' — eka asādhu, 'kṛṣṇābhakta' āra
one attached to women one kind of the unholy one who is not Kṛṣṇa's devotee another

84 To give up bad association — this is the conduct of a Vaiṣṇava. One who is attached to women is one kind of unholy person (*asādhu*); one who is not a devotee of Kṛṣṇa is the other.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The company of *sādhus* is Vaiṣṇava conduct in its "direct" (*anvaya*) form, and giving up bad company is Vaiṣṇava conduct in its "indirect" (*vyatireka*) form. The *asat* are of two kinds. One attached to women, that is, infatuated with them, is the first kind of *asādhu*, and one who is "not a devotee of Kṛṣṇa" is the second kind of *asādhu*. The pure devotee will take special care to avoid these two kinds of bad company.

Anubhāṣya.
Giving up the company of non-Vaiṣṇavas is the Vaiṣṇava's only good conduct (*sadācāra*). "Non-Vaiṣṇavas" means two classes of people: "those attached to women" and "non-devotees of Kṛṣṇa." Association with women is of two kinds. One "follows the prescribed *dharma*": on it *varṇāśrama-dharma* rests. The other is "unprescribed," aimed at *adharma*: through it the order of *varṇāśrama-dharma* is thrown into disorder, and as the fruit of *karma* one goes to hell and other places. One devoted to sin in this world is entirely unworthy of the name "Vaiṣṇava." The three goals of life (*trivarga*) — *dharma*, *artha* and *kāma* — are bound up with the non-Vaiṣṇava conduct of association with women. The fourth goal, *mokṣa*, does not arise from association with women; yet, through aversion to Kṛṣṇa, the seeker of *mokṣa* is even more of a non-Vaiṣṇava and more

contemptible than one attached to women. The company both of the *māyāvādī* and of the *māyā-vilāsī* (the enjoyer of *māyā*) destroys Vaiṣṇavism, that is, pure *bhakti*. The *māyāvādī* is a *mumukṣu* (seeker of liberation): wishing to enjoy the fruit of *mokṣa*, he renounces material enjoyment for his own elevation. And one attached to women is a *bubhukṣu*, an enjoyer. Both are bent on gratifying their own material senses, seek fruits other than Kṛṣṇa, are full of duplicity, or deceit (*kaitava*), and therefore neither is a "servant of Kṛṣṇa."

সত্যং শৌচং দয়া মৌনং বুদ্ধির্হ্রীঃ শ্রীর্যশঃ ক্ষমা ।
শমো দমো ভগশ্চেতি যৎসঙ্গাদ্যাতি সংক্ষয়ম্ ॥ ৮৫ ॥

satyaṁ śaucaṁ dayā maunaṁ
truthfulness purity compassion silence
buddhir hrīḥ śrīr yaśaḥ kṣamā
intelligence modesty beauty fame forbearance
śamo damo bhagaś ceti
control of the mind control of the senses fortune and thus
yat-saṅgād yāti saṅkṣayam
by the company of whom goes to ruin

85 "Truthfulness, purity, compassion, silence, intelligence, modesty, beauty, fame, forbearance, control of the mind and of the senses, and fortune — all go to ruin through the company of such people." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.31.33)

*The dreadful results of association with women and with those who associate with women — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.31.33–35) —*

তেষ্বশান্তেষু মূঢ়েষু খণ্ডিতাত্মস্বসাধুষু ।
সঙ্গং ন কুর্য্যাচ্ছোচ্যেষু যোষিৎক্রীড়ামৃগেষু চ ॥ ৮৬ ॥

teṣv aśānteṣu mūḍheṣu
with those restless foolish
khaṇḍitātmasv asādhuṣu
who have lost sight of the self unholy
saṅgaṁ na kuryāc chocyeṣu
company not one should keep pitiable
yoṣit-krīḍā-mṛgeṣu ca
of women play- pets and

86 "One should never keep company with the restless and the foolish, with the unholy who have lost sight of the self, with those pitiable men who are pets for women to play with." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.31.34)

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavān Kapiladeva tells Devahūti how the *jīva* who has turned from Kṛṣṇa and forgotten his true nature, under the sway of sin and piety, wanders through species before birth and suffers in the womb. Then in three verses He tells how after birth — in childhood, boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*) and youth — the *jīva* in various ways gratifies the senses, that is, longs for association with women, and of the power and evil results of this:

yat-saṅgāt (through association with those *asat* people) **satyaṁ śaucaṁ dayā maunaṁ buddhiḥ** (that is, intelligence directed toward the highest goal) **hrīḥ śrīḥ** (the wealth of *bhakti*) **yaśaḥ kṣamā śamaḥ damaḥ bhagaḥ** (power or opulence) **iti saṅkṣayam** (complete destruction) **yāti** (undergoes) — **teṣu aśānteṣu** (with those greedy for material enjoyment) **mūḍheṣu asādhuṣu khaṇḍitātmasu** (with those who take the material body and so on to be the transcendental self) **yoṣit-krīḍā-mṛgeṣu** (with the "pet deer" of women, the henpecked, wholly under their control) **śocyeṣu** (abodes of misery) **asādhuṣu** (with non-Vaiṣṇavas) **saṅgaṁ na kuryāt**.

ন তথাস্য ভবেন্মোহো বন্ধশ্চান্যপ্রসঙ্গতঃ ।
যোষিৎসঙ্গাদ্যথা পুংসো যথা তৎসঙ্গিসঙ্গতঃ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

na tathāsya bhaven moho
not so for him arises delusion
bandhaś cānya-prasaṅgataḥ
bondage and from other attachment
yoṣit-saṅgād yathā puṁso
from the company of women as for a man
yathā tat-saṅgi-saṅgataḥ
as of those attached to them from the company

87 "From no other attachment does a man fall into such delusion and bondage as from the company of women and of those attached to women." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.31.35)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Truthfulness, cleanliness, compassion, silence, intelligence, modesty, beauty (*śrī*), fame, forgiveness, tranquility, self-control, power — all of these perish through association with an *asādhu*: a pitiable, self-destroying, restless and foolish man, a pet deer of women. Never associate with such a person. By no other connection is the *jīva* so bewildered and bound as by the company of women and of those who keep company with women.

Anubhāṣya.
asya (for this person) **yathā yoṣit-saṅgāt** (from living with the object of enjoyment in the mentality "I am a material enjoyer") **yathā** (and) **tat-saṅgi-saṅgataḥ** (from living with enjoyers of women, that is, with those who take the body of blood and semen and so on to be the self) **mohaḥ** (loss of intelligence) **bandhaḥ** (the bondage of worldly existence) **ca bhavet**, **tathā anya-prasaṅgataḥ na bhavet**.

*The devotee's attitude toward the company of those averse to Hari — (words of the *Kātyāyana-saṁhitā*) —*

বরং হুতবহজ্বালা-পঞ্জরান্তর্ব্যবস্থিতিঃ ।
ন শৌরিচিন্তাবিমুখ-জনসম্বাসবৈশসম্ ॥ ৮৮ ॥

varaṁ huta-vaha-jvālā-
better of fire of the flames
pañjarāntar-vyavasthitiḥ
inside a cage to dwell
na śauri-cintā-vimukha-
not from thought of Kṛṣṇa (Śauri) turned away
jana-samvāsa-vaiśasam
of people living with the torment

88 "Better to dwell in a cage amid blazing flames than to suffer the torment of living with people who have turned away from the thought of Kṛṣṇa." (Kātyāyana-saṁhitā)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
It is better to suffer the torment of a cage amid flames than to keep the painful company of people turned away from the thought of Kṛṣṇa. The purport is this: if one must burn to death in fire or be imprisoned, one should accept even that, but not associate with people turned away from Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
hutavaha-jvālā-pañjarāntar-vyavasthitiḥ (even living in a cage amid the flames of a blazing fire) **varam** (is desirable; and yet) **śauri-cintā-vimukha-jana-saṁvāsa-vaiśasam** (the calamity of living together with people turned away from the thought of Śauri, Kṛṣṇa: that is the very *vaiśasa*, the disaster that befalls) **na**.

How to behave toward those devoid of devotion to Viṣṇu — (words of the Gosvāmipāda) —

মা দ্রাক্ষীঃ ক্ষীণপুণ্যান্ ক্বচিদপি
ভগবদ্ভক্তিহীনান্ মনুষ্যান্ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

mā drākṣīḥ kṣīṇa-puṇyān kvacid api
do not look at whose piety is spent ever even
bhagavad-bhakti-hīnān manuṣyān
for the Lord devotion devoid of people

89 "Never even look upon people who are devoid of devotion to the Lord, whose piety is spent." (Words of the Gosvāmipāda)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Never even look at people devoid of devotion to Bhagavān, whose pious merit is exhausted.

Anubhāṣya.

bhagavad-bhakti-hīnān (devoid of service to Kṛṣṇa) **kṣīṇa-puṇyān** (unfortunate) **manuṣyān kvacit** (even for the sake of worldly decorum and the like) **api mā** (not) **adrākṣīḥ** (should one look at).

*The conduct of the *paramahaṁsa*, or the Vaiṣṇava who possesses nothing (*niṣkiñcana*) —*

এত সব ছাড়ি' আর বর্ণাশ্রম-ধর্ম্ম ।
অকিঞ্চন হঞা লয় কৃষ্ণৈক-শরণ ॥ ৯০ ॥

eta saba chāḍi' āra varṇāśrama-dharma
these all giving up and of varṇa and āśrama the dharma
akiñcana hañā laya kṛṣṇaika-śaraṇa
owning nothing becoming he takes of Kṛṣṇa alone shelter

90 Giving up all this, and the *dharma* of *varṇa* and *āśrama* as well, he becomes *akiñcana*, one who owns nothing, and takes shelter of Kṛṣṇa alone.[11]

সর্ব্বধর্ম্মান্ পরিত্যজ্য মামেকং শরণং ব্রজ ।
অহং ত্বাং সর্ব্বপাপেভ্যো মোক্ষয়িষ্যামি মা শুচঃ ॥ ৯১ ॥

sarva-dharmān parityajya
all dharmas giving up
mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja
to Me alone for shelter come
ahaṁ tvāṁ sarva-pāpebhyo
I you from all sins
mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ
shall free do not grieve

91 “Give up all *dharmas* and take shelter of Me alone. I shall free you from all sins; do not grieve.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.66)[12]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Give up these two kinds of association with non-sādhus, and attachment to *varṇāśrama-dharma*, and take shelter of Kṛṣṇa alone, as an *akiñcana*, one who has nothing but Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 8.63.

Kṛṣṇa is the only one to be worshiped —

ভক্তবৎসল, কৃতজ্ঞ, সমর্থ, বদান্য ।
হেন কৃষ্ণ ছাড়ি’ পণ্ডিত নাহি ভজে অন্য ॥ ৯২ ॥

bhakta-vatsala, kṛtajña, samartha, vadānya
affectionate to His devotees grateful all-capable generous
hena kṛṣṇa chāḍi’ paṇḍita nāhi bhaje anya
such Kṛṣṇa leaving a wise man does not worship another

92 Kṛṣṇa is affectionate to His devotees, grateful, all-capable and generous. No wise man would leave such a Kṛṣṇa to worship another.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa loves His devotees, and He is grateful, generous and all-powerful. No wise person leaves Him to worship trivial things other than Kṛṣṇa. One who gives up the worship of Kṛṣṇa and becomes infatuated with material objects is a fool who destroys himself, and one as foolish as he is very rare.

Kṛṣṇa, the Self of all, gives His very Self —

কঃ পণ্ডিতস্ত্বদপরং শরণং সমীয়া-
ভক্তপ্রিয়াদৃতগিরঃ সুহৃদঃ কৃতজ্ঞাৎ ।
সর্ব্বান্ দদাতি সুহৃদো ভজতোঽভিকামা-
নাত্মানমপ্যুপচয়াপচয়ৌ ন যস্য ॥ ৯৩ ॥

kaḥ paṇḍitas tvad-aparaṁ śaraṇaṁ samīyād
what wise man other than You shelter would approach
bhakta-priyād ṛta-giraḥ suhṛdaḥ kṛtajñāt
than the One who loves His devotees true to His word the friend grateful
sarvān dadāti suhṛdo bhajato 'bhikāmān
all He gives to His friends who worship Him desires
ātmānam apy upacayāpacayau na yasya
Himself even increase and decrease not of whom

93 "What wise man would approach any shelter but You? You love Your devotees, You are true to Your word, You are their friend and are grateful. To the friends who worship You, You give all they desire, and even Your own self — and You neither increase nor diminish." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.48.26)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
What wise man would leave You — who love Your devotees, who are truthful in speech, a friend and grateful — and take shelter of another? To the friends who serve You, You give all they desire, even Your very Self, and yet You neither decrease nor increase.

Anubhāṣya.
After fulfilling Kubjā's cherished desire, Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa came with Rāma to Akrūra's house, wishing to send him to Hastināpura. Akrūra, bowing to Them, offers this prayer:

(Since You) **bhajataḥ** (to those who worship You) **sarvān suhṛdaḥ** (to friends) **abhikāmān** (what they desire, in full), **yasya** (and He for whom) **upacayāpacayau** (decrease and increase) **na** (there are not), (such) **ātmānam** (Your own form) **api dadāti**, (therefore) **bhakta-priyāt** (who love Your devotees) **ṛta-giraḥ** (truthful in speech) **suhṛdaḥ** (the friend) **kṛtajñāt** (who repay the devotees' love) **tvattaḥ** (apart from You) **aparaṁ śaraṇam** (shelter) **kaḥ paṇḍitaḥ samīyāt** (would go to)?

Uddhava is the proof that one should worship Kṛṣṇa alone —

বিজ্ঞ-জনের হয় যদি কৃষ্ণগুণ-জ্ঞান ।
অন্য ত্যজি' ভজে, তাতে উদ্ধব — প্রমাণ ॥ ৯৪ ॥

vijña-janera haya yadi kṛṣṇa-guṇa-jñāna
of a wise person arises if of Kṛṣṇa's qualities knowledge
anya tyaji' bhaje, tāte uddhava — pramāṇa
others giving up he worships (Him) of that Uddhava the proof

94 When a wise person comes to know Kṛṣṇa's qualities, he gives up all else and worships Him. Of this Uddhava is the proof:

Anubhāṣya.
As soon as an experienced person comes to know Kṛṣṇa's qualities, he gives up other worship and worships Kṛṣṇa alone. Uddhava is the proof of this.

Kṛṣṇa is supremely merciful, an ocean of mercy —

অহো বকী যং স্তনকালকূটং
জিঘাংসয়াপায়য়দপ্যসাধ্বী ৷
লেভে গতিং ধাত্র্যুচিতাং ততোঽন্যং
কং বা দয়ালুং শরণং ব্রজেম ॥ ৯৫ ॥

aho bakī yaṁ stana-kāla-kūṭaṁ
ah Pūtanā (sister of Baka) whom from her breast deadly poison
jighāṁsayāpāyayad apy asādhvī
wishing to kill made drink even though wicked
lebhe gatiṁ dhātry-ucitāṁ tato 'nyaṁ
attained the destination befitting a nurse than Him other
kaṁ vā dayāluṁ śaraṇaṁ vrajema
whom indeed merciful for shelter should we approach

95 "Ah! Wishing to kill Him, the wicked Pūtanā made Him drink deadly poison from her breast — and still she attained the destination befitting His nurse. To whom else so merciful should we go for shelter?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.2.23)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ah, this Pūtanā, the sister of Bakāsura, full of wicked intent, made Him whom she wished to kill drink the *kālakūṭa* poison from her breast, and even so she attained the destination worthy of a mother. Apart from Him, Kṛṣṇa, what other merciful one can I take shelter of?

Anubhāṣya.

The *mahā-bhāgavata* Śrīla Uddhava, stricken with grief in separation from Śrī Kṛṣṇa, describes to Vidura Śrī Kṛṣṇa's childhood pastimes and more:

aho (how wonderful) **bakī** (Pūtanā) **jighāṁsayā** (even with the wish to kill) **stana-kāla-kūṭam** (the *kālakūṭa* poison smeared on her breasts) **yam** (Kṛṣṇa) **apāyayat**, **asādhvī** (though a wicked demoness hostile to Kṛṣṇa) **dhātry-ucitām** (befitting a nurse who gives the breast and protects) **gatim** (the highest destination) **lebhe**, **tataḥ** (than Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **anyam** (other) **kaṁ vā dayālum** (generous one) **śaraṇaṁ vrajema** (that is, whom shall we worship)?

*Only the *paramahaṁsa*, the Vaiṣṇava, has offered himself to Kṛṣṇa —*

শরণাগতের, অকিঞ্চনের — একই লক্ষণ ।
তার মধ্যে প্রবেশয়ে ‘আত্মসমর্পণ’ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

śaraṇāgatera, akiñcanera — ekai lakṣaṇa
of the surrendered of the one who owns nothing the very same characteristics
tāra madhye praveśaye ‘ātma-samarpaṇa’
of them within enters self-offering

96 The surrendered soul (*śaraṇāgata*) and the one who owns nothing (*akiñcana*) have the same characteristics; and within surrender there is also self-offering (*ātma-samarpaṇa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The “*akiñcana* devotee” and the “*śaraṇāgata* devotee” — these two have the same symptoms. But the *śaraṇāgata* has one symptom more: “offering of the self” (*ātma-samarpaṇa*).

*The six kinds of *śaraṇāgati* —*

আনুকূল্যস্য সঙ্কল্পঃ প্রাতিকূল্যস্যবর্জ্জনম্ ।
রক্ষিষ্যতীতি বিশ্বাসো গোপ্তৃত্বে বরণং তথা ।
আত্মনিক্ষেপ-কার্পণ্যে ষড়্বিধা শরণাগতিঃ ॥ ৯৭ ॥

ānukūlyasya saṅkalpaḥ
of what is favourable acceptance
prātikūlyasya varjanam
of what is unfavourable rejection
rakṣiṣyatīti viśvāso goptṛtve varaṇaṁ tathā
He will protect thus faith as protector acceptance likewise
ātma-nikṣepa-kārpaṇye ṣaḍ-vidhā śaraṇāgatiḥ
offering of the self humility six kinds of surrender

97 "Surrender (*śaraṇāgati*) is of six kinds: the resolve to accept what is favourable to devotion; the rejection of what is unfavourable; faith that He will protect; acceptance of Him as one's guardian; the offering of oneself; and humility." (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 11.417)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The six symptoms of *śaraṇāgati*, taking shelter of Kṛṣṇa:

(1) *ānukūlya-saṅkalpa*, that is, the resolve: "Whatever is favorable to *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, I will certainly accept";

(2) *prātikūlya-vivarjana*, that is, renunciation: "Whatever is unfavorable to *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, I will certainly reject";

(3) "He will protect," that is, the faith: "I have no protector but Kṛṣṇa." This is not the faith that "knowledge of the nondifferent Brahman will save me from death," but the faith that "Kṛṣṇa, in His mercy, will protect me";

(4) accepting Kṛṣṇa as the *goptā*, the maintainer. One gives up the belief "By performing all my *karmas* I too will be maintained by the gods who preside over them," and firmly believes: "Kṛṣṇa alone is my maintainer; among gods and men I have no other";

(5) *ātma-nikṣepa*: the understanding "My will is not independent; it depends on Kṛṣṇa's will" — this is the offering of the self (*ātma-samarpaṇa*);

(6) *kārpaṇya*, that is, considering oneself lowly.

Anubhāṣya.

ānukūlyasya (of what helps the worship of Kṛṣṇa) **saṅkalpaḥ** (firm resolve, or acceptance), **prātikūlyasya varjanam** (giving up association with whatever opposes the worship of Kṛṣṇa), (**mām**) **rakṣiṣyati iti viśvāsaḥ** (firm faith, of this kind: "That Bhagavān, Lord of the three worlds, will arrange our welfare" and so

on), **goptṛtve** (as master, as maintainer, or as husband) **varaṇam** (praying, or accepting, of the kind described in the *Nṛsiṁha Purāṇa*: "'I take shelter of You, the God of gods, Janārdana' — whoever has come to Me for shelter in this way, I deliver from suffering"), **ātma-nikṣepa-kārpaṇye** (offering the self, of the kind described in the *Gautamīya-tantra*: "As I am directed by some God who dwells in the heart, so I act"; and humility, which reveals one's own lowliness, of this kind: "No one is more supremely merciful than You, and no one is more supremely pitiable than I," and so on — that is, plaintive prayer) — **iti ṣaḍ-vidhā śaraṇāgatiḥ** (taking shelter).

In the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 236) Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes: "It is sixfold when divided into limbs and the whole (*aṅga* and *aṅgī*). Of these, only 'accepting Him as protector' is the whole, since it has the same meaning as the word *śaraṇāgati*. The others are limbs, because they accompany it. * * * Thus, for one whose shelter is complete with all its limbs, it bears its full fruit at once; for others, it does so according to what they possess and in due order. This shelter is praised (in the verse *Bhāgavatam* 11.19.9), where it is said that He removes all the sufferings of those who have taken shelter of Him and showers His own sweetness on them from every side."

*The conduct of the *śaraṇāgata* —*

তবাস্মীতি বদন্ বাচা তথৈব মনসা বিদন্ ।
তৎস্থানমাশ্রিতস্তন্বা মোদতে শরণাগতঃ ॥ ৯৮ ॥

tavāsmīti vadan vācā
'Yours I am' thus saying with speech
tathaiva manasā vidan
just so with the mind knowing
tat-sthānam āśritas tanvā
of Him the abode taking shelter of with the body
modate śaraṇāgataḥ
rejoices the surrendered soul

98 "Saying with his words, 'I am Yours', knowing it so in his mind, and with his body taking shelter of the Lord's abode, the surrendered soul rejoices." (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 11.418)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

With his body the *śaraṇāgata* takes shelter of the places of the Lord's pastimes; with his mouth he says, “O Bhagavān, I am Yours”; in his mind he knows it — and he is filled with joy.

Anubhāṣya.

śaraṇāgataḥ (one who has surrendered) **‘(ahaṁ) tava (eva) asmi’ iti vācā vadan** (saying in words, “I am Yours (alone)”), **tathā eva manasā vidan** (knowing it in the mind as well — knowing himself devoted to service) **tanvā** (with the body) **tat-sthānam** (the places of the Lord and of His devotees) **āśritaḥ** (having taken shelter) **modate** (rejoices).

The Vaiṣṇava is nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa[35] *—*

শরণ লঞা করে কৃষ্ণে আত্মসমর্পণ ।
কৃষ্ণ তাঁরে করে তৎকালে আত্মসম ॥ ৯৯ ॥

śaraṇa lañā kare kṛṣṇe ātma-samarpaṇa
shelter taking he makes to Kṛṣṇa the offering of himself
kṛṣṇa tāṁre kare tat-kāle ātma-sama
Kṛṣṇa him makes at that moment like Himself

99 Taking shelter, he offers himself to Kṛṣṇa, and at that very moment Kṛṣṇa makes him like Himself.

*Like Kṛṣṇa, the Vaiṣṇava too is full of eternity, knowledge and bliss (*sac-cid-ānanda*) —*

মর্ত্ত্যো যদা ত্যক্তসমস্তকর্ম্মা
নিবেদিতাত্মা বিচিকীর্ষিতো মে ।
তদামৃতত্বং প্রতিপদ্যমানো
ময়াত্মভূয়ায় চ কল্পতে বৈ ॥ ১০০ ॥

martyo yadā tyakta-samasta-karmā
a mortal when having given up all works
niveditātmā vicikīrṣito me
having offered himself whom I wish to exalt by Me
tadāmṛtatvaṁ pratipadyamāno
then immortality attaining
mayātma-bhūyāya ca kalpate vai
with Me for a nature like Mine and becomes fit indeed

100 "When a mortal gives up all works and offers himself to Me, I wish to exalt him. Then he attains immortality and becomes fit to share with Me a nature like My own." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.29.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When the mortal *jīva* gives up all *karma*, offers himself fully to Me (Bhagavān) and acts by My will, he attains immortality and becomes *kalpita*, that is, fit to taste together with Me the *rasa* whose nature is spirit.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa, having described the truths of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* to Uddhava, His dearest and the best of devotees, at the very end describes the destination of the pure devotee who has given himself to Him exclusively:

yadā martyaḥ (a human being) **tyakta-samasta-karmā** (having turned away from enjoyment and liberation) **me** (to Me) **niveditātmā** (becomes — that is, offers himself), **tadā** (he) **mayā vicikīrṣitaḥ** (being inspired, becomes one to whom I wish to give something special), (and then) **amṛtatvam** (liberation) **pratipadyamānaḥ** (attaining) **mayā** (together with Me) **ātma-bhūyāya** (for being, like Me, full of eternity, knowledge and bliss) **kalpate** (becomes fit).

*(1) Description of the characteristics of *sādhana-bhakti**

এবে সাধনভক্তি-লক্ষণ শুন, সনাতন ।
যাহা হৈতে পাই কৃষ্ণপ্রেম-মহাধন ॥ ১০১ ॥

ebe sādhana-bhakti-lakṣaṇa śuna, sanātana
now of sādhana-bhakti the characteristics hear Sanātana
yāhā haite pāi kṛṣṇa-prema-mahā-dhana
from which one obtains of love for Kṛṣṇa the great treasure

101 Now hear, Sanātana, the characteristics of *sādhana-bhakti*, devotion in practice, by which one obtains the great treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

*The definition of *sādhana* —*

কৃতিসাধ্যা ভবেৎ সাধ্যভাবা সা সাধনাভিধা ।
নিত্যসিদ্ধস্য ভাবস্য প্রাকট্যং হৃদি সাধ্যতা ॥ ১০২ ॥

kṛti-sādhyā bhavet sādhya-
by action to be accomplished becomes whose goal
bhāvā sā sādhanābhidhā
is bhāva it is called sādhana
nitya-siddhasya bhāvasya
of the eternally perfect bhāva
prākaṭyaṁ hṛdi sādhyatā
the manifestation in the heart is the attainment

102 "Devotion carried out by the senses, whose goal is *bhāva*, is called *sādhana-bhakti*. *Bhāva* is eternally perfect; to 'attain' it is to make it manifest in the heart." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When *bhāva-bhakti*, which is the goal (*sādhya*), becomes attainable by action (*kṛti*), that is, by the senses, it is called *sādhana-bhakti*. Bhakti is the eternally perfect *bhāva* of the *jīva*, and *sādhyatā* means bringing it to manifestation in the heart. The meaning is this. In the *jīva*, a particle of spirit, there is by nature a particle of the bliss of Kṛṣṇa, the spiritual sun. Bound by *māyā*, the *jīva* has almost lost it in this life. That eternally perfect *bhāva* is what is to be manifested in the heart. In this condition the eternally perfect becomes a goal (*sādhya*). And when that bhakti — the *bhāva* to be attained — begins to be practiced with the senses of the conditioned *jīva*, it is called *sādhana-bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

kṛti-sādhyā (what is to be accomplished by action, that is, by the impulse of the senses) **sādhya-bhāvā** (that by which *bhāva* is to be attained) **sādhanābhidhā** (called *sādhana-bhakti*) **bhavet**; **hṛdi** (in the heart of the *jīvātmā*) **nitya-siddhasya** (eternally existing, self-manifest) **bhāvasya** (of the *bhāva* of love for Kṛṣṇa) **prākaṭyam** (the manifestation alone) **sādhyatā** (attainability by *sādhana*).

*The essential (*svarūpa*) and the accompanying (*taṭastha*) characteristics of *sādhana-bhakti* —*

শ্রবণাদি-ক্রিয়া — তার ‘স্বরূপ’-লক্ষণ ।
‘তটস্থ’-লক্ষণে উপজায় প্রেমধন ॥ ১০৩ ॥

śravaṇādi-kriyā — tāra ‘svarūpa’-lakṣaṇa
hearing and the rest the activities its essential characteristic
‘taṭastha’-lakṣaṇe upajāya prema-dhana
by the marginal characteristic arises the treasure of love

103 Hearing and the other activities are its essential characteristic (*svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*). Its marginal characteristic (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*) is that the treasure of love arises from it.

*Only by the eternally perfect, independent, pure (exclusive, unalloyed, or favorable) *abhidheya* is the eternally perfect, self-manifest, pure *prayojana* attained —*

নিত্যসিদ্ধ কৃষ্ণপ্রেম ‘সাধ্য’ কভু নয় ।
শ্রবণাদি শুদ্ধচিত্তে করয়ে উদয় ॥ ১০৪ ॥

nitya-siddha kṛṣṇa-prema ‘sādhya’ kabhu naya
eternally perfect for Kṛṣṇa love something to be produced ever is not
śravaṇādi śuddha-citte karaye udaya
hearing and the rest in the purified heart cause its rising

104 Love for Kṛṣṇa is eternally perfect; it is never something produced by effort. Hearing and the other practices awaken it in the purified heart.

*The kinds of *sādhana-bhakti*: (1) *vaidhī* and (2) *rāgānugā**

এই ত' সাধনভক্তি — দুই ত' প্রকার ।
এক 'বৈধী ভক্তি', 'রাগানুগা-ভক্তি' আর ॥ ১০৫ ॥

ei ta' sādhana-bhakti — dui ta' prakāra
this indeed sādhana-bhakti two indeed kinds
eka 'vaidhī bhakti', 'rāgānugā-bhakti' āra
one vaidhī-bhakti rāgānugā-bhakti the other

105 This *sādhana-bhakti* is of two kinds: one is *vaidhī-bhakti*, devotion according to rules, and the other is *rāgānugā-bhakti*, devotion that follows spontaneous love.[13]

*(a) Description and definition of *vaidhī-bhakti* —*

রাগহীন জন ভজে শাস্ত্রের আজ্ঞায় ।
'বৈধী-ভক্তি' বলি' তারে সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে গায় ॥ ১০৬ ॥

rāga-hīna jana bhaje śāstrera ājñāya
of rāga devoid a person worships of scripture by the command
'vaidhī-bhakti' bali' tāre sarva-śāstre gāya
vaidhī-bhakti calling it in all scriptures they sing

106 When one in whom *rāga*, spontaneous love, has not yet awakened worships at the bidding of the śāstra, the scriptures call this *vaidhī-bhakti*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hearing, chanting and remembering in a favorable mood are the *svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*, the essential characteristic, of this bhakti. When one gives up other desires (*anyābhilāṣa*) and cuts one's ties with *jñāna* and *karma*, this essential characteristic produces "the treasure of *prema*." Love for Kṛṣṇa is an eternally perfect reality. It can never be attained (by any means, any *abhidheya*, other than pure bhakti); it can arise only in a heart purified by hearing and the other practices. Therefore *sādhana-bhakti* consists above all of pure hearing, chanting and the other activities. It is of two kinds, *vaidhī* and *rāgānugā*. When those in whose

hearts *rāga* has not yet awakened take up worship at the command of scripture, that is *vaidhī-bhakti*.

The injunction to hear about, glorify and remember Śrī Hari alone —

তস্মাদ্ভারত সর্ব্বাত্মা ভগবান্ হরিরীশ্বরঃ ।
শ্রোতব্যঃ কীর্ত্তিতব্যশ্চ স্মর্ত্তব্যশ্চেচ্ছতাভয়ম্ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

tasmād bhārata sarvātmā
therefore O descendant of Bharata the Soul of all
bhagavān harir īśvaraḥ
the Lord Hari the Controller
śrotavyaḥ kīrtitavyaś ca
is to be heard of is to be glorified and
smartavyaś cecchatābhayam
is to be remembered and by one who desires fearlessness

107 "Therefore, O descendant of Bharata, one who desires fearlessness must hear about, glorify and remember the Lord Hari, the Controller and the Soul of all." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.1.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Bhārata, Bhagavān Hari, the Lord and the Soul of all, is always to be heard about, glorified and remembered by those who desire fearlessness.

Anubhāṣya.
"What should a person on the verge of death do?" In reply to this question of King Parīkṣit, Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī first praises the question highly, then describes the bondage of the *gṛhamedhīs* and tells how to be freed from it:

bhārata (O descendant of Bharata), **tasmāt** (because the *jīva* averse to Kṛṣṇa sees his own death and yet does not see it — for this reason) **abhayam** (the end of worldly existence for oneself and others, liberation, or self-protection) **icchatā** (by one who wishes to give up absorption in the "second," in what is other) **sarvātmā** (the Lord within the hearts of all) **bhagavān īśvaraḥ hariḥ** (alone) **śrotavyaḥ** (is to be heard about) **kīrtitavyaḥ** (is to be glorified) **smartavyaḥ ca** (and is to be remembered).

*At the beginning of *vaidhī-bhakti*, before the *paramahaṁsa* stage, *daiva-varṇāśrama-dharma* is observed; its origin —*

মুখবাহূরুপাদেভ্যঃ পুরুষস্যাশ্রমৈঃ সহ ।
চত্বারো জজ্ঞিরে বর্ণা গুণৈর্বিপ্রাদয়ঃ পৃথক্ ॥ ১০৮ ॥

mukha-bāhūru-pādebhyaḥ
from the mouth arms thighs feet
puruṣasyāśramaiḥ saha
of the Puruṣa the āśramas together with
catvāro jajñire varṇā
four were born varṇas
guṇair viprādayaḥ pṛthak
by their guṇas the brāhmaṇas and the rest separately

108 "From the mouth, arms, thighs and feet of the Puruṣa the four *varṇas*, beginning with the brāhmaṇas, were born together with the *āśramas*, each distinct by its qualities." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.2)[14]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 22.27.

*Every act that awakens the remembrance of Viṣṇu is a *vidhi*; every act that destroys the remembrance of Viṣṇu is a *niṣedha* —*

স্মর্ত্তব্যঃ সততং বিষ্ণুর্ব্বিস্মর্ত্তব্যো ন জাতুচিৎ ।
সর্ব্বে বিধিনিষেধাঃ স্যুরেতয়োরেব কিঙ্করাঃ ॥ ১০৯ ॥

smartavyaḥ satataṁ viṣṇur
is to be remembered always Viṣṇu
vismartavyo na jātucit
is to be forgotten not ever
sarve vidhi-niṣedhāḥ syur
all injunctions and prohibitions should be
etayor eva kiṅkarāḥ
of these two only the servants

109 "Viṣṇu is always to be remembered and never to be forgotten. All injunctions and prohibitions are servants of these two rules alone." (Padma-purāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Viṣṇu is always to be remembered and never forgotten" — all injunctions and prohibitions follow these two statements. The meaning is this: all the injunctions (*vidhi*) that have arisen in scripture and all the prohibitions (*niṣedha*) it states rest on these two statements. Whatever brings the Lord to mind is a duty, and so a *vidhi*; any act that makes one forget the Lord is a *niṣedha*.

Anubhāṣya.

viṣṇuḥ satataṁ smartavyaḥ, **na jātucit** (ever) **vismartavyaḥ** — **sarve vidhi-niṣedhāḥ etayoḥ** (of these two, the injunction and the prohibition — to remember Viṣṇu and not to forget Him) **eva kiṅkarāḥ** (obedient servants) **syuḥ** (are).

*Description of the sixty-four limbs of bhakti from among the countless [practices] of *vaidhī-bhakti* —*

বিবিধাঙ্গ সাধনভক্তির বহু ত' বিস্তার ।
সংক্ষেপে কহিয়ে কিছু সাধনাঙ্গ-সার ॥ ১১০ ॥

vividhāṅga sādhana-bhaktira bahu ta' vistāra
of many limbs of sādhana-bhakti great indeed the extent
saṅkṣepe kahiye kichu sādhanāṅga-sāra
in brief I shall tell something of the limbs of practice the essence

110 *Sādhana-bhakti*, with its many limbs, is very vast. In brief I shall tell you something of their essence.

গুরুপাদাশ্রয়, দীক্ষা, গুরুর সেবন ।
সদ্ধর্ম্মশিক্ষা-পৃচ্ছা, সাধুমার্গানুগমন ॥ ১১১ ॥

guru-pādāśraya, dīkṣā, gurura sevana
shelter at the guru's feet initiation of the guru service
sad-dharma-śikṣā-pṛcchā, sādhu-mārgānugamana
of true dharma learning inquiry of the saints the path following

111 Taking shelter at the feet of the guru; initiation (*dīkṣā*); serving the guru; learning true *dharma* and inquiring about it; following the path of the saints;

কৃষ্ণপ্রীত্যে ভোগত্যাগ, কৃষ্ণতীর্থে বাস ।
যাবৎ নির্ব্বাহ-প্রতিগ্রহ, একাদশ্যুপবাস ॥ ১১২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-prītye bhoga-tyāga, kṛṣṇa-tīrthe vāsa
for Kṛṣṇa's pleasure of enjoyment giving up in Kṛṣṇa's holy place living
yāvat nirvāha-pratigraha, ekādaśy-upavāsa
as much as for maintenance accepting on Ekādaśī fasting

112 giving up one's own enjoyment for Kṛṣṇa's pleasure; living in a holy place of Kṛṣṇa; accepting only what is needed to maintain life; fasting on Ekādaśī;

ধাত্র্যশ্বত্থগোবিপ্র-বৈষ্ণব-পূজন ।
সেবা-নামাপরাধাদি দূরে বিসর্জ্জন ॥ ১১৩ ॥

dhātry-aśvattha-go-vipra-vaiṣṇava-pūjana
the dhātrī aśvattha cows brāhmaṇas Vaiṣṇavas honouring
sevā-nāmāparādhādi dūre visarjana
in service to the Name offences and the like far away casting off

113 honouring the *dhātrī* (*āmalakī*) and *aśvattha* trees, the cows, the brāhmaṇas and the Vaiṣṇavas; keeping far from offences in service, offences to the Holy Name and the like;

অবৈষ্ণব-সঙ্গত্যাগ, বহুশিষ্য না করিব ।
বহুগ্রন্থ-কলাভ্যাস-ব্যাখ্যান বর্জ্জিব ॥ ১১৪ ॥

avaiṣṇava-saṅga-tyāga, bahu-śiṣya nā kariba
of non-Vaiṣṇavas company giving up many disciples not I shall make
bahu-grantha-kalābhyāsa-vyākhyāna varjiba
of many books partial study expounding I shall avoid

114 giving up the company of non-Vaiṣṇavas; not taking many disciples; not dabbling in many books, nor expounding them for the sake of argument;

হানি লাভে সম, শোকাদির বশ না হইব ।
অন্যদেব, অন্যশাস্ত্র নিন্দা না করিব ॥ ১১৫ ॥

hāni lābhe sama, śokādira vaśa nā haiba
in loss in gain even-minded of grief and the like under the sway not I shall be
anya-deva, anya-śāstra nindā nā kariba
other gods other scriptures blasphemy not I shall do

115 remaining even-minded in loss and gain; not falling under the sway of grief and the like; not blaspheming other gods or other scriptures;

বিষ্ণু-বৈষ্ণব-নিন্দা, গ্রাম্যবার্ত্তা না শুনিব ।
প্রাণীমাত্রে মনোবাক্যে উদ্বেগ না দিব ॥ ১১৬ ॥

viṣṇu-vaiṣṇava-nindā, grāmya-vārtā nā śuniba
of Viṣṇu of Vaiṣṇavas blasphemy worldly talk not I shall hear
prāṇī-mātre mano-vākye udvega nā diba
to any living being in mind in speech distress not I shall give

116 not listening to blasphemy of Viṣṇu or the Vaiṣṇavas, nor to worldly talk; not causing distress to any living being in mind or in speech;

শ্রবণ, কীর্ত্তন, স্মরণ, পূজন, বন্দন ।
পরিচর্য্যা, দাস্য, সখ্য, আত্মনিবেদন ॥ ১১৭ ॥

śravaṇa, kīrtana, smaraṇa, pūjana, vandana
hearing glorifying remembering worship offering prayers
paricaryā, dāsya, sakhya, ātma-nivedana
attending servitude friendship offering of the self

117 hearing, glorifying, remembering, worshipping, offering prayers (*vandana*), attending on the Lord (*paricaryā*), servitude (*dāsya*),

friendship (*sakhya*) and the offering of oneself (*ātma-nivedana*);

অগ্রে নৃত্য, গীত, বিজ্ঞপ্তি, দণ্ডবন্নতি ।
অভ্যুত্থান, অনুব্রজ্যা, তীর্থগৃহে গতি ॥ ১১৮ ॥

agre nṛtya, gīta, vijñapti, daṇḍavan-nati
before (the Deity) dancing singing opening the heart prostrate obeisance
abhyutthāna, anuvrajyā, tīrtha-gṛhe gati
rising to greet following behind to holy places to temples going

118 dancing and singing before the Deity; opening one's heart to Him (*vijñapti*); bowing down flat; rising to greet Him; following behind Him; going to holy places and temples;

পরিক্রমা, স্তবপাঠ, জপ, সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
ধূপ-মাল্য-গন্ধ-মহাপ্রসাদ-ভোজন ॥ ১১৯ ॥

parikramā, stava-pāṭha, japa, saṅkīrtana
circumambulation of prayers reciting japa congregational chanting
dhūpa-mālya-gandha-mahāprasāda-bhojana
of incense garlands fragrance mahāprasāda eating

119 circumambulation; reciting prayers; *japa*; *saṅkīrtana*; smelling the incense, garlands and fragrances offered to the Lord; honouring *mahāprasāda*;

আরাত্রিক-মহোৎসব-শ্রীমূর্ত্তি-দর্শন ।
নিজপ্রিয়-দান, ধ্যান, তদীয়-সেবন ॥ ১২০ ॥

ārātrika-mahotsava-śrīmūrti-darśana
of the ārati festivals of the Deity seeing
nija-priya-dāna, dhyāna, tadīya-sevana
of what is dear to oneself offering meditation of tadīya service

120 seeing the *ārati*, the festivals and the Deity (*śrī-mūrti*); offering what is dear to oneself; meditation; serving *tadīya*, what is His own.[15]

‘তদীয়’ — তুলসী-বৈষ্ণব-মথুরা-ভাগবত ।
এই চারির সেবা হয় কৃষ্ণের অভিমত ॥ ১২১ ॥

‘tadīya’ — tulasī-vaiṣṇava-mathurā-bhāgavata
tadīya Tulasī Vaiṣṇavas Mathurā the Bhāgavatam
ei cārira sevā haya kṛṣṇera abhimata
of these four service is of Kṛṣṇa the desire

121 *Tadīya*, “His own”, means Tulasī, the Vaiṣṇavas, Mathurā and the *Bhāgavatam*. Service to these four is what Kṛṣṇa desires.

কৃষ্ণার্থে অখিল চেষ্টা, তৎকৃপাবলোকন ।
জন্ম-দিনাদি-মহোৎসব লঞা ভক্তগণ ॥ ১২২ ॥

kṛṣṇārthe akhila ceṣṭā, tat-kṛpāvalokana
for Kṛṣṇa all endeavours of His mercy looking for
janma-dinādi-mahotsava lañā bhakta-gaṇa
of His birthday and the like festivals together with the devotees

122 Making every endeavour for Kṛṣṇa’s sake; looking to His mercy; celebrating His birthday and other festivals with the devotees;

সর্ব্বথা শরণাপত্তি, কার্ত্তিকাদি-ব্রত ।
‘চতুঃষষ্টি অঙ্গ’ এই পরম মহত্ত্ব ॥ ১২৩ ॥

sarvathā śaraṇāpatti, kārtikādi-vrata
in every way surrender Kārttika and other vows
‘catuḥ-ṣaṣṭi aṅga’ ei parama mahattva
sixty-four limbs these supreme greatness

123 surrendering to Him in every way; observing Kārttika and other vows — these are the sixty-four limbs (*aṅgas*) of devotion, and supreme is their greatness.

Among them, five limbs of bhakti are the best of all —

সাধুসঙ্গ, নামকীর্ত্তন, ভাগবতশ্রবণ ।
মথুরাবাস, শ্রীমূর্ত্তির শ্রদ্ধায় সেবন ॥ ১২৪ ॥

sādhu-saṅga, nāma-kīrtana, bhāgavata-śravaṇa
of the saints the company of the Name chanting the Bhāgavatam hearing
mathurā-vāsa, śrī-mūrtira śraddhāya sevana
in Mathurā living of the Deity with faith service

124 The company of saints; chanting the Holy Name; hearing the *Bhāgavatam*; living in Mathurā; serving the Deity with faith —

Even partial practice of them awakens love for Kṛṣṇa —

সকলসাধন-শ্রেষ্ঠ এই পঞ্চ অঙ্গ ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেম জন্মায় এই পাঁচের অল্প সঙ্গ ॥ ১২৫ ॥

sakala-sādhana-śreṣṭha ei pañca aṅga
of all practices the best these five limbs
kṛṣṇa-prema janmāya ei pāṁcera alpa saṅga
for Kṛṣṇa love gives birth to of these five slight contact

125 these five limbs are the best of all practices. Even slight contact with these five gives birth to love for Kṛṣṇa.[16]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

(1) Taking shelter at the feet of the guru; (2) *dīkṣā*, that is, initiation into the mantra; (3) service to the guru; (4) learning about true *dharma* and inquiring about it; (5) following the path of the sādhus; (6) giving up one's own enjoyment for Kṛṣṇa's pleasure; (7) living in a holy place of Kṛṣṇa; (8) accepting only what one needs to maintain life; (9) fasting on Ekādaśī; (10) honoring the *dhātrī* (*āmalakī*) tree, the *aśvattha* tree, cows, *brāhmaṇas* and Vaiṣṇavas. These ten limbs are the beginning of *bhajana*. Then: (11) keeping far away from offenses in service (*sevāparādha*) and offenses against the holy name (*nāmāparādha*); (12) giving up the company of non-Vaiṣṇavas; (13) not making many disciples; (14) not studying many books in part (*kalā*, that is, piecemeal) and not indulging in explanations for argument's sake; (15) being equal in loss and gain; (16) not

being overcome by grief and the like; (17) not disrespecting other gods or scriptures; (18) not listening to blasphemy of Viṣṇu and the Vaiṣṇavas; (19) not listening to *grāmya-vārtā*, that is, household talk rooted in the sense gratification of men and women; (20) not disturbing the mind of any living being. These last ten limbs, marked by prohibition, are to be practiced negatively (*vyatireka*). Two limbs — “freedom from miserliness in dealings” (*akārpaṇya*) and “not undertaking great enterprises” — the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* counts among those ten limbs. And the limb “not listening to *grāmya-vārtā*,” mentioned in this book, the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* does not include among those ten.

These twenty limbs are like the entrance to the temple of *bhajana*. Three of them — “taking shelter at the feet of the guru,” “*dīkṣā*” and “service to the guru” — are counted as principal limbs. (1) Hearing; (2) chanting; (3) remembering; (4) worship; (5) offering prayers (*vandana*); (6) service (*paricaryā*); (7) *dāsya*, servitude; (8) *sakhya*, friendship; (9) *ātma-nivedana*, offering oneself[27]; (10) dancing before the Śrī Vigraha; (11) singing; (12) *vijñapti*, opening one's heart to Him; (13) *daṇḍavat-praṇāma*, falling flat like a rod; (14) *abhyutthāna*, that is, rising on seeing Bhagavān or a devotee approach; (15) *anuvrajyā*, that is, following behind when a devotee or Bhagavān sets out; (16) going to holy places and to the temples of the Lord; (17) circumambulation (*parikramā*); (18) reciting prayers; (19) *japa*; (20) *saṅkīrtana*; (21) smelling the fragrance of incense and garlands that are the Lord's *prasāda*; (22) honoring *mahā-prasāda*; (23) seeing the festive *ārati*; (24) seeing the Śrī Mūrti; (25) offering to Bhagavān what is dear to oneself; (26) meditation; serving the *tadīya*, that is, (27) serving Tulasī and the others, (28) serving the Vaiṣṇavas, (29) living in Mathurā and (30) relishing the *Bhāgavatam*; (31) every endeavor for Kṛṣṇa; (32) waiting for His mercy; (33) celebrating His appearance days and other festivals with the devotees; (34) taking shelter of Him in every way; (35) Kārttika and other vows. To these thirty-five limbs four more must be added: (1) wearing the marks of a Vaiṣṇava on the body, (2) wearing the letters of Hari's names, (3) wearing *nirmālya*, the remnants of what has been offered, and (4) drinking *caraṇāmṛta*. Kavirāja Gosvāmī considered these four limbs part of *arcana* and the rest. With them there are thirty-nine (39) limbs. To these the five limbs must be added again: 1. *sādhu-saṅga*, 2. *nāma-kīrtana*, 3. hearing the *Bhāgavatam*, 4. living in Mathurā, 5. serving the Śrī Mūrti with faith. At the end of his description of the sixty-four limbs of *vaidhī-bhakti* (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva-vibhāga, second *laharī*), Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī writes: “These five limbs, though already written of

above, are praised here again to show that they are the best of all." Adding these five gives forty-four limbs, and these forty-four together with the twenty mentioned before make sixty-four limbs of bhakti in all. These sixty-four limbs of bhakti are distinct kinds of worship (*yajana*, or *upāsanā*) with the body, the senses and the inner faculty (*antaḥ-karaṇa*). Some of them are entirely separate, and some are of a mixed nature.

*The injunction to associate with sādhus and to hear the *Bhāgavatam* —*

সজাতীয়াশয়ে স্নিগ্ধে সাধৌ সঙ্গঃ স্বতো বরে ।
শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতার্থানামাস্বাদো রসিকৈঃ সহ ॥ ১২৬ ॥

sajātīyāśaye snigdhe sādhau saṅgaḥ svato vare
of like aspiration affectionate with a saint association than oneself superior
śrīmad bhāgavatārthānām āsvādo rasikaiḥ saha
of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam of the meanings the relishing with rasikas together

126 "One should associate with a saint who shares one's aspiration, is affectionate and is superior to oneself, and one should relish the meaning of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* together with *rasikas*, those who know its taste." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Pūrva-vibhāga, Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, 40)[17]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One should associate with a sādhu who is full of affection (*snigdha*), whose desires are of the same kind as one's own, and who is superior to oneself. In the same way, one should relish the meaning of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* together with *rasika* sādhus.

Anubhāṣya.

sajātīyāśaye (with desires of the same kind) **snigdhe** (devoted to tender affection whose nature is deep confidence) **svataḥ** (than oneself) **vare** (better) **sādhau saṅgaḥ** (is to be sought). **rasikaiḥ** (with those versed in the worship of Kṛṣṇa) **saha śrīmad-bhāgavatārthānām āsvādaḥ** (is to be done, that is, one should grasp the purport. A grammarian who has abandoned the *bhakti-yoga* of the path of the Śrutis; a *śābdika*, a mere master of words; one attached to women; a *gṛhavrata*; an enemy of Viṣṇu and the Vaiṣṇavas; a *māyāvādī*; an offender against the name; one who lives by his garb; one who lives by mantras; one who

lives by the *Bhāgavatam*; and a *viṣayī* devoted to gratifying the senses — with them one should not relish its meaning. For, according to the words of *śruti* and *smṛti* — "To one who has supreme devotion to God…"[36] and "The *Bhāgavatam* is grasped by devotion, not by intellect, nor by commentaries" — they cannot understand the meaning of the scripture of the *paramahaṁsas*, and they have no right to grasp the inner meaning of the book).

*The glory of worshiping the Śrī Vigraha, of *saṅkīrtana* of the holy name and especially of living in the holy *dhāma* —*

শ্রদ্ধা বিশেষতঃ প্রীতিঃ শ্রীমূর্ত্তেরঙ্ঘ্রিসেবনে ।
নামসংকীর্ত্তনং শ্রীমন্মথুরামণ্ডলে স্থিতিঃ ॥ ১২৭ ॥

śraddhā viśeṣataḥ prītiḥ
faith special love
śrī-mūrter aṅghri-sevane
of the Deity of the feet in the service
nāma-saṅkīrtanaṁ śrīman-
of the Name congregational chanting in the beautiful
mathurā-maṇḍale sthitiḥ
of Mathurā region residence

127 "With faith and with special love one should serve the feet of the Deity, chant the Holy Name in *saṅkīrtana*, and live in the beautiful region of Mathurā." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Pūrva-vibhāga, Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, 41)[18]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Out of special faith: love for serving the feet of the Śrī Mūrti, *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and living in Mathurā-maṇḍala.

Anubhāṣya.
śrī-mūrter aṅghri-sevane śraddhā viśeṣataḥ (especially) **prītiḥ** (in external worship, *arcana*, in general; in mental service to the Divine Couple of Vraja, especially: attachment to *bhajana* at all times), **nāma-saṅkīrtanam** (worship of the name), **śrīman-mathurā-maṇḍale sthitiḥ** (living where Kṛṣṇa dwells. Śrīman Narottama Prabhu determined in the *Prema-bhakti-candrikā*: to know the land of Śrī Gauḍa-maṇḍala as *cintāmaṇi* — that itself is living in Mathurā. Living in Śrī

Māyāpura and the other *dhāmas* — the land of Śrī Gaura's pastimes — and also in Śrī Kṣetra, in the *dhāmas* of the South (Dākṣiṇātya), in Vraja-maṇḍala and others should be known as nondifferent from living in Mathurā. But for those who see a difference between them, even their so-called living in Mathurā is full of material enjoyment and leads downward).

দুরূহাদ্ভুতবীর্য্যেঽস্মিন্ শ্রদ্ধা দূরেঽস্তু পঞ্চকে ।
যত্র স্বল্পোঽপি সম্বন্ধঃ সদ্ধিয়াং ভাবজন্মনে ॥ ১২৮ ॥

durūhādbhuta-vīrye ‘smin
hard to grasp wondrous in power in this
śraddhā dūre ‘stu pañcake
faith far away let it be in the group of five
yatra svalpo ‘pi sambandhaḥ
where slight even connection
sad-dhiyāṁ bhāva-janmane
for those of good understanding for the birth of bhāva

128 “The power of these five limbs is wondrous and hard to grasp. Let alone faith in them: even the slightest connection with them gives birth to *bhāva* in those of good understanding, who are free from offence.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Pūrva-vibhāga, Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, 87)[19]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

These last five limbs are hard to fathom at once, and their power is wondrous. Let alone faith in them — even the slightest connection with them becomes, for a person free from offenses, the cause of the birth of *bhāva*.

Anubhāṣya.

asmin durūhādbhuta-vīrye (hard to accomplish, unprecedented and full of power) **pañcake** (in the five limbs beginning with *sādhu-saṅga*) **śraddhā dūre astu**, (**yatra** — in which five best limbs of *sādhana*) **svalpaḥ sambandhaḥ api sad-dhiyām** (of Vaiṣṇavas of good intelligence, highly skilled) **bhāva-janmane** (is able to manifest *bhāva* — this is to be supplied).

Continuous practice of each of them brings love for Kṛṣṇa —

‘এক’ অঙ্গ সাধে, কেহ সাধে ‘বহু’ অঙ্গ ।
‘নিষ্ঠা’ হৈতে উপজয় প্রেমের তরঙ্গ ॥ ১২৯ ॥

‘eka’ aṅga sādhe, keha sādhe ‘bahu’ aṅga
one limb practises (one) someone practises many limbs
‘niṣṭhā’ haite upajaya premera taraṅga
steadiness from arise of love the waves

129 Some practise one limb, some practise many; from steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) arise the waves of love.

Anubhāṣya.
When, by practicing *bhajana*, the *jīva* is freed from *anarthas*, steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) arises. From *niṣṭhā*, *prema* is born.

Some attain perfection, love for Bhagavān, by practicing a single limb of the ninefold bhakti, others by practicing all the limbs —

‘এক’ অঙ্গে সিদ্ধি পাইল বহু ভক্তগণ ।
অম্বরীষাদি ভক্তের ‘বহু’ অঙ্গ-সাধন ॥ ১৩০ ॥

‘eka’ aṅge siddhi pāila bahu bhakta-gaṇa
by one limb perfection attained many devotees
ambarīṣādi bhaktera ‘bahu’ aṅga-sādhana
Ambarīṣa and other devotees’ of many limbs practice

130 Many devotees have attained perfection through a single limb; devotees such as Ambarīṣa practised many limbs.

The names of devotees each of whom practiced a single limb of the ninefold

bhakti —

শ্রীবিষ্ণোঃ শ্রবণে পরীক্ষিদভবদ্বৈয়াসকিঃ কীর্ত্তনে
প্রহ্লাদঃ স্মরণে তদঙ্ঘ্রিভজনে লক্ষ্মীঃ পৃথুঃ পূজনে ৷
অক্রূরস্ত্বভিবন্দনে কপিপতির্দাস্যেঽথ সখ্যেঽর্জ্জুনঃ
সর্ব্বস্বাত্মনিবেদনে বলিরভূৎ কৃষ্ণাপ্তিরেষাং পরম্ ॥ ১৩১ ॥

śrī-viṣṇoḥ śravaṇe parīkṣid abhavad vaiyāsakiḥ kīrtane
of Śrī Viṣṇu in hearing Parīkṣit was the son of Vyāsa in glorifying
prahlādaḥ smaraṇe tad-aṅghri-bhajane lakṣmīḥ pṛthuḥ pūjane
Prahlāda in remembering His feet in serving Lakṣmī Pṛthu in worship
akrūras tv abhivandane kapi-patir dāsye 'tha sakhye 'rjunaḥ
Akrūra and in offering prayers the lord of the monkeys in servitude and in friendship Arjuna
sarva-svātma-nivedane balir abhūt kṛṣṇāptir eṣāṁ param
of all he had and himself in the offering Bali was the attainment of Kṛṣṇa of these the highest

131 "Parīkṣit attained perfection by hearing about Śrī Viṣṇu; Śukadeva, the son of Vyāsa, by glorifying Him; Prahlāda by remembering Him; Lakṣmī by serving His feet; Pṛthu by worship; Akrūra by offering prayers; Hanumān, lord of the monkeys, by servitude; Arjuna by friendship; and Bali by offering all he had and himself. All of them attained Kṛṣṇa in the highest way." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.265)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

King Parīkṣit attained Kṛṣṇa in the best way by hearing about Śrī Viṣṇu; Śukadeva by glorifying Him; Prahlāda by remembering Him; Lakṣmī by serving His feet; King Pṛthu by worshiping Him; Akrūra by offering Him prayers; Hanumān, the lord of the monkeys, by serving Him as a servant; Arjuna by friendship with Him; and Bali by offering Him all he had, and himself.

Anubhāṣya.

parīkṣit (Viṣṇurāta) **śrī-viṣṇoḥ śravaṇe** (by hearing the names, form, qualities and pastimes of Kṛṣṇa described in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*), **vaiyāsakiḥ** (Brahmarāta Śukadeva) **kīrtane** (by the *kīrtana* of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, which is *hari-kathā*), **prahlādaḥ** (of Viṣṇu) **smaraṇe** (since his heart was pure), **lakṣmīḥ tad-**

aṅghri-bhajane (by serving the lotus feet of Nārāyaṇa), **pṛthuḥ** (of Viṣṇu) **pūjane** (by *arcana*), **akrūraḥ tu** (to the Yādava) **abhivandane**, **kapi-patiḥ** (Hanumān) **dāsye** (by service to Rāma alone), **arjunaḥ** (with Kṛṣṇa) **sakhye**, **baliḥ** (Prahlāda's grandson) **sarva-svātma-nivedane** (by self-surrender) **param** (exclusively [in this] was fixed) **abhūt**; **eṣām** (of these servants of Hari — by fidelity to a single limb alone) **kṛṣṇāptiḥ** (the attainment of Kṛṣṇa) **abhūt**.

Ambarīṣa serves Kṛṣṇa with all his senses —

স বৈ মনঃ কৃষ্ণপদারবিন্দয়ো-
র্ব্বচাংসি বৈকুণ্ঠগুণানুবর্ণনে ৷
করৌ হরের্মন্দিরমার্জ্জনাদিষু
শ্রুতিঞ্চকারাচ্যুতসৎকথোদয়ে ॥ ১৩২ ॥

sa vai manaḥ kṛṣṇa-padāravindayor
he indeed the mind of Kṛṣṇa on the lotus feet
vacāṁsi vaikuṇṭha-guṇānuvarṇane
words of the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha of the qualities in describing
karau harer mandira-mārjanādiṣu
the hands of Hari of the temple in cleaning and the like
śrutiṁ cakārācyuta-sat-kathodaye
the ears he engaged about Acyuta holy narrations in the telling

132 “King Ambarīṣa engaged his mind on Kṛṣṇa’s lotus feet, his words in describing the qualities of the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha, his hands in cleaning Hari’s temple and similar service, and his ears in hearing the holy narrations of Acyuta.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.18)

মুকুন্দলিঙ্গালয়দর্শনে দৃশৌ
তদ্ভৃত্যগাত্রস্পর্শেঽঙ্গসঙ্গমম্ ৷
ঘ্রাণঞ্চ তৎপাদসরোজসৌরভে
শ্রীমত্তুলস্যা রসনাং তদর্পিতে ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

mukunda-liṅgālaya-darśane dṛśau
of Mukunda of the images of the temples in seeing the eyes
tad-bhṛtya-gātra-sparśe ‘ṅga-saṅgamam
of His servants of the bodies in touching the touch of his limbs
ghrāṇaṁ ca tat-pāda-saroja-saurabhe
the sense of smell and of His feet lotus in the fragrance
śrīmat-tulasyā rasanāṁ tad-arpite
of the beautiful Tulasī the tongue offered to Him in what was

133 “He engaged his eyes in seeing Mukunda’s Deities and temples, his body in touching the bodies of the Lord’s servants, his sense of smell in the fragrance of the beautiful Tulasī at the Lord’s lotus feet, and his tongue in what had been offered to Him.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.19)

পাদৌ হরেঃ ক্ষেত্রপদানুসর্পণে
শিরো হৃষীকেশপদাভিবন্দনে ৷
কামঞ্চ দাস্যে ন তু কামকাম্যয়া
যথোত্তমঃশ্লোকজনাশ্রয়া রতিঃ ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

pādau hareḥ kṣetra-padānusarpaṇe
the feet of Hari holy places along the paths in walking
śiro hṛṣīkeśa-padābhivandane
the head of Hṛṣīkeśa to the feet in bowing
kāmaṁ ca dāsye na tu kāma-kāmyayā
desire and in servitude not but for the sake of enjoyment
yathottamaḥ śloka-janāśrayā ratiḥ
so that of Uttamaśloka in the devotees sheltered attraction

134 “He engaged his feet in walking to the Lord’s holy places, his head in bowing to the feet of Hṛṣīkeśa, and his desire in servitude, not in seeking enjoyment — so that there arose in him the attraction (*rati*) that takes shelter of the devotees of Uttamaśloka.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.20)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mahārāja Ambarīṣa engaged his mind in Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, his speech in describing the qualities of Vaikuṇṭha, his two hands in cleaning Hari's temple and similar

service, his ears in narrations of Kṛṣṇa, his two eyes in seeing Kṛṣṇa's Śrī Mūrti, his body in touching the bodies of Kṛṣṇa's servants, his sense of smell (his nose) in the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, his tongue in tasting the *tulasī* offered to Kṛṣṇa, his two feet in walking to Kṛṣṇa's holy places, his head in bowing at the feet of Hṛṣīkeśa, and his "desire" (*kāma*) in selfless servitude. And he engaged them in such a way that there arose in him the *rati* whose shelter is Kṛṣṇa's devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

When Viṣṇurāta Parīkṣit asked about the transcendental life of the *mahā-bhāgavata* Ambarīṣa, the guru of the *brāhmaṇas* — a life full of service to Kṛṣṇa — Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī glorifies how Ambarīṣa served Hṛṣīkeśa with all his senses:

uttamaḥśloka-janāśrayā (following the servants of Hari) **ratiḥ** (attraction) **yathā** (might arise, so) **saḥ ambarīṣaḥ kṛṣṇa-padāravindayoḥ** (on Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet) **manaḥ**, **vaikuṇṭha-guṇānuvarṇane** (in telling the glories of Hari's qualities) **vacāṁsi** (his words), **harer mandira-mārjanādiṣu** (in washing, smearing and other service to the Lord's temple and the Vaiṣṇavas' feet, in *nīrājana*, or in drawing the marks of the conch, the disc, the *ūrdhva-puṇḍra* and the like) **karau** (his arms), **acyuta-sat-kathodaye** (when the true narrations of Acyuta, Viṣṇu, arise) **śrutim** (his two ears), **mukunda-liṅgālaya-darśane** (in seeing the temples, the abodes of Kṛṣṇa's "*liṅgas*," that is, His *arcā* forms) **dṛśau** (his eyes), **tad-bhṛtya-gātra-sparśe** (in touching the bodies of Hari's servants) **aṅga-saṅgamam** (touch with the skin, with the head), **śrīmat-tulasyāḥ** (of the beautiful Tulasī) **tat-pāda-saroja-saurabhe** (in the fragrance of the Lord's lotus feet) **ghrāṇam** (his nose), **tad-arpite** (in *mahā-prasāda* and whatever else is offered to Kṛṣṇa) **rasanām** (his tongue), **hareḥ kṣetra-padānusarpaṇe** (in circumambulating the *dhāma* and the like) **pādau**, **hṛṣīkeśa-padābhivandane** (in bowing to Govinda's feet and the like) **śiraḥ** (his head), **dāsye** (in accepting as *mahā-prasāda* the garlands, scents, garments, ornaments and other things the Lord has used) **kāmaṁ ca**, **na tu kāma-kāmyayā** (with the desire to enjoy), **cakāra** (engaged).

A devotee fully surrendered is under no obligation to anyone but Kṛṣṇa —

কাম ত্যজি' কৃষ্ণ ভজে শাস্ত্র-আজ্ঞা মানি' ।
দেব-ঋষি-পিতৃদিগের কভু নহে ঋণী ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

kāma tyaji' kṛṣṇa bhaje śāstra-ājñā māni'
desires giving up Kṛṣṇa worships of scripture the command honouring
deva-ṛṣi-pitṛdigera kabhu nahe ṛṇī
to the gods the sages the forefathers ever is not a debtor

135 One who gives up desires and worships Kṛṣṇa, honouring the command of scripture, is never in debt to the gods, the sages or the forefathers.

*For one qualified for *vaidhī-bhakti*, the rites of *karma-kāṇḍa* — the five sacrifices (*pañca-yajña*) and the rest — are unnecessary —*

দেবর্ষিভূতাপ্তনৃণাং পিতৃণাং
ন কিঙ্করো নায়মৃণী চ রাজন্ ।
সর্ব্বাত্মনা যঃ শরণং শরণ্যং
গতো মুকুন্দং পরিহৃত্য কর্ত্তম্ ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

devarṣi-bhūtāpta-nṛṇāṁ pitṝṇāṁ
of the gods sages beings kinsmen men of the forefathers
na kiṅkaro nāyam ṛṇī ca rājan
not a servant nor he a debtor and O king
sarvātmanā yaḥ śaraṇaṁ śaraṇyaṁ
with his whole being who for shelter to the giver of shelter
gato mukundaṁ parihṛtya kartam
has gone to Mukunda giving up his duties

136 "O king, one who has given up his duties and with his whole being has gone for shelter to Mukunda, the giver of shelter, is no longer a servant or a debtor to the gods, the sages, other beings, his kinsmen, mankind or the forefathers." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.41)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O King, one who has given up worldly duties and with his whole being taken shelter of Mukunda, the giver of shelter, is no longer a debtor to the gods, the sages, the other living beings, his kinsmen or the ancestors. The meaning is this. As soon as a person is born, he becomes a debtor of all these debts, and, as the scriptures prescribe, he repays them by performing many kinds of duties. But one

who has given up all desires and taken shelter at Kṛṣṇa's feet finds all these debts repaid even without performing the prescribed rites.

Anubhāṣya.

The debt to the gods, the debt to the sages, the debt to the ancestors, the debt to living beings and the debt to men — these five debts are cleared by the five sacrifices. “Teaching is the sacrifice to Brahman; *tarpaṇa* is the sacrifice to the ancestors; *homa* is the sacrifice to the gods; *bali* is the sacrifice to beings; honoring guests is the sacrifice to men.”[37] By *homa* the *deva-yajña* is performed, by teaching the *brahma-yajña* or *ṛṣi-yajña*, by *tarpaṇa* the *pitṛ-yajña*, by *bali* the *bhūta-yajña*, and by honoring guests the *nṛ-yajña*.

While describing *bhāgavata-dharma* to Vasudeva, Śrī Nārada recounted the conversation of Nimi, the king of Videha, with the nine Yogendras. First eight Yogendras answered Nimi's questions in turn. Then one of them, the sage Karabhājana, described to Nimi the different colors of the four *yuga-avatāras* of Bhagavān Viṣṇu and the different ways they are worshiped, and the future appearance of Vaiṣṇavas in various places in Bhārata. And at the very end he glorifies, in the following two verses, the greatness of one exclusively surrendered to Kṛṣṇa:

rājan (O King), **yaḥ** (a person) **kartam** (a distinction that has been made, or one's own *dharma*) **parihṛtya** (giving up) **sarvātmanā** (with body, mind and words) **śaraṇyam** (the shelter of all) **mukundaṁ śaraṇaṁ gataḥ**, (**saḥ**) **ayam devarṣi-bhūtāpta-nṛṇām** (of the gods, the sages, the beings, the *āptas* — the dependents of one's household — and of men) **pitṝṇām na kiṅkaraḥ** (is not obliged) **na ṛṇī ca** (therefore one who has taken shelter of the path of bhakti has no need at all to perform the five sacrifices and the rest, as the *karmīs* who desire fruits must).

A Vaiṣṇava is never a sinner, and a sinner is never a Vaiṣṇava —

বিধি-ধর্ম্ম ছাড়ি’ ভজে কৃষ্ণের চরণ ।
নিষিদ্ধ পাপাচারে তার কভু নহে মন ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

vidhi-dharma chāḍi’ bhaje kṛṣṇera caraṇa
of rules the dharma giving up worships of Kṛṣṇa the feet
niṣiddha pāpācāre tāra kabhu nahe mana
to forbidden sinful conduct his ever does not go mind

137 One who gives up the *dharma* of rules and worships Kṛṣṇa's feet never turns his mind to forbidden, sinful conduct.

*Even if a *sādhaka* sins by chance, by Kṛṣṇa's mercy his sin is completely removed —*

অজ্ঞানে বা হয় যদি 'পাপ' উপস্থিত ।
কৃষ্ণ তাঁরে শুদ্ধ করে, না করায় প্রায়শ্চিত্ত ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

ajñāne vā haya yadi 'pāpa' upasthita
through ignorance or happens if sin occurs
kṛṣṇa tāṁre śuddha kare, nā karāya prāyaścitta
Kṛṣṇa him pure makes not makes him perform atonement

138 And if through ignorance he should fall into 'sin', Kṛṣṇa purifies him; He does not make him perform atonement.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who has given up all the forms of *dharma* based on Vedic injunctions and worships the Lord as a *niṣkiñcana*, one who has nothing but Kṛṣṇa, by his very nature has no inclination toward any forbidden sin. And if for some reason a sin does occur, that is, happens to be committed, Kṛṣṇa purifies him without making him perform any atonement.

*As the indwelling Lord, the *caitya-guru*, He purifies one of sin —*

স্বপাদমূলং ভজতঃ প্রিয়স্য
ত্যক্তান্যভাবস্য হরিঃ পরেশঃ ।
বিকর্ম্ম যচ্চোৎপতিতং কথঞ্চিৎ
ধুনোতি সর্ব্বং হৃদি সন্নিবিষ্টঃ ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

sva-pāda-mūlaṁ bhajataḥ priyasya
His own of the feet the root of one who worships the dear one
tyaktānya-bhāvasya hariḥ pareśaḥ
who has given up other feelings Hari the Supreme Lord
vikarma yac cotpatitaṁ kathañcit
sinful act which and has occurred somehow
dhunoti sarvaṁ hṛdi sanniviṣṭaḥ
removes all in the heart residing

139 "Should a dear devotee who worships the root of His feet, having given up every other feeling, somehow commit a sinful act, Hari, the Supreme Lord, seated in his heart, removes it all." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who, giving up every other feeling, serves the feet of Hari Himself — if such a person, dear to Kṛṣṇa, ever somehow commits *vikarma* (sin), the Supreme Lord Hari, staying in his heart, destroys that sin.

Anubhāṣya.
sva-pāda-mūlam (His own lotus feet) **bhajataḥ** (of one who serves) **priyasya** (full of love) **tyaktānya-bhāvasya** (of one who has given up feeling for anything other than pure, desireless service to Bhagavān Hari — for the body and the like, or for other gods; that is, of one devoted to exclusive bhakti) **kathañcit** (through inattention and the like) **yat vikarma** (a forbidden act) **utpatitam** (committed through ill fate) **bhavet**, **tat api sarvaṁ pareśaḥ hariḥ hṛdi sanniviṣṭaḥ** (staying as the indwelling Lord) **dhunoti** (destroys).

**Jñāna* and *vairāgya*, properties of the mind, are never limbs of bhakti, the property of the soul; they are only two sons who follow bhakti —*

জ্ঞান-বৈরাগ্যাদি — ভক্তির কভু নহে 'অঙ্গ' ।
অহিংসা-যম-নিয়মাদি বুলে কৃষ্ণভক্ত-সঙ্গ ॥ ১৪০ ॥

jñāna-vairāgyādi — bhaktira kabhu nahe 'aṅga'
knowledge renunciation and the like of bhakti ever are not limbs
ahiṁsā-yama-niyamādi bule kṛṣṇa-bhakta-saṅga
non-violence yama niyama and the like accompany of Kṛṣṇa's devotees the company

140 Knowledge (jñāna), renunciation (*vairāgya*) and the like are never limbs of devotion. Non-violence, restraint (*yama*), regulation (*niyama*) and the like follow along in the company of Kṛṣṇa's devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Many people mistakenly think that *jñāna*, and the *vairāgya* born of *karma*, are steps to devotion to Bhagavān. In truth they certainly are not. Detachment born of *jñāna* or *karma* is not directed to the soul's own nature (*svarūpa*); it is a particular, changeable property of a temporary state. Therefore it is not a limb of eternal service to Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-dāsya*). The fruit of *karma* or *jñāna* is a particular transformation of changeable, temporary experience, and it culminates in enjoyment or liberation. Therefore it has no connection at all with eternal bhakti. Pure bhakti can exist only when *jñāna* or *vairāgya* is given up. A devotee of Kṛṣṇa is by nature free from violence, self-controlled and devoted to regulation. He does not have to acquire these virtues.

*Without bhakti, *jñāna* and *vairāgya* do not bring the highest good —*

তস্মান্মদ্ভক্তিযুক্তস্য যোগিনো বৈ মদাত্মনঃ ।
ন জ্ঞানং ন চ বৈরাগ্যং প্রায়ঃ শ্রেয়ো ভবেদিহ ॥ ১৪১ ॥

tasmān mad-bhakti-yuktasya
therefore in devotion to Me engaged
yogino vai mad-ātmanaḥ
of a yogī indeed whose mind is in Me
na jñānaṁ na ca vairāgyaṁ
not knowledge nor and renunciation
prāyaḥ śreyo bhaved iha
as a rule the highest good is here

141 "Therefore, for the *yogī* engaged in devotion to Me, whose mind is in Me, neither knowledge nor renunciation is, as a rule, the means to the highest good in this world." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.20.31)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

For a yogī dear to Me, endowed with devotion to Me and with his mind fixed on Me alone, efforts for *jñāna* and *vairāgya* are generally not beneficial. The meaning is this: bhakti is by its very nature independent. *Jñāna*, *vairāgya*,

yoga and the rest may be slightly useful to it at first, but they are not counted among its limbs.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīmad Uddhava heard from Kṛṣṇa that the *jīva's* desire to enjoy arises from the words of the Vedas — the Lord's commands in the form of injunctions and prohibitions — and that by those same words of the Vedas the sense of separateness is destroyed. Then he asked how to remove the confusion, or bewilderment, that this causes in the *jīva's* mind. In reply Bhagavān first compares the paths of *karma*, *jñāna* and bhakti, and then describes the supremacy of bhakti:

tasmāt (since bhakti is free from all *upādhis*) **vai** (certainly) **mad-bhakti-yuktasya mad-ātmanaḥ** (of one whose mind is in Me, Kṛṣṇa) **yoginaḥ** (of a person engaged in *bhakti-yoga*) **iha na jñānam**, **na ca vairāgyaṁ prāyaḥ śreyaḥ** (the cause of the highest good) **bhavet**.

A pure devotee does not disturb others —

এতে ন হ্যদ্ভুতা ব্যাধ তবাহিংসাদয়ো গুণাঃ ৷
হরিভক্তৌ প্রবৃত্তা যে ন তে স্যুঃ পরতাপিনঃ ॥ ১৪২ ॥

ete na hy adbhutā vyādha
these not indeed wonderful O hunter
tavāhiṁsādayo guṇāḥ
your non-violence and the other virtues
hari-bhaktau pravṛttā ye
in devotion to Hari engaged who
na te syuḥ para-tāpinaḥ
not they are causing pain to others

142 “O hunter, it is no wonder that you have non-violence and these other virtues: those who are engaged in devotion to Hari never cause pain to others.” (Skanda-purāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O hunter, it is not surprising that nonviolence and the other virtues have appeared in you: those who have taken up *hari-bhakti* cause no suffering to others.

Anubhāṣya.

vyādha (O hunter), **tava ete ahiṁsādayaḥ guṇāḥ adbhutāḥ** (extraordinary) **na**, **hi** (because) **ye** (people) **hari-bhaktau** (in the worship of Kṛṣṇa) **pravṛttāḥ** (engaged), **te** (devotees) **para-tāpinaḥ** (bent on harming others) **na syuḥ** (are).

*(b) Description of *rāgānugā-bhakti**

বৈধীভক্তি-সাধনের কহিলুঁ বিবরণ ।
রাগানুগা-ভক্তির লক্ষণ শুন, সনাতন ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

vaidhī-bhakti-sādhanera kahiluṁ vivaraṇa
of vaidhī-bhakti of the practice I have told the description
rāgānugā-bhaktira lakṣaṇa śuna, sanātana
of rāgānugā-bhakti the characteristics hear Sanātana

143 I have described to you the practice of *vaidhī-bhakti*. Now, Sanātana, hear the characteristics of *rāgānugā-bhakti*.

*What *rāgātmikā-* and *rāgānugā-bhakti* are —*

রাগাত্মিকা-ভক্তি — 'মুখ্যা' ব্রজবাসি-জনে ।
তার অনুগত ভক্তির 'রাগানুগা'-নামে ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

rāgātmikā-bhakti — 'mukhyā' vraja-vāsi-jane
rāgātmikā-bhakti pre-eminent in the people of Vraja
tāra anugata bhaktira 'rāgānugā'-nāme
it following of the devotion rāgānugā by name

144 *Rāgātmikā-bhakti*, devotion whose very nature is *rāga*, is found pre-eminently in the people of Vraja. Devotion that follows it is called *rāgānugā*.[20]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The bhakti of the devotees who live in Vraja, whose nature is *rāga*, is the principal one (*mukhyā*); that is, such bhakti exists nowhere else. And the bhakti that lives in following the residents of Vraja is called *rāgānugā-bhakti*.

*The definition of *rāgātmikā-bhakti* —*

ইষ্টে স্বারসিকী রাগঃ পরমাবিষ্টতা ভবেৎ ।
তন্ময়ী যা ভবেদ্ভক্তিঃ সাত্র রাগাত্মিকোদিতা ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

iṣṭe svārasikī rāgaḥ
for the beloved natural rāga
paramāviṣṭatā bhavet
supreme absorption is
tan-mayī yā bhaved bhaktiḥ
with it filled which is devotion
sātra rāgātmikoditā
it here rāgātmikā is called

145 "Natural, intense absorption in one's beloved is *rāga*. Devotion filled with such *rāga* is here called *rāgātmikā*." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.272)[21]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The natural inclination to serve the beloved (*iṣṭa-vastu*), full of supreme absorption, is called *rāga*. When *kṛṣṇa-bhakti* is *tanmayī*, full of such *rāga*, it is called *rāgātmikā*.

Anubhāṣya.

iṣṭe (in the cherished object — that) **svārasikī** (natural, full of deep thirst, suited to one's own perfected *rasa*) **paramāviṣṭatā** (the inclination to serve, full of absorption in it — that) **rāgaḥ bhavet**. **tanmayī** (full of such *rāga*) **yā bhaktiḥ bhavet**, **atra** (in the literature of the pure devotees) **sā 'rāgātmikā' uditā** (is called).

*The essential (*svarūpa*) and the accompanying (*taṭastha*) characteristics of *rāgātmikā-bhakti* — "deep thirst" and "absorption" —*

ইষ্টে 'গাঢ়-তৃষ্ণা' — রাগের স্বরূপ-লক্ষণ ।
ইষ্টে 'আবিষ্টতা' — তটস্থ-লক্ষণ কথন ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

iṣṭe 'gāḍha-tṛṣṇā' — rāgera svarūpa-lakṣaṇa
for the beloved intense thirst of rāga the essential characteristic
iṣṭe 'āviṣṭatā' — taṭastha-lakṣaṇa kathana
in the beloved absorption the marginal characteristic is said to be

146 Intense thirst for the beloved is the essential characteristic of *rāga*; absorption in the beloved is said to be its marginal characteristic.

Anubhāṣya.
In what is favorable to oneself, that is, in the cherished object, *rāga* in the form of deep thirst is the principal, that is, the essential characteristic (*svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*). And knowing by effects — what is called the accompanying characteristic (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*) — is here absorption in the cherished object.

রাগময়ী-ভক্তির হয় 'রাগাত্মিকা'-নাম ।
তাহা শুনি' লুব্ধ হয় কোন ভাগ্যবান্ ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

rāgamayī-bhaktira haya 'rāgātmikā'-nāma
filled with rāga of devotion is rāgātmikā the name
tāhā śuni' lubdha haya kona bhāgyavān
of it hearing filled with longing becomes some fortunate one

147 Devotion full of *rāga* is named *rāgātmikā*. Hearing of it, some fortunate soul is filled with longing (*lobha*) for it.

*The nature, or characteristic, of a *rāgānugā* devotee —*

লোভে ব্রজবাসীর ভাবে করে অনুগতি ।
শাস্ত্রযুক্তি নাহি মানে রাগানুগার প্রকৃতি ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

lobhe vraja-vāsīra bhāve kare anugati
out of longing of the people of Vraja the mood he makes following
śāstra-yukti nāhi māne rāgānugāra prakṛti
of scripture the arguments does not heed of the rāgānugā the nature

148 Out of that longing he follows the mood of the people of Vraja. Such is the nature of *rāgānugā*: it does not wait upon the arguments of scripture.[22]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Anugati means following.

Anubhāṣya.

To be captivated by the *bhāva* of the residents of Vraja and to follow the desire for that *bhāva* is the natural inclination of *rāgānugā* devotees. Devotees in whom taste has awakened (*jāta-ruci*) are by their very nature highly skilled in scriptural reasoning. And when someone else comes with scriptural arguments against their eternally perfect taste, they do not accept them. One should know that the *prākṛta-sahajiyās* and other *sampradāyas* that have taken to a wrong path in fact lack awakened taste (*ajāta-ruci*). In the conceit of being *rāgānugā*, they give up the study of the books of bhakti and the path that follows Śrī Rūpa, nourish mundane tastes fit for libertines and fools, and so bring about their own ruin. They are deceived and unfortunate.

*The definition of *rāgānugā-bhakti* —*

বিরাজন্তীমভিব্যক্তাং ব্রজবাসিজনাদিষু ।
রাগাত্মিকামনুসৃতা যা সা রাগানুগোচ্যতে ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

virājantīm abhivyaktāṁ
shining clearly manifest
vraja-vāsi-janādiṣu
in the people of Vraja and others
rāgātmikām anusṛtā
rāgātmikā following
yā sā rāgānugocyate
which it rāgānugā is called

149 “Devotion that follows the *rāgātmikā* devotion shining, clearly manifest, in the people of Vraja is called *rāgānugā*.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.270)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among the residents of Vraja and others, *rāgātmikā-bhakti* shines in manifest form. And the bhakti that follows (*anusṛtā*, that is, *anugatā*) that bhakti is *rāgānugā-bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

yā vrajavāsi-janādiṣu abhivyaktām (so as to be clearly manifest) **virājantīm** (shining) **rāgātmikām** (belonging to the nature of the eternally perfect people of Vraja) **bhaktim anusṛtā** (following), **sā 'rāgānugā' ucyate**.

তত্তদ্ভাবাদিমাধুর্য্যে শ্রুতে ধীর্যদপেক্ষতে ।
নাত্র শাস্ত্রং ন যুক্তিঞ্চ তল্লোভোৎপত্তিলক্ষণম্ ॥ ১৫০ ॥

tat-tad-bhāvādi-mādhurye
of their respective moods and the like in the sweetness
śrute dhīr yad apekṣate
when it is heard the intellect that depends on
nātra śāstraṁ na yuktiṁ ca
not here scripture nor reasoning and
tal lobhotpatti-lakṣaṇam
that of longing of the arising the sign

150 "When one hears of the sweetness of their moods and the rest, and the intellect is drawn to it without waiting upon scripture or reasoning — that is the sign that longing has arisen." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.292)[23]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When one hears of the sweetness of the *bhāvas* and the rest of the residents of Vraja, the intelligence relies on greed (*lobha*) — and this is what gives one the qualification for *rāgānugā-bhakti*. Neither scripture nor reasoning is the sign that this greed has arisen.

Anubhāṣya.

(From the mouth of a guru who is a *mahā-bhāgavata* with awakened taste, or from perfect scriptures such as *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and the *Padma Purāṇa*) **tat-tad-bhāvādi-mādhurye** (the sweetness of the *bhāvas* and the rest of the residents of Vraja — *bhāvas* that rest in the *rasas* of *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*) **śrute** (when it is experienced through hearing) **yat** (whose) **dhīḥ** (the intelligence) **atra** (here) **śāstram** (scriptural injunction) **na**, **yuktim** (deliberation) **ca na apekṣate** (but acts of itself, by its own nature) — **tad eva lobhotpatti-lakṣaṇam** (the sign that *rāga* has arisen).

*The twofold practice of *rāgānugā-bhakti* by one freed from *anarthas* — in the body of a *sādhaka* and in the *siddha-deha* —*

বাহ্য, অভ্যন্তর, — ইহার দুই ত' সাধন ।
'বাহ্যে' সাধক-দেহে করে শ্রবণ-কীর্ত্তন ॥ ১৫১ ॥

bāhya, abhyantara, — ihāra dui ta' sādhana
external internal of it two indeed practices
'bāhye' sādhaka-dehe kare śravaṇa-kīrtana
externally in the body of a sādhaka he does hearing and chanting

151 Its practice is of two kinds, external and internal. Externally, in the body of a practitioner (*sādhaka*), he hears and chants;

'মনে' নিজ-সিদ্ধদেহ করিয়া ভাবন ।
রাত্রি-দিনে করে ব্রজে কৃষ্ণের সেবন ॥ ১৫২ ॥

'mane' nija-siddha-deha kariyā bhāvana
in the mind his own perfected body making contemplation
rātri-dine kare vraje kṛṣṇera sevana
night and day he does in Vraja to Kṛṣṇa service

152 and in his mind, contemplating his own perfected spiritual body (*siddha-deha*), he serves Kṛṣṇa in Vraja night and day.

The evidence of scripture —

সেবা সাধকরূপেণ সিদ্ধরূপেণ চাত্র হি ।
তদ্ভাবলিপ্সুনা কার্য্যা ব্রজলোকানুসারতঃ ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

sevā sādhaka-rūpeṇa
service in the form of a sādhaka
siddha-rūpeṇa cātra hi
in the perfected form and here indeed
tad-bhāva-lipsunā kāryā
for their bhāva by one who longs is to be done
vraja-lokānusārataḥ
the people of Vraja following

153 “One who longs for the *bhāva* of the people of Vraja should serve, following them, both in the form of a *sādhaka* and in the perfected form.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.295)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those in whom greed for *rāgātmikā-bhakti* has arisen should, following the activities of the people of Vraja, render external service in the form of a *sādhaka* and internal service in the form of a *siddha*.

Anubhāṣya.

atra (in the *sādhana* of *rāgānugā-bhakti*) **tad-bhāva-lipsunā** (by one who longs for the *bhāva* of his own cherished one in Vraja — the guru, dearest to Kṛṣṇa — and wishes, by following him, to make it his own) **sādhaka-rūpeṇa** (in the body of a *sādhaka*, holding to the bhakti called *kīrtana* and the rest) **siddha-rūpeṇa** (with the mental body fit for eternal service in *svarūpa-siddhi*) **ca vraja-lokānusārataḥ** (following the people of Vraja who have that *anurāga*) **sevā hi kāryā** (should be done).

*The *rāgānuga* devotee, at every moment following the guru, renders perfected service to his cherished one —*

নিজাভীষ্ট কৃষ্ণপ্রেষ্ঠ পাছে ত’ লাগিয়া ।
নিরন্তর সেবা করে অন্তর্ম্মনা হঞা ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

nijābhīṣṭa kṛṣṇa-preṣṭha pāche ta’ lāgiyā
his own chosen of Kṛṣṇa dear one behind indeed keeping close
nirantara sevā kare antarmanā hañā
constantly service he does with mind turned within becoming

154 Keeping close behind the dear one of Kṛṣṇa whom his heart has chosen, he serves without cease, his mind turned within.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those dearest to Kṛṣṇa are the devotees who live in Vraja. Whoever longs for the sweetness of one of these devotees of Vraja and considers following him to be the service he desires keeps behind him and, with his mind turned within, constantly serves Kṛṣṇa.

*The *rāgānuga* devotee, freed from *anarthas*, in solitude remembers his cherished one, and so on —*

কৃষ্ণং স্মরন্ জনঞ্চাস্য প্রেষ্ঠং নিজসমীহিতম্ ।
তত্তৎকথা-রতশ্চাসৌ কুর্য্যাদ্বাসং ব্রজে সদা ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

kṛṣṇaṁ smaran janaṁ cāsya
Kṛṣṇa remembering the person and His
preṣṭhaṁ nija-samīhitam
dearest his own chosen
tat-tat-kathā-rataś cāsau
in their respective narrations absorbed and he
kuryād vāsaṁ vraje sadā
should make residence in Vraja always

155 "Remembering Kṛṣṇa and that dearest devotee of His whom he has chosen as his own, and absorbed in narrations about them, he should always live in Vraja." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.294)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Always remembering Kṛṣṇa and the one he himself has chosen from among those dearest to Him, and absorbed in narrations about them, he should always live in Vraja. If he cannot live in Vraja in body, he should live in Vraja at least in mind.

Anubhāṣya.

kṛṣṇaṁ ca asya (Kṛṣṇa's) **preṣṭhaṁ** (dearest) **nija-samīhitaṁ** (his own cherished) **janaṁ ca smaran asau** (the *sādhaka*) **tat-tat-kathā-rataḥ** (devoted to the narrations befitting that *rasa*) **sadā** (eternally) **vraje** (in Vṛndāvana, which is full of service to Nandanandana) **vāsaṁ kuryāt** (should establish eternal residence, in the gross body or even in the mind. The idea is this: one devoid of the worship of Kṛṣṇa, bewildered by the enjoyment of material objects, never lives in the *dhāma*. But one who is always engaged in *bhajana* lives day after day in the eternal *dhāma*, even if by worldly sight he stays elsewhere).

*The *rāgānuga* serves Kṛṣṇa in four *rasas*; *śānta-rasa* has no place here*

—

দাস-সখা-পিত্রাদি-প্রেয়সীর গণ ।
রাগমার্গে নিজ-নিজ-ভাবের গণন ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

dāsa-sakhā-pitrādi-preyasīra gaṇa
of servants friends parents and others beloveds the groups
rāga-mārge nija-nija-bhāvera gaṇana
on the path of rāga of each one's own bhāva the reckoning

156 Servants, friends, parents and the others, and the beloveds: on the path of *rāga* each devotee is reckoned among them according to his own *bhāva*.

*The *rāgānuga* devotee, related to Kṛṣṇa in the four *rasas* and devoted to Him alone, is beyond time and *prakṛti* —*

ন কর্হিচিন্মৎপরাঃ শান্তরূপে
নঙ্ক্ষ্যন্তি নো মেঽনিমিষো লেঢ়ি হেতিঃ ।
যেষামহং প্রিয় আত্মা সুতশ্চ
সখা গুরুঃ সুহৃদো দৈবমিষ্টম্ ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

na karhicin mat-parāḥ śānta-rūpe
never ever devoted to Me in the abode of peace
naṅkṣyanti no me 'nimiṣo leḍhi hetiḥ
will perish not My time devours weapon
yeṣām aham priya ātmā sutaś ca
for whom I the beloved the Self son and
sakhā guruḥ suhṛdo daivam iṣṭam
friend guru well-wisher deity the desired

157 (Lord Kapila to Devahūti:) "Those devoted to Me, for whom I am the beloved, the Self, son, friend, guru, well-wisher, deity and all they desire, are never lost in My abode of peace, and My weapon, time, does not devour them." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.38)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those for whom I am the beloved, the Self, the son, the friend, the guru, the well-wisher, the deity and the cherished one are always devoted to Me. O mother of peaceful form, My wheel of time never destroys them.

Anubhāṣya.

The venerable (*bhagavān*) sage Maitreya recounts to Vidura the conversation of Kapila and Devahūti. Devahūti asked Bhagavān Kapiladeva about *bhakti-yoga* and the truth of the self (*ātma-tattva*). Glorifying pure *bhakti-yoga*, known as *sāṅkhya-yoga*, He first says that bhakti is the best *abhidheya* and then glorifies the greatness of the pure devotees, the servants of Hari:

(O mother,) **śānta-rūpe** (in Me, the object of steadfast faith — or in the eternal abode Vaikuṇṭha, where form is *śānta*, that is, free from change: pure *sattva*) **yeṣām** (of the devotees) **ahaṁ priyaḥ** (the object of love), **sutaḥ** (the object of affection), **ātmā** (the dearest), **sakhā** (the one they trust), **guruḥ** (the instructor), **suhṛdaḥ** (the benefactor) **iṣṭaṁ daivam** (the object of worship; they alone) **mat-parāḥ** (are My devotees), (therefore, protected by Me) **karhicit** (ever) **na naṅkṣyanti** (do not become featureless, deprived of enjoyment, since) **animiṣaḥ** (time) **me** (My) **hetiḥ** (wheel of time) **na leḍhi** (does not devour them).

*Obeisances to the *rāgānuga* devotees —*

পতিপুত্রসুহৃদ্ভ্রাতৃপিতৃবন্মিত্রবদ্ধরিম্ ।
যে ধ্যায়ন্তি সদোদ্যুক্তাস্তেভ্যোঽপীহ নমো নমঃ ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

pati-putra-suhṛd-bhrātṛ-
husband son well-wisher brother
pitṛvan mitravad dharim
as father as friend on Hari
ye dhyāyanti sadodyuktās
who meditate always zealous
tebhyo 'pīha namo namaḥ
to them even here obeisance obeisance

158 "Again and again I bow to those in this world who always zealously meditate on Hari as their husband, son, well-wisher, brother, father or friend." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.308)[24]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Again and again I bow to those who always, with eagerness, meditate on Hari as husband, son, well-wisher, brother, father, friend and so on.

Anubhāṣya.

iha (in this world) **ye** (the devotees) **sadā udyuktāḥ** (full of eagerness) **harim** (Bhagavān) **pati-putra-suhṛd-bhrātṛ-pitṛvat mitravat ca dhyāyanti**, **tebhyaḥ api namaḥ namaḥ**.

*Only by the designated service to his cherished one, at every moment following the guru, does the *rāgānuga sādhaka* attain perfection, or *bhāva-bhakti* —*

এইমত করে যেবা রাগানুগা-ভক্তি ।
কৃষ্ণের চরণে তাঁর উপজয় 'প্রীতি' ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

ei mata kare yebā rāgānugā-bhakti
in this way practises whoever rāgānugā-bhakti
kṛṣṇera caraṇe tāṁra upajaya 'prīti'
of Kṛṣṇa for the feet in him arises love

159 In whoever practises *rāgānugā-bhakti* in this way, love (*prīti*) for Kṛṣṇa's feet arises.

*(2) Description of *bhāva-bhakti*, or *rati*, the *sādhya*. The unblossomed state of love for Kṛṣṇa is *bhāva-bhakti*, or *rati*, which attracts Kṛṣṇa —*

প্রীত্যঙ্কুরে 'রতি', 'ভাব' — হয় দুই নাম ।
যাহা হৈতে বশ হন শ্রীভগবান্ ॥ ১৬০ ॥

prīty-aṅkure 'rati', 'bhāva' — haya dui nāma
of love in the sprout rati bhāva are two names
yāhā haite vaśa hana śrī-bhagavān
by which subdued becomes Śrī Bhagavān

160 When love is still a sprout, it has two names, *rati* and *bhāva*; by it Śrī Bhagavān Himself is won over.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"The sprout of *prīti* has two names, *rati* and *bhāva*": the sprout of *prema*, or *prīti*, has two names — *rati* and *bhāva*.

Thus ends the twenty-second chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Here is a devotee who acts in this way: externally, in the body of a *sādhaka*, he serves by the *kīrtana* of the *hari-kathā* he has heard, and in his mind, in the *siddha-deha* fit for serving Kṛṣṇa and befitting his own *rasa*, he always serves Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa in Vraja. He walks the *rāgānuga* path not as one walks in *vaidhī-bhakti*, by the force of scripture or of the guru's instructions, but by the power of his own natural, awakened taste. Walking this path, he attains deep love (*prīti*) for Kṛṣṇa's feet. Only on the *rāgānuga* path is Kṛṣṇa subdued by the power of *rati*, or *bhāva*, and then one attains loving service to Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-prema-sevā*).

*Until *bhāva*, or *rati*, arises, the *abhidheya* takes the form of *sādhana*; from it the *prayojana* is attained —*

যাহা হৈতে পাই কৃষ্ণের প্রেম-সেবন ।
এত ত' কহিলুঁ 'অভিধেয়'-বিবরণ ॥ ১৬১ ॥

yāhā haite pāi kṛṣṇera prema-sevana
by which one obtains to Kṛṣṇa in love service
eta ta' kahiluṁ 'abhidheya'-vivaraṇa
thus indeed I have told of the abhidheya the description

161 Thus I have described the *abhidheya*, the means by which one obtains loving service to Kṛṣṇa (*prema-sevā*).

*The *abhidheya*, *sādhana-bhakti*, has been described in brief —*

অভিধেয়, সাধন-ভক্তি এবে কহিলুঁ সনাতন ।
সংক্ষেপে কহিলুঁ, বিস্তার না যায় বর্ণন ॥ ১৬২ ॥

abhidheya, sādhana-bhakti ebe kahiluṁ sanātana
the abhidheya sādhana-bhakti now I have told Sanātana
saṅkṣepe kahiluṁ, vistāra nā yāya varṇana
in brief I have told it in full not can be described

162 Now, Sanātana, I have told you of the *abhidheya*, *sādhana-bhakti*. I have told it in brief; it cannot be described in full."[25]

*One who hears about *sādhana-bhakti* attains love for Kṛṣṇa —*

অভিধেয় সাধনভক্তি শুনে যেই জন ।
অচিরাৎ পায় সেই কৃষ্ণপ্রেমধন ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

abhidheya sādhana-bhakti śune yei jana
the abhidheya sādhana-bhakti hears whatever person
acirāt pāya sei kṛṣṇa-prema-dhana
very soon obtains that one of love for Kṛṣṇa the treasure

163 Whoever hears of *sādhana-bhakti*, the *abhidheya*, very soon obtains the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the twenty-second chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

164 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 10.2 (= Madhya 13.2); translation as there. ↩
2. The chapter continues the Lord's instruction to Sanātana (Madhya 20–21). ↩
3. The same verse as Madhya 20.121; translation as there. ↩
4. Numbered as in the heading of the edition and the *Anubhāṣya* (5.19.26); in other editions — 5.19.27. ↩

5. The same verse as Ādi 1.48; translation as there. ↩
6. The same verse as Madhya 9.266; translation as there. ↩
7. The same verse as Madhya 8.274; translation as there. ↩
8. The same verse as Ādi 8.58; translation as there. ↩
9. The same verse as 46; translation as there. ↩
10. The same verse as Ādi 1.60; translation as there. ↩
11. “All this” is the two kinds of bad association named in verse 84 (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). ↩
12. The same verse as Madhya 8.63 and 9.265; translation as there. The verse number is not printed in the edition. ↩
13. *Rāgānugā* means “following *rāga*”: the spontaneous love is that of the eternal residents of Vraja (*rāgātmikā-bhakti*), and *rāgānugā* follows it (verses 147–150). ↩
14. The same verse as 27; translation as there. ↩
15. *Tadīya*, “what is His own”: by verse 121, Tulasī, the Vaiṣṇavas, Mathurā and the *Bhāgavatam*. ↩
16. The condition is freedom from offence (verse 128). ↩
17. Reference by the edition’s heading (in another numbering, 1.2.91). ↩
18. Reference by the edition’s heading (in another numbering, 1.2.90). ↩
19. Reference by the edition’s heading (in another numbering, 1.2.238). ↩
20. *Mukhyā*, “principal”: such bhakti exists nowhere else (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*); the path of the practitioner is *rāgānugā*, following the people of Vraja. ↩
21. Reference as in the edition’s heading (Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, 272). ↩
22. That is, his longing was not awakened by scriptural argument, and he does not accept arguments raised against his awakened taste (see verse 150). This is not a disregard of scripture: according to the *Anubhāṣya*, devotees in whom taste has truly awakened (*jāta-ruci*) are deeply versed in the reasoning of scripture, while the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, who imagine themselves *rāgānugās* and abandon the books of devotion and the path of Śrī Rūpa, have no such taste. ↩
23. This is how longing (*lobha*) is born, not a rejection of scripture (see the note to verse 148). ↩
24. The verse number is not printed in the edition. ↩
25. The second line is the same as in Madhya 9.358. Here ends Mahāprabhu’s speech begun in verse 3. ↩
26. The edition reads *bhagavad-avidveṣī* (“not hostile to Bhagavān”); the sense and the verse (*dviṣatsu*, “toward the hostile”) require *bhagavad-vidveṣī*. An evident misprint. ↩

27. In the edition *ātma-nivedana*, like *sakhya*, is numbered (8); the numbering is correct from there on. An evident misprint, corrected to (9). ↩
28. The edition reads *phalam*; the verse and the gloss (“exceedingly”) require *alam*. An evident misprint. ↩
29. *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* 107. ↩
30. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.34. ↩
31. The punctuation of the edition is ambiguous here: the words about the four kinds of results of action could also be taken as describing Brahman. Translated according to the sense of the verse (“where the word … directed toward action does not operate”). ↩
32. So in the edition. According to the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (4.30), Prajāpati Dakṣa is the son of the Pracetās. ↩
33. So in the edition (“মধ্য ৮ম পঃ ২৭৫”). The verse *sarva-bhūteṣu yaḥ paśyet …* is Madhya 8.274 in our numbering (the *Anubhāṣya* discusses it there). Not corrected. ↩
34. According to the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (5.18), Bhadraśravā and his attendants worship Hayagrīva in Bhadrāśva-varṣa (5.18.1–6), while this verse (5.18.12) belongs to Prahlāda's prayer to Lord Nṛsiṁha in Hari-varṣa. ↩
35. “Nondifferent” (*abhinna*) in nature: as the next subheading explains, the Vaiṣṇava, like Kṛṣṇa, is full of eternity, knowledge and bliss (*sac-cid-ānanda*). This is not an identity of the *jīva* and God; see *Anubhāṣya* 100 and verse 100. ↩
36. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23. ↩
37. *Manu-saṁhitā* 3.70. ↩